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by The_Desecrated_One

Summary

Part 2 of Who am I What Happened and why can't she remember? Catra has found herself seemingly stuck in a version of her past with no knowledge of how she got there. Plagued with nightmares and missing gaps in her memory, Catra must navigate an Etheria while being pursued by herself and hopefully find the answers to why this all happened.

Chapter 1

"*You look beautiful, Catra." Angella said as she straightened the young woman's bridal cape. As Angella smiled, she took in Catra's appearance. It was lovely wear that consisted of dark shades of blood red, ink black, and trims of gold. She wore a chained circlet with several red jewels along with a ringed band around her neck that had a tribal pattern of the magicats. Her cape was draped over her shoulders and gave Catra an air of elegance.*

Catra gave a smile before letting out a small shaky breath. "Is it weird that I'm nervous?"

Angella shook her head, taking on a calming and reassuring tone, "No. That's quite normal. I imagine that Adora is feeling much the same way."

Light Hope waved her hands in the air, signing at Catra, "You look gorgeous Catra. Don't be nervous. This is your day."

Catra looked towards her friends that were here with her. Mara, Light Hope, Netossa, Spinnerella, Angella and even Beatrix. They all were giving her smiles of encouragement.

Catra nodded before a bell chimed three times, emitting low hums throughout the Temple of Sharella. Beatrix stepped forwards, holding a box of the ceremonial items that was required. Catra opened the lid, revealing a gold trimmed ring with a red and blue embellished stone that seemed to be continuously drifting. The other item was a. . . silver oval with a green diamond in the center.

Catra felt dread creep into her as she quickly spun around to find she was alone in a forest. "Adora! Mara! Anyone!"

"*Catra, no one is coming for you. You are gone and all alone." An ominous voice taunted from the shadows. Catra looked towards the silhouette, trying to make out their face. As they stepped*

forward into the light, Catra found it was too bright to see them, the light burning her eyes.

"*Come little sister. Bask in the light with me."*

Catra D'riluth sat up with a gasp, clutching her chest. As she looked around the tent, she found herself wincing at the beam of light peeking through the tent flaps. Grumbling as she calmed down, she crawled over to it before quickly closing it. As she sat down on the ground, Catra thought about the nightmare. She remembered the majority of her wedding but it was broken, fractured in certain areas. Whatever had happened after, she didn't know. But it seemed her mind was dead set on torturing her with it. Catra shook her head, letting out a sigh. It was fairly common these days. She longed for the days when she could sleep soundly but that wasn't going to happen anytime soon. At least not until she got Adora back.

A glint of purple light emanated from her azurlight. A purple gemstone that sat on her wrist similar to a bracer. It was the only thing she had with her besides the clothes on her back. It was a useful tool that Light Hope had modified and gifted her for her sixteenth birthday. Everything from hacking to recordings, it even contained hundreds of books worth of knowledge pertaining to Eternia's empire and the peoples within it. She had tried calling Adora's but to no avail. If she was here, something was blocking the signal.

Smiling softly, Catra pulled up a picture of Adora and herself that she found herself looking at quite frequently and found that she could understand Angella a bit more. For whenever she found herself overwhelmed, looking at Adora helped.

It had been over a month and a half since she'd arrived here. She didn't know how or why she was here but she had deduced that she hadn't just time traveled to get here. She had jumped ship in a manner of speaking. When Catra had run into the alternate version of herself, she had made a break for it and successfully,

albeit barely, escaped with no injury. She had to give her other self credit, she knew how to take herself down.

After escaping, she had quickly learned that there was no such thing as soul shards here. She had scoped out a Horde base for a week, breaking into one of their archives. It was here that Catra learned the truth. Catra's parents existed here but they were most certainly not Magicats. Here, Catra was not of the D'riluth lineage or any lineage for that matter. She was simply a war orphan whose parents had been the victim of a battle between the original Rebellion and the Horde. But something stuck out to her. Adora's birth records were unknown as were any mention of parentage.

Catra shook her head of those thoughts before turning off the gem and climbing out of the tent to start the day. It had been several trying weeks of traveling through the mountains towards Dryll. She had lost count of how many times she'd had to hide from the Horde and the Rebellion's troops. How many times she had to run when spotted.

She remembered reading a report that Entrapta had toyed with a piece of Eternian technology that had caused a wide scale virus to infect her robots before Glimmer, Bow, and Adora had recruited her right after the battle of Salineas. She had never had the chance to ask about it but if she had to guess, it sounded like one of the original encryption keys from Zed's department. Either way, she needed to get it. In fact, any Eternian tech would be handy right about now. With her time magic severely regressed, she needed all the help she could get. If she could recreate a warp drive, even a basic one, it could boost her powers, allowing her to get home.

As she stretched, her muscles screamed out in defiance. Living the royal life, while luxurious and fun, was not always good for her body. She would never let herself fall out of shape but she definitely skipped workouts now and then. The last month and a half had her feeling like she was back in the Horde.

Quickly packing the tent up and gathering her supplies, she began the trek towards Dryll, snacking on some leftover jerky.

The Fright Zone

In one of the many training halls, sounds of weights and sparring could be heard. Catra snarled as she let loose a quick savage combo on a punching bag. As she took deep breaths, calming her pulse, her ears twitched as she heard someone enter the room. A dark glare settled on her face.

"Catra, you seem more motivated lately. I'm pleasantly surprised. It seems the loss of Salineas has motivated you quite a bit." Shadow Weaver said in that irritatingly sweet tone she used when she was bothering her. It told her that she had nothing better to do than bug her.

"Oh, that's not it at all." Scorpia said with an oblivious smile. Catra shot a glare at the woman, silently telling her to be quiet. "Oh, uh, maybe I was mistaken."

Shadow Weaver raised a brow, "Oh? Do tell. What has gotten Catra in such a mood?"

"Nothing has gotten me in a mood. I'm just irritated at my loss." Catra said through gritted teeth, deflecting as best she could. Shadow Weaver didn't buy it for a second, unfortunately.

Shadow Weaver rounded on Kyle across the room, "Kyle, explain."

Kyle looked like a nervous wreck ,being thrust into the spotlight in such a manner. He spared a glance at Catra only to find himself being glared at with a look that promised pain if he spoke of what they saw. When he glanced back at Shadow Weaver, he decided that Shadow Weaver was much scarier. "We. . . saw something. Back at Salineas, I mean."

Shadow Weaver's eyes narrowed, "Go on."

"It was. . . well, we saw Catra." Kyle said, trying his best to tell her.

Shadow Weaver turned back towards Catra, "What does he mean?"

Catra shook her head, throwing her hands in the air, "It wasn't me, okay? It was just another cat person. She wandered into the camp and then ran off. End of story. Everyone's making a big deal out of nothing."

"She literally wore the same type of clothes you wear. The only difference being that her clothes had gold on them and she was wearing boots and gloves." Lonnie said from the side.

Rojelio hissed, causing Kyle to nod, "Yeah that too and don't forget the white cape. She even had a headpiece that was similar to yours. I guess that it was golden but it was still the same."

Catra looked pissed but still held her ground. "Her clothes were completely different. She wore black, red, and gold. I wear burgundy and violet. She wore boots, I don't. She had a cape, I will never wear one. And the headpiece? Lots of people wear them. So what if it was gold."

Scorpia finally spoke up, "But her eyes were the same. She had a blue eye and a yellow eye."

Shadow Weaver thought about what they were saying before chuckling, waving her hand dismissively. "Catra is right."

"She is?" Everyone said at the same time.

"Of course I am." Catra said as if it was obvious.

"Time traveling is impossible and any magic pertaining to temporal effects is unheard of and outright forbidden by Etheria as a whole. You just happened to meet a similar looking woman. Perhaps a distant relative." Shadow Weaver lectured.

"Oh yeah?" Lonnie snapped back in a slightly disrespectful tone that Shadow Weaver would have punished if not for what she said next, "Then how do you explain the orb she threw down that froze all of our troops in mid air?"

"What?" Shadow Weaver said, instantly turning her full attention on Lonnie.

"Yeah," Scorpia said in a slightly awed tone, "You should have seen it. It was crazy. I'd never seen any of the princesses do that. When she threw it, it made, like, a bubble that made everyone stop. We were the only ones who managed to dodge until Catra chased her down. Everything was frozen. The dirt, the bugs, the birds, even the electricity from the stun batons."

Shadow Weaver whipped around towards Catra, grabbing her arm, "Is this true?"

"Yeah, but like you said, It's not possible." Catra said, pulling her arm free.

"Do you have any footage at all of this woman?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Kyle's recorded some, but it's horrible quality." Lonnie said as she reached over to grab it before handing it to Shadow Weaver.

As she watched the shaky footage, Shadow Weaver paused it on a single frame that depicted the woman fairly well. They were right, she really did look exactly like Catra, although she looked older. In her early twenties for sure. Then she vanished from the video. "What just happened?"

"Kyle got bubbled." Lonnie said, snickering. Kyle let out a cry of embarrassment but Shadow Weaver paid it no mind. She was doing everything in her power to study the appearance of what could possibly be a future Catra. She used magic but her colors told her something about the woman. She wore Catra's colors of red and black but her highlights of gold and her shoulder cape told her a story all on its own. If this was Catra from the future,

then she was most likely in a relationship with Adora. But why come to the past?

Shadow Weaver stood up straight before looking at Catra, her hair flowing a bit more erratically, an air of seriousness filled the room as they all stood at attention. "Catra, You have full authorization to capture this woman. Use any means at your disposal."

"Wait, you really think this is me from the future?" Catra asked in disbelief.

"Whether she is or isn't doesn't matter. What does matter is the fact that she utilized a school of magic that was thought to be impossible. If the Horde can harness the ability to stop time in a localized area, then we need it." Shadow Weaver explained. "If it does indeed happen to be you, well, I'm sure you will have lots to talk about."

Catra watched Shadow Weaver leave the room before shooting glares at the squad. "Next time, keep your mouths shut!" she snarled before leaving the room.

Dryll

Catra was walking the mountains as she came into view of Entrapta's castle. She had never been here before but she knew this was the correct location. As she walked forward, she caught sight of someone she didn't think she'd see here.

"Bow?" Catra muttered to herself. He looked the same as ever, although slightly panicked.

"No, be careful!" Bow yelled before a pit of spikes opened up in front of him.

Catra eyed the trap as she quickly climbed one of the pillars, taking care to stay out of sight. She wasn't sure if this version of Bow would attack her or not. Best if she stayed quiet. As she quickly scaled the castle, she ignored Bow in favor of finding

Entrapta. The less she had to interact with him the better. No doubt this Adora and Glimmer weren't far behind. Quickly pulling herself onto a scaffolding, she began to maneuver towards one of the windows. Unfortunately, her plans of stealth were quickly dismissed as Glimmer and Adora in the form of She Ra appeared, shrieking at the height of the scaffolding they were on. Adora's eyes met hers and widened just before Glimmer teleported away. "Cat–"

Catra let out a groan at the stupidity of the situation before quickly climbing into the castle. "Fuck." She cursed under her breath.

No matter, she could still do this with minimal contact. Grab the encryption key and get out. As she crept through the castle, avoiding any traps that she could see, she bore witness to a complete overload of data in the castle. Her theory about it being an encryption key was quickly proven right. The tell tale signs of infection were all there. If she could get a hold of it, it would be a matter of simply rebooting it. Quickly pulling up

As she crawled through a ventilation shaft, she came to a spot above an unconscious Adora. A pang of longing shot through her, urging her to make sure she was alright. Catra shook her head free of those thoughts, reminding herself that this wasn't her Adora.

"Adora? Wake up, please wake up!" Glimmer said frantically.

Entrapta looked at Glimmer, curiosity in her eyes, "The tall one seems infected too. She turned less tall. How does it work?"

Glimmer glared at Entrapta, "She's not an it, she's my friend. And what do you mean she's infected too?"

Entrapta clasped her hands together before her hair formed into a triangular shape, "It's really fascinating. I've been experimenting with a disc that was recovered from a mine in Dryl. It was a game-changer. It held more complete First One's code than

anything I've ever seen before." She gained a thoughtful look, "But it seems to have reacted with the First Ones tech that powers my bots. It infected them with some sort of a virus."

"But why would it make She-Ra sick?"

Entrapta pulled out a scalpel, "Well, I'd have to take her apart to be sure. But since her sword is First One's tech, it must have spread through that."

"First, you're not taking her apart. She is a person!" Glimmer snapped, grabbing the scalpel from Entrapta's hair, "Second, if we destroy this disc, will that turn off the bots and stop the virus?"

Entrapta took a small step back before gaining a concerned look, "Destroy it? But the experiment isn't complete!"

Catra shook her head. They wouldn't get the chance to if she had anything to say about it.

"I think we can safely say that this experiment is a failure!" Glimmer said, ushering to the surrounding castle.

"But what if it's not–" Entrapta looked like she wanted to argue for about two seconds before hanging her head in defeat, "no, you're right, it's a failure."

As Catra shook her head, she quickly made her way through the vents before coming to the source of the so-called virus. It was in the center of the room connected to the main control center surrounded by robots everywhere. Surprisingly, Bow and Glimmer had managed to make it into the room around the same time she did.

Entrapta began laughing, "It's running on its own power now! That's it. We need to get outta here and burn this place to the ground. Experiment officially failed."

"Wait, I have an idea." Bow said, stopping everyone in their tracks before taking aim at the disk. "Now's your chance, sonic arrow. I

believe in you!" Just before the arrow could reach its mark, it seemed to freeze in air. Upon further inspection, Glimmer and Bow realized that the robots were frozen as well.

"What kind of sonic arrow is that?" Glimmer asked in confusion.

"I didn't do that." Bow said in an equally confused manner.

Just then, Catra jumped down and grabbed the arrow out of mid air before quickly chucking the arrow away from her in the opposite direction before freezing in mid air again. "Sorry. But I need this disk more than you do."

"Catra! I knew you had something to do with this!" Glimmer cried out in anger.

As Catra pulled the disk out of the console, she started to twist the ends before it opened. Pushing it open to the side to reveal a dial. As soon as she twisted it, it snapped closed. The effect was instant as Adora slowly sat up, her strange behavior all but gone. After a couple more seconds, the frozen area started moving again and the castle's robots all crumbled to the ground.

"Where am I? What's happening?" Adora asked confusedly before her eyes landed on Catra only to stop mid sentence. "Catra?."

Catra pocketed the disk before she turned away from the group, making sure they couldn't get a good look at her face. "Don't worry about me. Just forget you ever saw me."

"Wait! I–" Adora was cut off, shocked as she witnessed Catra seemingly vanish before her eyes. "Where'd she go?"

Glimmer narrowed her eyes, "She teleported. It's weird. I feel like I know where she went. Like I could follow her."

"Don't. We don't know where she could have gone, or if there are others with her." Bow said.

"But the disk–" Glimmer started before Adora interjected.

"It's alright Glimmer. Worry about it later." Adora said as Bow helped her to her feet. Adora's mind was focused though. What did Catra want with the disk and why did she hide her face?

Adora Glenn, daughter of King Randor and Queen Marleena sat up with a sharp gasp before immediately shrinking into herself, wincing as she grasped her ribs with a pained groan.

"Easy, easy, you've been asleep for a while. You don't want to strain yourself" A voice said from her side as a cup of water was held in front of her. Quickly grabbing it, Adora downed the water before looking up at the source of the voice. "King Micah?"

Before Adora could say anything else, Micah reached out and touched her face. Adora's confusion showed as Micah pulled his hand back, "Apologies. It's been quite some time since I've talked to anyone else. Anyone real that is."

Adora stood up before looking at Micah. "What happened? I remember the bits of the wedding but not much else."

"Wedding? What are you talking about?" Micah asked as he looked around cautiously at their surroundings.

Adora finally took a second to look at him before realizing something. This wasn't the Micah that she knew. He was dirty and scarred, almost as if he had been in a large battle and he seemed exhausted. She recognized the look from some of Lonnie's friends. Some of the Horde soldiers had worn it from her original timeline as well. "King Micah, do you know who I am?" She asked gently.

Micah narrowed his eyes as he examined her before shaking his head. "Your clothes tell me you're a princess or a queen but beyond that, no. If we have met, I can't remember you. . .*Have* we met?"

"I'm the queen of Eternia. I'm Adora. You, Angella, and Glimmer were at Catra and I's wedding. How long has it been since then?" Adora asked with a slight hint of desperation.

"Queen of. . . Eternia? Wedding?" Micah muttered quietly before shaking his head. "You're not making any sense. That's–" Micah cut himself off, looking to the side. The sounds of chittering drifted into the clearing. "We need to run, now!" Adora wanted to ask why before the dark was lit up by multiple glowing purple eyes. As they stepped out of the shadows, she saw they looked feline in nature with what looked like pincers in their mouths.

Adora narrowed her eyes. The creatures looked very similar to the dylinx of Eternia. Adora quickly stepped forward before summoning her sword and holding it above her. "For the honor of Grayskull!"

Micah watched in fascination as a mystical princess appeared before him that he had only read about in stories. "She Ra." He said in fascination.

Adora quickly swung her sword in an arc, sending out a shockwave of golden light that blasted everything away from them. Whatever creatures remained snarled at Adora before retreating, not keen on repeating their friend's mistakes.

As Micah looked around the clearing, he looked back at Adora. "So let me get this straight. You're the Queen of the Eternians and you're She Ra?"

Adora smiled, "That pretty much sums it up."

"I have a lot of questions. But why are you here?" Micah asked.

"I'm trying to figure that out. It was the day of my wedding and we were being crowned and then. . . well I can't remember much after. Speaking of which, where is *here*, exactly?" Adora asked.

"You're on Beast Island." Micah explained.

Adora froze in shock as memories of her Horde days filled her mind. "What do you mean Beast Island?"

"Just what I said. I've been trapped here for days, months, years," he looked off to the side, "I have no concept of time here." Suddenly his face filled with hope, "But you're She Ra. You can get us off this island right? You must be able to."

Adora was still reeling from what she just heard. She turned towards Micah, "Is the Horde an enemy of the Princesses or is it Etheria's military?"

"The Horde is the enemy. They've been trying to conquer the planet for years?" Micah said, baffled.

"I time traveled." Adora said in shock before a determined look settled on her face. She needed to find Catra. She looked down at the azurlight only to find it cracked. "Shit." Suddenly she started feeling weaker. As she looked down at her hands, she slowly started to shift out of She Ra before all that was left was herself. As she tried to call upon the magic, she found it almost absent, but that wasn't quite right. It was almost as if it was depleted. "Shit."

"What?" Micah asked.

"My powers are on the fritz and my azurlight is cracked."

"Is that bad?" Micah asked, looking at her wrist.

Adora shook her head, "It's not the first time I've had to fight without being She Ra. As for my azurlight?" She tapped it, attempting to turn it on. "Only if I can't get it started. I just don't have the tools to fix it with me."

Micah watched in silence as Adora finally got it to emit a slight glow. After a moment of gentle prodding, a hologram appeared. It was severely glitched but it was operational.

"Yes!" Adora exclaimed before nodding. "Access emergency signaling. Severity level nine. Search for any operational azurlights on the planet."

The gem lit up in a blinking pattern before turning pink. *"Connecting to planet wide Eternian system N-32. Receiving Signal."*

All of a sudden Micah heard the dreaded signal that he had run from everyday for who knows how long, coming from the gem on her wrist. As he narrowed his eyes, Adora waved her hand to the side. "Descramble the encoded signal."

'*Planetwide evacuation required. All units return to Eternia*

Planetwide evacuation required. All units return to Eternia

Grayskull has fallen. Initiate Sol System Resurrection.

–File Corrupted

–File Corrupted

This is a feature, not a bug. This is a feature, not a bug'

Adora was confused. She didn't know what these messages meant but regardless, she had to focus on getting off of this island. "Signal received. Initiate signal shutdown. Proceed with azurlight search."

Micah didn't say anything to the woman in front of him but he had heard it. He had heard the island beginning to shut down. He was overwhelmed. This was it. He really was going to get off of this forsaken island. He let out a shaky breath but didn't relax. He couldn't afford to relax until he was off.

'*Azurlight detected. Securing connection. Visual component damaged. Audio connection secured. Contacting Queen Catra D'riluth.'* The gem said before turning green. Adora breathed a sigh of relief.

As Catra fiddled with the disk at her camp, her azurlight began to blink with a green light.

'*Com link with Adora Glenn established.*'

"*Catra! Catra, are you there!*"

Catra immediately abandoned the disk, looking at her wrist at breakneck speed "Adora, I'm here! What happened? Where are you? Why can't I see you?"

"*My azurlight is damaged. As for where? It's hard to explain. I'm fine, but I'm on Beast Island. I think we time traveled, Catra. I'm with King Micah.*"

Catra let out a relieved sigh before nodding, "Kind of. We didn't time travel. This is an alternate timeline. My mom wasn't C'yra here. And I didn't lose my memories here. I've been running from the rebellion and the Horde for the last month and a half. They think I'm the other Catra."

"*Other Catra? We didn't switch?*"

"No. Whatever happened caused us to jump here. I'm trying to build a warp drive to jump start my powers so we can leave but it's. . . proving to be a challenge. My magic is severely limited right now."

"*. . .Can you warp to us?*"

". . .No." Catra said, "I can barely warp two miles right now. My gravity powers barely work, my clairvoyance is gone, my bombs drain me, and I'm not chancing a rewind. All in all, it's like I'm fifteen again."

"*. . .No.*" Catra said*, "I can barely warp two miles right now. My gravity powers barely work, my clairvoyance is gone, my bombs drain me, and I'm not chancing a rewind. All in all, it's like I'm fifteen again.*"

"I can barely be She Ra right now. It's like my powers are drained."

"*Great."* Catra grumbled.

Micah looked at Adora before stepping forward, "May I?"

Adora nodded. "Of course."

Micah nodded before leaning forward. "Catra, I don't think we've met before and I'm not sure I understand this whole time travel thing but if you can't get to us then you need to go to Bright Moon."

A humorless chuckle was heard from Catra, *"Didn't you hear what I said? Everyone is trying to capture or kill me. That includes Angella. If I even think about going there, they'll attack me."*

Micah nodded, "I understand that but if you explain where I am then you might be able to speak to Angella."

Catra was silent for a moment before she spoke softly. *"Adora, does Micah know how long he's been there?"*

"No, he said there's no concept of time here. Why?"

Catra let out a breath, *"I just snuck into Dryll to steal a disk with a virus. A month and a half ago, I ran away from the Horde while they were headed to Salineas to destroy the Sea Gate. Do you understand the time frame here?"*

"Fuck." Adora muttered.

"What is it?" Micah asked. "What does that mean?"

"*When I spoke to Angella about you, she never told me exactly when it was that you supposedly died. But it's been a while. Long enough that no one could have known you were here."* Catra said before dropping her voice to a gentler tone, *"Micah, Glimmer is about sixteen."*

Micah took a step back at hearing that before looking at his hands. After a moment, he clenched his hands into fists, a

determined look on his face. "Can you make this call at any time?"

"As long as the channel remains open, yeah." Adora said.

"Good," Micah said, nodding, "Then here's what I want you to do Catra. Can you get to Angella undetected?"

"*I know the castle fairly well. Once I'm in range I can just teleport in. It shouldn't be too hard. But to do what you're suggesting would need to be quick. Because as soon as I go in there, they will attack me. There's no question about it. My other self is a Force Captain. My face has a capture or flee on sight order."* Catra's voice said over the line.

Micah nodded, "That's why it's imperative that you directly seek Angella out first. No one else."

"*What about Castaspella? She's your sister right?"* Catra asked.

Micah shook his head, "No. She'll assume it's illusion magic. It has to be my wife."

Catra was quiet before a sigh was heard. *"Alright. I'm just east of Dryll at the edge of the mountain range."*

"That's mostly flat lands and plains." Micah said nodding, "That's a straight shot to Bright Moon. Roughly a day's journey."

"*You're forgetting the patrols."*

Micah thought about something before a thought came to him. "The mountains across the bay of Bright Moon."

"*They are crawling with Juliet's soldiers. I'd never make it through, even with my powers."*

"You won't have to." Micah said.

"What do you mean?" Adora asked.

"There's a mine. Long abandoned even before my time as King. It was initially used to mine the material arcanite." Micah explained.

"*The Horde uses that for their tanks."* Catra said.

"Yes. It's highly conductive to a charge of any kind. The mine was abandoned because of the dangerous nature of the mineral. It's not hard to navigate if you can teleport through the cracks. Going around it was the dangerous part. You'll need a light of some kind but beyond that, it's a straight path through the mountains directly to the bay.

"*Alright."* Catra said slowly, *"Is it safe where you are?"*

"Is it?" Adora asked Micah as well.

"With that signal dead, I should be able to set up a camp near the beach away from danger." Micah said with audible excitement. Adora could understand his anxiousness to leave this place. It was definitely what the Horde promised and more.

"Please hurry." Adora said.

"*I will. Stay safe and be ready to receive the call. I love you."*

"We will. I love you too." Adora said before the call ended.

Adora looked at Micah. "We better get going. We probably have a bit of a wait ahead of us."

True to Micah's words, it took about a whole day to reach the mine and navigate through it. Thankfully it was as empty as he said it would be. As Catra exited the mine, she could see Bright Moon off in the distance. It was early morning so the guards should be switching rotations, giving her a moment of opportunity. She had avoided having to swim across the large river with a quick teleport. Finding herself in the brush, she quickly navigated through the trees, jumping through branches and climbing the

stones lining the beach as she made her way towards the castle avoiding any guards or civilians that she might happen to run into.

Finally making her way towards the castle, she began to scale the wall, finding herself outside Adora's bedroom on her balcony. As she quietly peeked through her window, she quietly cursed her luck at what she saw. Adora was already in her morning routine of exercising. As Catra watched her finish her push ups, she waited for her to head for the showers. Unfortunately, as Catra was quick to realize, that wasn't what was going to happen because Adora had quickly whipped her head at the window. Catra had just ducked out of sight. Her ears still picked up the sound of Adora's approaching footsteps and the slight metallic ringing of her sword.

As Adora walked to the balcony doors, she quickly grasped the doors and flung them open, sword primed to strike, only to find herself alone. Adora at a young age had learned to trust her instincts, growing up in the Horde, and every cell in her body was telling her that she had just been watched.

"Guards!" Adora called out.

Moments later, Juliet walked into the room. "Yes, Adora?"

"I think someone's in the castle." Adora said seriously.

"You're certain?" Juliet said to which Adora nodded. Juliet gave a sharp nod before ordering the others to lockdown the castle. Catra, on the other hand, had teleported just in time above Adora.

As Adora went to transform just in case of an attacker, she raised her sword, looking up and found herself staring Catra straight in the eyes. "Fuck." Catra simply said.

"For the honor of–" Adora went to quickly say before she was cut off from a kick in the gut. As her sword was viciously ripped from her hands, she recovered quickly, pulling a dagger from her belt, prepared to fight.

"Catra, I–" Adora went to say but found Catra missing a beat, she immediately ran out into the halls. "Glimmer! Bow! It's Catra! She's here!"

"We know!" Bow called out, holding up his bow with a cut string.

"Where's Glimmer?" Adora asked as the halls filled with guards.

"She went after her!" Bow said, quickly pulling another bowstring out of his satchel, restringing his bow. "Let's hurry!"

"Give the sword back, Catra! You can't win! Not here!" Glimmer yelled as she followed her throughout the castle, teleporting wherever Catra found herself.

"Get lost Sparkles! You can have the sword back once I'm done here." Catra cried before teleporting in front of Bow and Adora. Immediately, Bow fired an arrow at her while Adora charged her.

Catra let out a growl. This was not going the way she had planned and she didn't have the magic to beat Glimmer in a teleporting match on her home turf. She needed to find Angella and quickly. Dodging the arrow, she quickly threw the sword across the room, away from Adora, before engaging her in a fight. Even as kids, Adora had always bested her in a hand to hand and that still hadn't changed. The fact that she was actively trying not to hurt her also didn't help matters.

As the fight pressed on, Catra found herself becoming overwhelmed by the onslaught, having to teleport just to stay in the fight. Suddenly, the doors swung open to give way to Netossa, Spinnerella, and Juliet and her guards. Catra found herself up against more than twenty opponents.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" Adora cried as she shifted to She Ra. Catra looked everywhere for an escape route but with Glimmer able to lock onto her teleport, a thought that hadn't even crossed her mind, she found herself trapped.

"Give up Catra." Adora said, leveling the sword at her. And then Catra saw who she was looking for. Angella entered the room with glowing fists and a glare that could kill. As Catra thought about what she could do she tried to use what little gravity magic she could, only to find her hands sputtering.

"All out of magic? Sucks, doesn't it?" Glimmer taunted.

Catra eyed everyone in the room before using the remaining magic she had left and threw a temporal bomb down, encompassing the entire room in the spell. The effect was weak and would only last for five seconds on account of what little magic she had left, but five seconds was all she needed. As everyone slowly turned towards Catra, quickly regaining their speed, she had already maneuvered past everyone and grabbed Angella, pinning her claws against her throat. And just like that, the effect was gone. Everyone froze at the suddenly dangerous position they found themselves in.

"Let go of my mom!" Glimmer snarled.

"Let her go, Catra!" Adora cried.

Cries of outrage filled the room as every guard in Bright Moon entered the room, spears primed at her. Catra tried to talk only to be drowned out by the shouts and screams of the guards.

"Everyone shut the fuck up!" Catra snarled, her voice carrying throughout the halls. Everyone went silent at that. Catra tilted her head towards her wrist "Adora, are you there?"

"What?" Adora said in front of her in confusion.

"Not you! Adora, answer the damn call!" Catra snarled.

"*I'm here! What's happening?"* Adora's voice rang out through the throne room.

Whispers of confusion filled the halls until Bow spoke up. "Does Catra look older?"

"Tell Micah to say something! I'm looking at every guard in this damn castle pointing spears at me because I'm holding Angella hostage." Catra said with slight desperation. This was it. She couldn't teleport anymore. If this failed she was done for.

"Micah?" Angella whispered in shock.

"*Angie! Angie, are you there? It's me. It's not a trick."* Micah's voice drifted through the hall like a dagger, cutting off everyone who might have said something.

"Micah? Is that really you?" Angella asked, her head craning to look at the gem on Catra's wrist.

"She's taller too." Bow said quietly.

"*It's me. The Horde sent me to Beast Island. These two, Catra and Adora, helped me. I sent Catra there to tell you. Adora and I are stuck here."*

"How do we know it's really him? This could be a trick." Juliet said cautiously.

"*On our wedding night. It was just us on the balcony. I cast a spell that showed you–"*

"Stars." Angella said quietly, her eyes filling with tears. "It's really you."

"This isn't our Catra." Bow said in realization from the back, coming to a conclusion that Adora had already reached.

"*It's me. You need to trust Catra. She's there to help."*

"Once she lets Queen Angella go!" Juliet said harshly.

"*Let her go, Catra."* Micah's voice rang through the halls.

Catra gave a harsh laugh, "I'm looking at over twenty guards with spears, four princesses with magic leveled at me, and an archer

all primed to attack me and I have no magic left. Forgive me if I'm a bit hesitant to let her go."

Adora eyed Catra before turning back. Bow unknocked his arrow and Glimmer let the magic dissipate around her. Angella looked at Spinnerella, Netossa, and Juliet. "Lower your weapons."

Nobody looked comfortable with the idea but did as commanded. Catra eyed the room before angling herself towards a door that she knew for a fact led to an exit before letting Angella go and backing up towards the door. As Angella rubbed her throat, she turned and eyed Catra before looking at her wrist, "Micah, are you still there?"

"*I'm here."*

"You've been on Beast Island? This whole time?"

"*Yes. Adora was able to disable the island's. . . hostilities and called Catra. I directed her towards you. It sounds like the plan worked more or less."* Micah said, sounding relieved.

Angella wiped her eyes, as she choked back a sob with a small laugh. "We're going to come get you. Just hang on."

"*I've waited almost twelve years, I think I can wait a few more days."* Micah chuckled.

Catra turned away from Angella, "Put Adora back on."

After a moment, Adora's voice drifted through the gem. *"I'm here."*

"What's your azurlight's condition?"

"*Not good. The crack is worse."* Adora said.

Catra nodded, "Set it to emergency stasis. You won't be able to call though. The less damage I need to fix on it the better."

"*Okay, we're on a cliff overlooking a beach on the south side of the island. It has a skeleton of a giant sea monster on the rocks. You can't miss it. I'll see you soon."*

"See you soon." Catra said before the glowing light faded. Catra turned to look at the room full of rebellion soldiers and the rebellion themselves. "What!" Catra slightly growled.

"You're from. . . the future!" Bow said with excitement in his eyes.

"Yeah, let's not make a big deal out of it, Bow." Catra said with slight irritation.

"What's it like? Am I handsome in the future? Am I still an archer? Do we win the war?" Bow rapidly asked.

Catra let out a sharp yell, "Be quiet!" before slowly sinking to the ground, struggling to catch her breath.

"What's wrong with her?" Adora asked in concern as she walked towards her.

"Magic exhaustion." Glimmer said, recognizing the signs immediately. "Give her a few minutes to relax. She just over-used it."

"Time magic." Angella said before looking at Catra, "Is that how you time traveled?"

Catra nodded. "Yeah."

Angella looked conflicted on how to handle Catra. On one hand, this was a future version of a Force Captain in the Horde. On another, she had just risked life and limb to tell her that Micah was alive. Her compassion eventually won over. "Get her some food and water. And contact Sea Hawk immediately as well as Castaspella." She looked back at Catra, "I want to have a word with you shortly. For now, rest."

Catra gave a thumbs up before laying back. Adora stood over her before kneeling down, an awkwardness in her tone. "Are you alright?"

"Wow, you sound uncomfortable." Catra snickered after a moment.

Adora visibly relaxed at the sight of her best friend joking with her. A version of her anyways. Adora narrowed her eyes before flicking the blue gem in her golden head piece. "Why'd you ditch the red? Trade it in for some gold to look fancy?"

"That's actually my crown." Catra said with a raised eyebrow.

"Crown?" Bow asked.

"It's a long story that we can talk about later." Catra said, before standing up. Adora found herself close to eye level with Catra, surprisingly.

"Why are you helping us!" Glimmer asked defensively, shoving herself in between Adora and her. "Did the Horde lose? Is that why you came back in time?"

"Glimmer, calm down." Bow said, placing a hand on her shoulder, "She's helping us. She came to get us to go get your father."

"No! She's helping herself." Glimmer said with a glare. "She's needed us to help her get Adora off Beast Island for some reason. My dad's just a bonus that worked in her favor."

"That's not true. She's–" Adora went to defend her only to be cut off by Catra.

"No, she's absolutely right."

"What?" Adora asked in shock.

"See?" Glimmer spat. "What did I tell you?"

"Glimmer's right. I'm only here to get Adora back. I had no clue that Micah was on that island. The fact that it worked out this way is just a happy accident for all parties involved. Once I've got Adora back, I'll finish building a warp drive and we'll leave. End of story." Catra said before taking a plate of food that was being brought to her, nodding at the servant, "Thanks."

"So, you'll just leave? Just like that? Why'd you even come to the past in the first place?" Adora asked in mild irritation.

Catra sipped her drink, "I didn't. In fact, neither I nor Adora know how we ended up here. But the less I say the better. Better you focus on yourselves then us. Because I know for a fact that Micah was not supposed to be here nor was he going to get rescued any time soon."

"How do you know?" Bow asked.

"Because, right around this time was when I joined the rebellion and that is clearly not going to happen in this timeline." Catra said before eyeing Angella entering the room again.

"Catra and all members of the war council come with me!" Angella commanded before turning and striding towards the war room.

Catra and the trio followed along with Juliet and Netossa and Spinerella. As everyone took their seats, Catra remained standing. Angella realized the mistake before ushering a servant to get Catra a chair.

After everyone had taken their seats, Angella looked at Catra expectantly, "Please explain yourself."

Catra took a deep breath before sighing, "Okay, let's get the big thing out of the way first. You and my Adora are not the same person, just like I'm not the same Catra as yours. Our timelines are different."

"How so?" Angella asked.

"Let's start with the biggest difference. The souls shards." Catra said.

"The what?" Bow asked.

"Exactly my point. In my time, these little crystals were known throughout Etheria by princesses and mages alike. They were dangerous and caused complete memory loss in those affected by them. In some cases, you could go mad or die." Catra explained.

"So what? Were they important?" Netossa asked.

"Considering I came into contact with one, yes, I'd say they were fairly important. I lost all my memories. Couldn't even remember my name. I wandered for a bit before Perfuma found me and captured me. She handed me over to Bright Moon where Adora defended me and that's pretty much how I joined the rebellion." Catra shrugged.

Glimmer looked like she wanted to call her a liar. "And how do you know that these things aren't actually around?"

"Because *your* Catra is still working against you. And I know it's right around this time because Castaspella's eclipse ritual should be taking place soon. After that, I believe two weeks to be exact, Princess Prom will be hosted by Frosta." Catra said.

"I forgot about Princess Prom." Bow said off to the side.

Catra shook her head "Look, I get that you're in the middle of the war. I do, but I am not the answer to your problems. Neither is my Adora. You can't do it like I did. The fact that you're getting Micah back already tells me that."

Angella looked at Catra closely before opening her mouth, "What was our relationship like?"

"Friends? Mentor? It's difficult to label it. We were close." Catra simply said.

"Wait, what do you mean like you did?" Bow asked before his eyes widened, "Did you defeat the Horde?"

"No, Hordak called for a dialogue and we brokered a peace treaty." Catra said before being interrupted.

"Well how did you get him to do that?" Spinnerella asked.

"It's not that simple. There were–" Catra was cut off again.

"If we can just copy you then we could end the war." Netossa said with sounds of agreement from Glimmer.

"It's not–"

"And with King Micah back it'll be even better!" Juliet said from the side.

Catra's tail was swishing aggressively before she stood up, slamming her hands on the table. "Enough!"

Everyone recoiled at the outburst before Catra smoothed her hair down, taking a seat with a huff. "You can't do that. This whole thing was dependent on me getting my magic. It was *very* circumstantial and we were lucky it worked out at all. And by the end of it all, it didn't even matter."

"Why not?" Angella asked, speaking for the first time.

"I was time traveling back like a thousand years during all of this. I was in constant contact with the First Ones and it made me consider things I normally wouldn't have done. About a week later, time fell apart." Catra explained.

"Fell apart how?" Adora asked.

"As in 'the end of the world' fell apart. I was taken captive by the First Ones and you all had to rescue me. It ended with me rewriting time in a specific way that made everything work out the way it did. It wasn't an easy decision. The only reason I can even

remember any of it is because my Glimmer got lucky and had some of She Ra's magic that allowed her to remember." Catra explained.

'That sounds insane!" Glimmer cried in disbelief. "Are we really believing any of this?"

"This does sound a bit far fetched." Bow agreed.

Catra sat back before tapping her azurlight. "Bring up Etheria's files on the Kingdom of Bright Moon and all high ranking officials."

"*These files are restricted. Administrator code required."* A voice rang out from the gem.

"Designated Administrator AU-66666 Catra." Catra said.

"*Administrator code accepted. Lifting security protocols. Welcome Queen Catra."*

Immediately. Several images appeared of Angella and Micah standing together with Glimmer. One of the more recent images showed Glimmer with her wings and Hordak awarding Bow a medal. Catra swiped them away before flicking her hand forward. "Tell me who the Horde is."

"*The Etherian military, otherwise known as 'The Horde,' is Etheria's first line of defense against planetary threats. Overseen by King Micah and Queen Angella's closest advisor, General Hordak, the Horde is an elite fighting force that has advanced military tactics on Etheria. Its science division is managed by General Hordak's wife, Queen Entrapta from their Kingdom of Dryll. Their marriage is one of great importance that not only united Eternia and Eterhia, but has advanced the technological aspect of Etheria by centuries."*

Catra lightly brushed the azurlight, turning it off. She looked at the alternate versions of her friends with an expectant look, "Do you believe me now?"

"Fascinating!" Castaspella said from the doorway.

"I concur! This is astounding. Never did I think that I'd have the chance to witness a time traveler. What an adventure! I must hear all about it." Sea Hawk shouted exuberantly.

"Sea Hawk? How are you here so fast?" Adora asked.

"Oh, I was just down the coast. My darling Mermista is unfortunately back in Salineas but no matter. I hear you need to make a dangerous trek to the dreaded Beast Island! Say no more, for I am your man! It will be perilous. It will be dangerous. Fraught with all the makings of a legendary tale as we rescue the King himself. Huzzah!"

"Right. . . ignoring that for a moment, I take it that you are the one I have to thank for the information about my brother? Is. . . Is it true?" Castaspella asked with a slight tremor in her voice.

Catra nodded, "It's true. He's alive."

Castaspella looked like she was about to cry but settled for letting out a small laugh. "All right then. Well, let's go get him."

"Not so fast!" Sea Hawk said, losing his jovial attitude in favor of a more serious one. "I'm not joking about the journey. This isn't some stroll down to Salineas. This is Beast Island we're talking about. We'll be able to sail down the Straits of Serpentine until we reach the Sea Gate of Salineas but once we exit the Enchanted Grotto, that's it. We will officially be in Horde waters. It's not a short journey either. The navigation will take a few days just to avoid the Horde's patrols."

All eyes turned towards Catra. She gained a defensive look on her face, "What?"

"What do you suggest?"Bow asked.

"You're asking me?" Catra scoffed. "What makes you think I know what to do?"

"You said you navigated past Horde and Rebellion patrols for the last month."

"You snuck into Dryll."

"You're an excellent strategist."

"You come from the future."

"Okay, okay, fine!" Catra exclaimed in irritation, holding her hands up. She looked down for a moment before casting a glance at Adora.

"What?"

"Are the Skiff's still under the armory?" Catra asked.

Adora looked at her for a few seconds before her eyes widened, "You want to steal a sky ship."

Catra nodded. "It would be easier to transport everyone and safer too. My second alternative is to use Swift Wind but I see you haven't met him yet."

"Who?" Glimmer asked.

"Adora's steed. He's a talking Horse with wings that's bound to She Ra. You'll meet him in the coming weeks. Regardless, this might be easier going by sky. That's how the Horde gets there at least in my time they did."

Adora shook her head, "No, you're right. They still transport prisoners there with the sky ships." She let out a hum, "That. . . would work. Actually, that's a really good plan."

Catra nodded before turning to Sea Hawk who had gained a bit of dejected look at seemingly having his adventure dashed. "Sea Hawk!"

"Yes ma'am?" He said nervously, standing at attention.

"You're going to be causing a distraction so that Adora, Glimmer, and I can slip in unnoticed under the cover of night. You're going to take Bow and while you pass Salineas be sure to grab Mermista. Several ships will need to accompany you, but you and only you are going to be headed directly into the Horde river. We're going to charge through the patrols and straight shoot it. It's going to be dangerous. Can you handle it?"

Sea Hawk nodded determinedly. "I take it that the sky ship will be the evacuation plan?"

"Yeah." Catra turned towards Castaspella, Angella, Netossa, and Spinnerella, "Are any of you going to go with Sea Hawk?"

"I will." Castaspella declared. "If there's even a chance that Shadow Weaver will be present, then you'll need me. I refused to help my brother once and I thought it got him killed. I'll be damned if I don't help bring him back."

"You can count on us." Netossa said with a smirk. Spinnerella nodded in agreement.

Catra looked at Angella as she contemplated her choice, ". . .No one is forcing you to do this Angella. We're going to rescue them all the same."

Angella shook her head, "I *will* go." She said resolutely, "If Hordak gets wind of me in the field, especially so close to the Fright Zone, he will send every troop he can to capture me. It will be the perfect diversion."

Catra nodded before turning to Adora. "My Adora's powers aren't working correctly. That means it's up to you to be She Ra if there's an air battle. Are you up for it?"

Adora nodded with a serious expression.

"Good." Catra said, "Juliet, I want you to take Spinnerella and your soldiers and come in from the North by sea and several ground troops with Netossa from the east by Thaymor. Netossa,

contact Perfuma and have her rendezvous with you and the troops by Thaymor. Sea Hawk won't have an escape route once he pushes through the river so you'll need to divert some of the heat off of him. We want them to panic."

Juliet nodded before Catra turned towards Glimmer and Angella, "You're not going to like this next part."

"Why?" Glimmer asked.

"I'm going to supercharge us." Catra said.

"Supercharge? Supercharge how?" Angella asked.

"She's going to siphon some magic from the Moon Stone and force it into you." Castaspella said with some distaste. "Am I correct in that assumption?"

Catra nodded, "It was the first spell I learned from Shadow Weaver and it was for the exact same purpose we're using it for now."

"I–Is it harmful?" Angella asked with hesitance.

"Only if you continue to do it for an extended period." Catra explained before turning towards Glimmer, "When I overcharged my Glimmer, she compared it to being without a limit on her range of teleportation. That's what we're going to be hoping for."

"What about you? Aren't you going to be teleporting too?" Bow asked.

Catra shook her head. "No. With my magic being as regressed as it is, I'll need to conserve it. When I have the Moon Stone's power, it will boost me to where I should normally be but I don't know how long that will last me. I'll need it to freeze the surrounding ships when we go to get you guys."

"Got it." Bow said with a chorus of agreement from the room.

Catra looked at everyone as she stood, "Remember everyone, this is a grab and go, not an attack. The goal is diversion. Once we have the ship, pull back. There's no use in risking yourselves. Adora, Glimmer, and I will leave tonight. With the Horde's failure at Salineas, they pulled their ships in towards the shore. Make sure everyone is in position."

"How can you be sure?" Juliet asked.

"Because I remember Shadow Weaver ordering them to do it."

"Then it sounds like a plan." Bow said as he went to stand by Sea Hawk.

"A legendary tale for the songs!" Sea Hawk shouted, "I shall contact my darling Mermista and inform her of the plan. I'll leave at once."

"I'll gather my men." Juliet said before turning to leave.

Angella stood and nodded, "Everyone take care of one another and watch each other's backs." she said before following Sea Hawk.

As everyone left the room, Adora and Glimmer stared at her. Catra let out a sigh. "Get comfortable, we're going to be waiting a couple of hours."

Glimmer eyed Catra, "I still don't really trust you. . . but you're helping me get my dad back, sooo. . . Thank you"

Catra nodded, a smile on her face, "It's kind of funny really. My Glimmer acted the exact same way you are now when I first showed up. The circumstances are a bit different but I suppose I showed up around the same time anyways."

Adora examined Catra's appearance before looking at her crown. "What are you the queen of?"

Catra let out a small laugh, "Actually, I only just recently became a queen. As for your question, I'm queen of Eternia and the empress of the natural known universe. . . Wow, does that sound weird coming out of my mouth."

"Eternia? As in the First Ones?" Glimmer asked.

"The very ones." Catra said.

"How are you, Queen?" Glimmer asked? "Is it some weird trial by combat? Cause I can see you winning something like that."

Catra actually laughed at that, "No, but I'd pay to see that. No, I married into the position."

Glimmer and Adora's eyes widened in shock, "You're married?"

Catra didn't miss the small dejection in Adora's eyes. All of a sudden, a sly thought began to take root in her mind. "Yep. She's an Eternian I met during my childhood. She's smart and funny and beautiful and quick with a joke. She challenges me to be better."

Glimmer gave a genuine smile at the description while Adora seemed to become a bit distant. "So how long have you been together?" Glimmer asked.

"We started dating when I was sixteen. She was the daughter of King Randor and Queen Marleena of Eternia. But we met in my Kingdom of Halfmoon when my mother was in a diplomatic meeting with her mother and we've been together ever since. See, technically, in the rewritten timeline, I wasn't born on Etheria. Because of that, I was born to Queen C'yra of Half Moon."

"What's your mom like?" Adora asked, quick to change the subject.

Catra lost her smile in favor of a bittersweet one, "I'd. . . rather not talk about her. She's gone now, so. . ."

"Oh. . . I, uh, I'm sorry." Glimmer said with genuine remorse. "Were you childhood friends with Adora in your time as well?"

"Yeah." Catra smiled again, "In fact, Adora is the reason I found the courage to confess my feelings."

Adora gained a slightly strained smile but nodded nonetheless. "That's cool that we're still childhood friends. Even if you didn't grow up on Etheria."

Catra had to bite her tongue just to keep from cackling. She could see right through her and how much this was bothering her. She couldn't wait to see her face when she got her Adora back. Catra stood up, "Well, let's get prepared. We need to be ready." Glimmer nodded before walking towards the door, following Catra.

"Yeah," Adora said from behind them as they left the room, her smile falling from her face, "let's, uh, let's do that."

This marks the end of Chapter One of What Happened. Sorry for the long wait. It took me forever to find the time to write this and to top it all off I had no clue how to start the chapter. But, part 2 will hopefully leave all of your questions answered. Let me know what you all think. Reviews are always welcome.

Chapter 2

As Catra, Adora, and Glimmer sat at the edge of the whispering woods, overlooking the Fright Zone, they awaited the confirmation that everyone had reached their assigned positions. Castaspella had surprised them with a stroke of genius by casting an illusion over Sea Hawk's ship, allowing them to pass into the Horde's river undetected. It did drain a lot of her magic but she assured them she could still cast offensive spells.

"*We're in position and have eyes on the Fright Zone."* Bow's voice came through the azurlight. *"Catra's info was right. The Horde's ships are all pulled in towards the mouth of the river. We managed to get past them without raising any alarms."*

"Good," Catra answered. "Glimmer and I are charged and primed. My magic is stable so far. Await the signal."

Glimmer looked at Adora with a tense look. Even the excitement of being overcharged did little to calm her nerves. This wasn't some small attack. They were attacking the heart of the Horde to save her father. A lot could go wrong. Adora gave a small nod before putting a comforting hand on her shoulder, "It's gonna be fine. We've got this."

Catra swiped her fingers across the gem, "Juliet, what's your status?"

"*We've just cleared the northern mountains and are in range of the Fright Zone."* Juliet said in a determined voice.

"Alright, standby for the signal." Catra said before touching the gem once more. "Netossa, did you rally with Perfuma?"

"*We did. We're in position."*

"Alright, be ready for the signal." Catra said before cutting the connection. She let out a deep breath before turning towards Glimmer and Adora. "Are you both ready?"

Adora nodded, brandishing her sword. Glimmer nodded, her hands glowing with magic, "We're ready."

Catra nodded before connecting an open communication, "Everyone, once you start attacking, their forces will split to reach defensive positioning. You need to maintain the offensive advantage for at least ten minutes before we can go."

A chorus or affirmatives answered her. Catra nodded with a determined look, "Attack."

Catra was bored out of her mind if not a little irate as she listened to Scorpia drone on about the colors of the Horde's armor when the alarm started blaring. Catra's crew immediately shot to their feet, "What's going on!" Lonnie yelled over the alarm.

"We're under attack!" A soldier yelled as they charged past the room before turning to Catra.

Catra looked a little shocked before her squad armored up, grabbing weapons from their lockers. Catra looked at Scorpia, "Ready them. I'm going to find out what's happening."

"You heard the woman! Battle stations everyone! . . . And where is Kyle?" Scorpia's exasperated voice followed Catra as she ran out of the room. As she maneuvered through the halls towards the Black Garnet Chamber, she noticed every squad was headed in different directions. As she entered the room, she came upon Shadow Weaver charging herself with the Black Garnet. As Shadow Weaver finished charging, she turned to find Catra walking towards her. "Which section of the rebellion is attacking and from which direction?"

Shadow Weaver motioned Catra to follow her as she strode out of the room. "All of them. From the North, East, and South."

Catra looked shocked at the information, "How did they get past the ships?"

"I don't know, but we need to hurry." Shadow Weaver said, no sign of her usual taunts. "We weren't prepared for such a large-scale attack." Shadow Weaver snaked a hand out to the hall, grabbing a passing soldier. Catra realized that it was Octavia.

"Shadow Weaver!" Octavia said in surprise at the sudden movement.

"Give me a situation report. Where am I most needed?" Shadow Weaver demanded, her body radiating power due to her recent charge.

Octavia gave a serious nod, "Right. We have confirmed sightings of several hundred troops being led by General Juliet to the northern mountain ranges with Princess Spinerella. It seems to be almost half of them. To the east are Princesses Netossa and Perfuma with the other half of the rebellion's forces. Most of the troops are headed for these areas. From the south is a single ship that has managed to slip past the blockades. We have multiple confirmed sightings of Princess Mermista, Captain Sea Hawk, the archer Bow, and the Queen of Bright Moon herself. Lorde Hordak is already headed for it as we speak."

"Why haven't we taken the ship yet?" Catra quickly asked.

"There's a skilled mage that's keeping most of our forces at Bay." Octavia held a pad out, showing the images captured, "This is what she looked like. Until this moment, we've never seen her before."

Shadow Weaver narrowed her eyes, "Castaspella." She seethed. She was no fool. This was a direct challenge on her person. She knew she would have to go here. The Queen of Brightmoon coupled with the Princess of Salineas was too much of an opportunity. She needed to head for the river. "So be it. I'm headed for the south. Catra, take your squad and go where you see fit." She said dismissively as she seemed to levitate through the halls.

As everyone went in different directions, Catra went back to the barracks only to find her squad gone. Within minutes, Catra found herself alone in the Fright Zone. Even Hordak had gone for the southern front, intent on capturing Queen Angella. She'd never seen it so quiet in the Fright Zone. If Shadow Weaver had allowed her to speak she would have told her something didn't feel right. This didn't feel like an attack. No, this felt more like. . . like a distraction.

Catra narrowed her eyes before running for Hordak's sanctum. As she got to the entrance, she quickly ran to the control panel. Under normal circumstances she'd never risk this, but she didn't have time to wait. Immediately pulling up the camera feed of the Fright Zone, she started cycling through the rooms at rapid speeds, her eyes searching for anything bright and pink. After a minute, her efforts were rewarded.

"I knew it." Catra growled before rushing for the armory.

"Woah, I've never teleported that far before." Glimmer whispered excitedly.

"Come on, we don't have time to spare." Catra D'riluth said quietly as they quickly ran to the control center for the hangar.

Adora quickly ran up to the console and started inputting a code. "I've never seen the Fright Zone so quiet before. It's almost like it's abandoned." After a moment, Adora let out a grunt of irritation, "The code isn't right."

"7-Echo-Delta." Catra said as she glanced around the hangar, searching for any signs of life.

"It worked." Adora said as the doors slid open, only to be met with a kick to the chest, sending her careening across the floor.

"Hey Adora."

"Catra." Adora said as she quickly got to her feet.

Catra D'riluth whipped around as they all turned to look at her alternate self. Besides their clothing and age, there truly was no difference between the two. Catra eyed her older self before letting out a scoff. "So you really are me from the future, huh? So what," she turned towards Adora, "you couldn't convince me to join you. . . so you replaced me?"

The tone came out cocky and uncaring, but she knew herself better than anyone in this room, maybe even better than her younger self. She was genuinely hurt by this, even if she wasn't showing it. She recognized the sense of betrayal on her face because she remembered how it felt for her when her Adora had left. "She didn't replace you."

Catra glanced at her older self, finally getting a good view of her. "No? Then why did she come back here with you?" '*without me?*' the words went unspoken.

"Believe me, this is just a dark chapter of my history that I am all too eager to leave behind. Once I've got what I need, I'm gone." She said to her younger self.

Catra narrowed her eyes at the trio standing before her but honed in on Adora, noticing she hadn't transformed yet. Glimmer gave a glare but beyond that made no move as they positioned themselves behind her older counterpart.

"She won't make a move." she said as she began to walk around her into the hangar.

"And how do you figure that?" Catra spat.

"Because I'm you. And I know for a fact that you are in the most disadvantageous position you could possibly be in right now. And because you have questions that you want answers to."

Catra seethed with a fury that could kill, but she knew she was right. She couldn't do anything right now. Not without backup. Not with Adora and Sparkles staring her down. And certainly not with her future self staring her down. She could freeze her in time like

she had with Kyle and just be done with it. As Adora and Glimmer cautiously walked past her, Adora stopped, "Catra, come with us. You can–"

"Hey! This is not the time nor the place. She's pissed off and we have something we need to do. Work out your issues with each other later." Catra D'riluth snapped.

Adora looked between the two before hanging her head and following Glimmer. Catra watched as they boarded a sky ship and for the first time, seriously considered Adora's offer, if only to talk to her future self. As it began to lift off, her older self glanced out the door at her, "Hey!" She shouted over the engine. "You probably hate me right now, but believe me, things will get better! My advice? Stop listening to Shadow Weaver!"

Catra watched as the ship flew out of the hangar, the bitter feeling of defeat battling in her gut with feelings of confusion. She wanted, no, needed to know what to do. Why had she come here? What did she want? And why go to Adora? Does it mean that Adora comes back? Catra let out a snarl as she kicked over several oil cans in anger.

Catra D'riluth held up her azurlight, "Mission was a success. We retrieved the aircraft. All units retreat."

"*Affirmative."* Juliet said.

"*You got it."* Netossa said over the line.

"Sea Hawk, be ready. We'll be there shortly."

"*Ah, well, please hurry. There is a rather intimidating individual arriving with a red cloaked woman in tow. I do believe Castaspella is running out of magic as well."* Sea Hawk said urgently.

"Hold tight." She said before killing the line.

As they quickly flew across the battlefield, Catra noticed the soldiers lining the shore while multiple ships were surrounding the Dragon's Daughter IV. Angella, Mermista, and Castaspella were desperately holding the line as Catra flew overhead. Upon the sky ship's arrival, a chorus of cheers were heard from the Horde before quickly turning to cries of shock at the sight of Adora and Glimmer.

"Man the controls, Adora." Catra said before rolling her shoulders as she stepped to the door. Angella quickly picked up Bow and Castaspella and flew them to the ship while Glimmer teleported Mermista and Sea Hawk up.

"Whatever you're about to do I suggest doing it quickly." Castaspella said in a fearful tone as the Horde's tanks began to take aim.

As every tank and weapon leveled at the ship, Catra let the magic surge through her body before throwing her hands out, baring her teeth in a yell of power. Instantly, a field of distortion encompassed the battlefield, freezing the Horde's troops.

As Adora descended the ship, Bow, Castaspella, Sea Hawk, Mermista and Angella marveled at the display of power. After boarding the ship, Adora began to pull up before Catra noticed the tanks had fired on Sea Hawk's ship. What they had failed to account for was that many of their munitions would hit their own ships as well. Narrowing her eyes, Catra held a hand out. Castaspella looked at Catra in confusion, "What are you doing?"

Catra simply said nothing as the battlefield began to rewind several seconds before the Tanks had taken aim before freezing once more. Catra lowered her hand before nodding to herself. "We're good. Let's go."

Catra quickly took the controls from Adora before flying out of range of the Fright Zone. Holding up her wrist, Catra slowed the ship to a stop above the cloud line. "Juliet, Netossa, what's your status?"

"*We successfully retreated with minimal injuries to our troops and no casualties. We're rerouting back to Bright Moon."* Juliet's voice carried through.

"*Same here."* Netossa responded. *"We're headed back to Plumeria now."*

"Alright. We're enroute to Beast Island now. If you run into trouble, keep us posted."

"*Will do."* Netossa said.

"*Affirmative."* Juliet said.

As they kicked it into overdrive, Mermista looked at Catra in confusion with a bit of anger but Adora caught Catra's attention first. As Adora glared at Catra, she raised a brow. "What?"

"She was considering it! And then you left!" Adora yelled angrily. Glimmer took a step back, choosing to remain quiet. "You said that this was when you joined the rebellion. That could have been the moment for us! For her, I mean." Adora corrected quietly.

Angella looked at Glimmer in slight confusion but Glimmer slightly shook her head.

"She chose to stay."

"You didn't give her a chance. She would have come this time." Adora seethed.

"She wouldn't have. Believe me. I know." Catra said as she piloted the ship without sparing a glance.

"Oh why? Because you're from the future?" Adora snapped.

Catra immediately pulled the ship to a halt, causing everyone to grab for anything to stabilize, before she stood up swiftly as Adora stumbled into her. Immediately catching Adora and giving her a light shove back, she nodded, "Yes, Adora. Because I'm from the

future. And I'm telling you right now that this is the exact moment before I joined you in my timeline. So believe me when I say this that no matter what you said, she wasn't going to come with us."

"Isn't this the chick who attacked my Kingdom?" Mermista asked with a bit of bite in her voice.

"Not now!" Adora snapped without looking at Mermista. "And why wouldn't she have come?"

"Because she doesn't want you to come back." Catra said in a slightly harsh tone.

Adora took a small step back in shock. "What? I-No. . . You're lying! Why wouldn't she want me to come back? For the last six months that's all she's been trying to get me to do."

Catra shook her head, a harsh chuckle on her lips. "Adora, who do you think took the fall for you when you left? It sure as hell wasn't Lonnie."

"You could have left–She can leave! She doesn't need to stay there anymore!" Adora said, correcting herself.

Catra shook her head in disbelief as she sat back down before continuing to pilot the ship towards Beast Island. Everyone remained quiet at the interaction. "I. Didn't. Want. To. Leave. What don't you get about that? I was trying to prove to myself that I was better. That I wasn't afraid of Shadow Weaver. That I was a better Force Captain than you."

"You. . .She always said she didn't care about that stuff." Adora said quietly.

"She was lying. Obviously. She didn't want to hurt you. You're the most important person in her life." Catra said, thinking about Mara's words before swiveling in her chair, giving a look of irritation, "And you threw it away, for people you knew for less than a day."

"I. . ." Adora stammered before gaining a desperate look on her face. "She doesn't understand. If she could just see–"

"No she doesn't. It took me losing all of my memories to see that. But you're not going to get that luxury. That alternate future. So, I'm going to say this to all of you in the nicest way possible." Catra said, glaring at everyone in the ship. "Stop fucking talking to me."

Catra turned around before silently speeding back up. Mermista spared a sorrowful glance at Adora before leading Glimmer and Bow to the back of the ship. "What was that all about?"

"That's Catra from an alternate future slash timeline." Bow explained. "She's helping us. For now."

"She's just pissed off. Give her a bit to cool down." Adora said with a small glare on her face before turning towards Mermista with a softer look, "I'm sorry I snapped at you."

"It's fine." Mermista said as she cast a side glance at their feline pilot. "Why's she helping though? And why's she dressed as a princess?"

"She's actually a queen." Glimmer said.

"She is?" Angella walked towards them.

"Yeah, don't you remember? Her gem thingy said so." Glimmer said.

Angella and Bow gained a look as they indeed remembered that. "What is she the queen of?"

"The First Ones." Adora grumbled, slightly irritated at the question. "She married some Eternian princess who was the King's daughter."

Jealousy much?" Mermista drawled with a raised brow.

Adora gained a look of indignation. "I'm not jealous!"

At the front of the ship, Catra's ear twitched as she eavesdropped on the conversation. The anger from the argument bled out of her as amusement began to take its place. An almost unnoticeable smirk shifted onto her face before she caught Angella looking at her through her reflection on the glass. Quickly wiping the smirk off her face in favor of a focused scowl, she continued forwards. She wished that she could see the stars.

Angella glanced between Adora who was being teased by Mermista and Glimmer as her daughter and friend's attempted to cheer her up. Her eyes began to examine Catra's attire for the first time before they locked on to her cape. White and gold. She wore a golden ring with a blue and red embellish on her left ring finger as well. Angella furrowed her brow in thought. It couldn't be. . . could it? Surely she would have mentioned it? But Adora had said that she had married an Eternian princess. Turning towards Glimmer she asked a question.

"Did Catra grow up with Adora in her time?" Angella asked.

"Why wouldn't she have? Isn't she from the future?" Mermista asked, a bit confused at the question.

"This Catra went through a weird time rewrite. . . or something. It changed their whole history. Basically, the First Ones are still alive and the Horde isn't our enemies, but our army instead. Isn't that cool!" Bow said excitedly.

"That's. . . weird to say the least." Mermista said slowly.

Sea Hawk nodded in agreement. "For sure. But I'm sure Adora can fill us in on the whole story once we get to her."

"Future Adora's here too?"

"To answer your question, yes." Glimmer said to her mom. "Apparently she was a big reason that Catra got married."

Adora gave a noncommittal sound. "Yeah, sure, whatever. Let's just focus on getting King Micah."

Angella raised a brow but said nothing. Catra and Adora were not a couple even when everything seemed to have gone their way. She could see that this bothered Adora and wouldn't tease her about such things. She knew how it felt to be unrequited in one's feelings. To get her friend back, only to have her choose someone else must have been hard to hear.

"We're coming up on Beast Island. Everyone, take a seat." Catra said before beginning to descend. After circling the island a few times, she caught sight of the rocks with a skeleton on it that Micah and Adora had mentioned but no fire in sight. Raising her azurlight, she swiped her hand across it.

"Override emergency stasis zones. Contact Adora."

After a few seconds Adora's voice carried through the azurlight. *"Catra?"*

"We're above the island. Have Micah cast a flare spell." Catra said before ending the call. After a moment of silence, a bright glowing orb shot into the sky, illuminating the beach.

"I see them." Bow said, pointing at a singular tree along a cliff.

Catra nodded before opening the ramp doors. "Angella, you're up. Grab them and bring them up. We can have a reunion once we're away from the island. It's still dangerous."

Angella nodded before flying down. Catra watched as she watched Micah envelop his wife in a hug, tears streaming down both of their faces before pulling away from one another. Angella quickly grabbed their hands before flying them up to the ship. Once Catra saw them enter the plane, she immediately flew away from the island, heading straight for Bright Moon. Putting it into auto pilot, she quickly stood up and headed for the back of the ship towards her wife.

Adora watched the reunion of Micah and Angella, Glimmer, and Castaspella with a smile before turning her attention to her future counterpart. She was also looking at her as well. She wore a long white dress with a golden trim that showed off her figure and she wore small aesthetic pieces of golden armor on her shoulders, boots, and gloves with blue gems embedded throughout her dress. A black and red cape hung from her shoulder with an almost purple embellishment along the edges with a royal design pattern. She noticed her hair was down as well. Her body was more developed and had transitioned to a woman's. She seemed sure of herself in every move she made and wore her confidence on her person.

She was in slight awe of herself if she was being honest. Everyone turned to look as Catra came into the room, quickly rushing towards Adora. Suddenly Adora found herself extremely confused as she watched Catra pull her counterpart into a kiss. Her confusion was matched by most of the occupants in the room.

"Thank Sharella you're okay! When I couldn't get ahold of you I thought–"

"It's fine, I'm fine." Adora said, hugging her wife with slight tears of happiness before pulling back a bit. "Do you remember anything that happened?"

Catra shook her head, "No. I barely even remember the wedding. We were walking towards one another and then nothing."

"We can worry about that later. I'm just glad you're alright." Adora said lovingly as Catra leaned into her touch.

"What the fuck?" Mermista said in utter bewilderment. "I thought she was married to some eternian princess."

"She is." Glimmer said in confusion. "She told us herself."

Adora Glenn turned to look at Glimmer before looking back at Catra. Catra looked away towards Adora's younger counterpart, a

wide grin on her face before letting out a laugh. "Oh, it was so worth it. You should see your faces."

"I'm lost." Adora said in confusion as she looked at Catra. "I thought you said that I, er, she helped you confess to your wife and that your wife was the princess of Eternia?"

Her future counterpart nodded, "I am the Queen of Eternia." she said before looking at Catra, "What did you tell them?" an accusing tone present.

Catra shrugged, her grin not leaving her face, "Nothing but the truth. I married the princess and you helped me realize my feelings for her."

Adora Glenn groaned, " I doubt the night before your proposal was what cemented our feelings."

Catra laughed, "Maybe not. But the morning sex aft–"

Adora elbowed her in the ribs before turning towards her younger self. "So. . . you're me. This is strange, I'm not gonna lie."

Adora struggled to ignore Catra's comment but succeeded nonetheless. "Yeah. This is probably how Catra just felt."

Catra stepped away from the group for a moment, lifting her azurlight. "Juliet, Netossa, we've got him. Mission is a success."

We've made it back to Bright Moon. Netossa and Perfuma have arrived as well. We await your return." Juliet said before pausing for a moment. *"Welcome back my King."*

The line went quiet before Catra nodded, heading back towards the pilot's ship. Suddenly she stopped. Her eyes narrowed as her ears twitched in high alert.

"Catra?" Both Adora's said in unison. They're tone caught everyone's attention before Catra held a hand up.

"Shhhhhhh." Catra said quietly as she tilted her head, the hum of the ship being the only audible thing in the air. There, to Catra's highly sensitive ears, she heard it. Breathing from the side of her. Catra turned towards the ship's passengers as she counted each person before confirming that everyone was accounted for. Silently stepping towards the hangar storage closet, she unsheathed her claws before yanking the door open, a snarl present on her face as she bared her fangs.

As everyone looked towards Catra, a small shout of fear erupted from the small closet. Catra immediately lost all signs of hostility before annoyance gave way. Snaking her hand at the intruder, she pulled them free with an irritated groan. "Really, Kyle!"

Adora Glenn raised an eyebrow in amusement before letting out a small laugh. Everyone else was less amused however. "Horde soldier!" Glimmer cried.

"Hey Catra." Kyle said nervously before yelping at Catra's glare.

Rolling her eyes before hauling him to his feet, Catra immediately shoved him into a chair, "What are you even doing in here? I know for a fact that you weren't allowed in the hangar."

Kyle looked around at the room full of rebellion soldiers and prisoners before letting out a nervous chuckle. "Funny story. Octavia had me cleaning the ships as a punishment and then someone, not naming names, decided to lock me in the closet because they thought it was funny. That may have been a few hours ago."

Catra thought about the joke and her sense of humor before deadpanning at the cadet, "Was it me?"

Kyle's nervous silence told her that she was indeed correct in her guess. Letting out a groan, she pulled her hands down her face. Letting out a sigh, she gave, in Kyle's personal opinion, a menacing glare, "Just sit there and don't move."

"Yes, Ma'am." Kyle saluted before falling silent under the scrutinizing looks of the rebellion.

Catra shook her head as she pushed the ship to fly faster towards Bright Moon. Glimmer looked at her in disbelief. "We can't bring him to Bright Moon!"

Catra nodded before a sly smirk appeared. Hitting a button, the side doors opened. Glimmer looked at her in confusion as she stood up. "You're right. That wouldn't do at all."

"Of course. . . right?" Glimmer asked in an unsure tone.

Catra clicked her tongue, "Sea Hawk, what's the procedure for 'walking the plank' as it were?" she said as Kyle gained a look of terror.

"Catra!" Adora cried in disapproval.

Catra immediately chuckled for a moment before looking at her wife, "Oh come on. You know I'm just joking. Our Kyle would have loved that."

"This isn't our Kyle." Adora admonished her.

Catra rolled her eyes before sitting back in the pilot seat, "Fine, do what you want with him. We're almost at Bright Moon anyway."

Adora mouthed at her wife in slight annoyance before turning towards Kyle. "Kyle," She smiled warmly, "It's good to see you. How are you doing? How's everything going with Rojelio?"

"Oh, y'know, things are good. Rojelio's good." Kyle's voice died down a bit as he found himself under Angella's icy glare, ushering him to be silent.

Angella looked at Angella, "Yes, Angella?"

"Glimmer, how much magic do you have left?" Angella asked as she looked at the older Adora.

"I'm still overcharged by quite a bit. Why?" Glimmer asked.

"Could you teleport this Kyle back to the Fright Zone and then back here?"

Everyone looked at Angella in shock. Of everyone to suggest letting him go, Angella was probably the last person they would have expected to suggest this. Glimmer nodded, "For sure."

Angella nodded, "Catra. Please pull the ship to a stop."

Catra gave a silent nod before doing so. After a moment, Angella gave Glimmer a nod. As Glimmer walked towards him, future Adora looked at him with a fond smile. "Tell Lonnie and Rojelio I said hi."

Kyle gave a genuine smile back, "For sure. I'll tell them Catra says hi too. And that she hasn't lost her sense of humor." He looked at his Adora before an uncharacteristic cockiness settled on his face as Glimmer went to grab him, "I'm so telling Catra that you guys get married."

Glimmer then immediately teleported Kyle away to Adora's embarrassed fury.

"Kyle is missing!" Lonnie yelled in a worried tone. She gave him shit more often than not but he was still one of her best friends. Rojelio let out a long hiss, giving away his absolute despair at the situation. If Kyle had gotten mixed up with one of the other ground troops, there was a good chance that he had been injured or worse.

This was one of the few instances that Shadow Weaver could say nothing because in reality, her wards were right to be worried. For all the hazing that Kyle received from the other troops, he still scored high enough to remain under her tutelage. As loath as she was to admit it, Kyle had his uses. Unfortunately, she was drained from the battle with Castaspella and hadn't had the chance to

recharge or she would have probably cast a search spell by this point but alas, she couldn't do much at the moment.

Scorpia looked beside herself in worry. All of a sudden, Catra came stalking into the room, a pissed off look set on her face. Lonnie rushed over to Catra, a worried look present, "Catra, have you seen Kyle? He's missing."

Catra froze mid step as she thought about the ship that she had witnessed Adora and her future self steal. Rolling her eyes, she waved a hand dismissively. "Kyle's fine."

"So he was with you then?" Shadow Weaver asked uncaringly. "Which battle did you head for? I didn't see you on the southern front."

"Neither. The battle was a diversion." Catra said as she handed a trackerpad to Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver raised an eyebrow as she looked down at the video. "They stole a sky ship." She glanced at Lonnie, "It just happened to be the one that Kyle was cleaning."

Shadow Weaver watched as Adora, the princess, and what appeared to be the future Catra sneak into the hangar before their Catra engaged them in combat. A futile effort to be sure, but a commendable one nonetheless.

"*So you really are me from the future, huh? So what, you couldn't convince me to join you. . . so you replaced me?*"

"*She didn't replace you.*" The older Catra's voice came through the video feed, causing everyone to look at the tablet in Shadow Weaver's hands.

"*No? Then why did she come back here with you?*"

"So it is Catra from the future." Lonnie muttered.

Shadow Weaver nodded, "Indeed. There's no mistaking it."

The short video ended there it seemed. Shadow Weaver wasn't a fool. Catra had purposefully cut the video short. No doubt due to a personal matter being brought up by her future counterpart. Handing back the tablet to Catra, she began to think.

"So then. . . Kyle should be fine, right? If you, er, future you has him then he'll be fine." Scorpia said, nodding.

All of a sudden, an all too familiar flash of sparkles appeared in the center of the room before Glimmer appeared with Kyle. Everyone took a step back in surprise as Glimmer shoved Kyle into Lonnie before turning towards Catra. "Fuck you." And with that, she was gone as quick as she came. Catra let out a small chuckle.

"Kyle!" Lonnie said in irritation, "Are you stupid!"

Kyle gave a nervous laugh before Shadow Weaver cleared her throat. Kyle immediately stood up and saluted, "Shadow Weaver!"

"Did you happen to garnish why they stole the sky ship?"

"Uh, maybe? I was locked in the hangar closet and didn't have the greatest view and there was a lot of yelling before future Catra found me." At Shadow Weaver's glare he continued with an anxious haste, "They went and got future Adora and someone named Micah from Beast Island. If there was any more than that, I didn't catch it."

"Micah's alive?" Shadow Weaver whispered in shock before turning away from the group. As everyone began to grill Kyle over his stupidity in locking himself in a locker, he held a hand up.

"I didn't lock myself in the closet, Catra did." Kyle said with a sly grin hovering over his face as he stepped behind Rojelio.

Catra narrowed her eyes in suspicion. He was acting way too smug. "Yeah? So what? It worked out in our favor didn't it? You got some info that helped."

"Oh, I got some info all right." he grinned, pulling Lonnie and Scorpia in front of him too.

If Catra was suspicious before, her irritation was only adding to it. "Well spit it out then!"

Shadow Weaver turned towards the squad with a raised brow, filing the new information away in her mind for later. She was curious as to what Kyle was about to say.

"Oh, it's nothing really. Just that you and Adora got married in the future." Kyle said before ducking behind the trio in front of him.

Catra's face instantly flushed as several emotions raged a war in her for supremacy before anger won out. "Yeah? You probably heard wrong." She snarled.

It was Kyle's turn to hold up *his* trackerpad as it played audio, however muffled it may be.

"*Thank Sharella you're okay! When I couldn't get ahold of you I thought–"* Catra's voice came through the tablet.

"*It's fine, I'm fine."* Adora's voice came out of the speakers. *"Do you remember anything that happened?"*

No. I barely even remember the wedding. We were walking towards one another and then nothing."

"*We can worry about that later. I'm just glad you're alright."* Adora said lovingly.

"*What the fuck?"* A voice rang out that nobody but Catra recognized. Mermista. *"I thought she was married to some eternian princess."*

"*She is. She told us herself."* Glimmer.

The audio began to cut out, no doubt due to Kyle maneuvering himself in the cramped space.

"*I'm lost. I thought you said that I, er, she helped you confess to your wife and that your wife was the princess of Eternia?"* Adora said.

Adora's voice came out once again but it sounded slightly different.*"I am the Queen of Eternia. . .What did you tell them?"*

"*Nothing but the truth. I married the princess and you helped me realize my feelings for her."*

Adora groaned, *" I doubt the night before your proposal was what cemented our feelings."*

Catra laughed, *"Maybe not. But the morning sex aft–"*

"*So. . . you're me. This is strange, I'm not gonna lie."* Adora.

"*Yeah. This is probably how Catra just felt."* Adora again.

Catra's face had turned completely red as she wanted to lunge at Kyle in anger but Scorpia wouldn't let her. "We can't kill our allies, Catra. We just got him back."

Shadow Weaver ignored the argument but Lonnie noticed her dismissal. "Shadow Weaver?"

"Well done, Kyle. You've delivered an important piece of vital information." Shadow Weaver said.

"Adora and Catra's relationship is vital?" Lonnie muttered in confusion.

"No," Shadow Weaver shook her head, "Not that. I'd already deduced that from the original video due to her clothing. I'm talking about this." Shadow Weaver said as she took the tablet, rewinding the audio.

"*I am the Queen of Eternia. . .What did you tell them?"*

"*Nothing but the truth. I married the princess and you helped me realize my feelings for her."*

"This version of Adora and Catra are not from this timeline. They are not representatives of this future." Shadow Weaver explained. "But this does pose an interesting opportunity."

"Which part?" Catra asked, her confusion prevalent.

"It means that we have two living breathing First Ones that know how to operate their technology." A voice said from their side. As they looked at the door, Hordak strode in. "And it's not just any First Ones. It's the queen's themselves."

Catra almost couldn't believe her ears when she heard what he said next.

"Force Captain Catra, you know yourself and Adora better than anybody it would seem if your counterpart's relationship is anything to go by. I am going to give you an opportunity here. You will have free reign of the Horde's resources and troops if you accept. Your mission is to either capture or convince these two to accompany you back here. Nobody but me will have a higher authority than you. Do you accept."

Shadow Weaver's eyes widened, "Lord Hordak, perhaps we should–"

Hordak silenced her with a simple glare before turning back towards Catra. Catra looked at Hordak in stunned silence. This was it. This was what she had strived for her whole life. She needed to accept, but for different reasons. She had deleted most of the video but her future self's words rang in her mind. For that's what she really was. *Her future*.

"*Believe me, this is just a dark chapter of my history that I am all too eager to leave behind*"

"I accept, Lord Hordak."

A dark red toothed grin broke out on Hordak's face.

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Grass. Soft grass. That's all Mara felt beneath her fingers as she opened her eyes. It was hard to breathe and she didn't realize why until she looked down at herself. Teela was lying unconscious on top of her.

"Teela, wake up." Mara said with a pained groan. She felt sore beyond belief. She felt like she had a bruise across her whole body.

Teela slowly opened her eyes before looking up at Mara. Immediately she shot up to stand, panic in her eyes. She looked around the area before looking back down at Mara. "What happened?" She groaned.

"I. . .I can't remember. Can you?" Mara said, straining to recall anything that may have landed them. . . wherever they were. The landscape was pretty. She swore that the trees looked familiar but she couldn't place them. The mountains in the distance looked familiar as well. She wasn't on Eternia though, that was for certain.

Teela shook her head, helping Mara stand before gesturing towards the horizon, "Does any of this seem at all familiar to you?" Teela asked.

"Yeah, but I can't place it." Mara said quietly as she looked around. As far as she could see were plains of wheat. The sky was blue which surprisingly ruled out more than a dozen planets. She narrowed her eyes as she noticed something strange about the picture in front of her. Teela seemed to notice it too. It may have

been broken and crumbled but the strange yellow line was a dead giveaway to Mara.

"Is that. . . a road?" Teela asked aloud.

"I think we're on–" Teela immediately tackled Mara to the ground as the sound of gunshot rang out through the field.

"I warned you people last time that there would be no more chances!"

"What the hell!" Mara gasped as she immediately rolled around to look at their assailant, the wheat keeping them hidden from view.

Teela looked towards the man and caught a glimpse of him. He was being flanked by two others with what looked like slightly different versions of the weapon he was carrying. Another man and a woman. She caught sight of an animal as well that looked unfamiliar to her. "What is that thing?"

"It's a dog." Mara said through clenched teeth as she summoned her sword. "We're on Earth!"

Teela looked at the three before shaking her head, "Relations be damned. They fired first."

"I agree. We can deal with the consequences later. Watch the guns. They're similar to Zed's arc thrower." Mara said before readying herself. Teela nodded.

"I'll cover you while you transform." she said before standing and holding her hand out in front of her. Immediately, the trio turned their guns towards Teela and fired.

The bullets never reached her as they seemed to stop in mid air, a slight glow around them. Teela clenched her fist before slamming her hand into the ground. Within moments, a crimson glow began racing towards their attackers. Mara stood, raising her sword in the air before chanting her words of power.

"For the power of Grayskull!" Mara instantly shifted into He-Ro before leveling her sword towards the three.

Teela's spell had hit the man, the woman, and the dog, but the initial shooter had dodged. It was as if they were suspended in air in beams of crimson light. The dog had begun to whine upon being immobilized as Teela leveled her hands at the two in a threatening manner.

The man instantly put his hands up. "Wait! Please, wait! Don't hurt them!" He begged.

Teela looked to Mara as the now much taller woman strode forward. "Why did you fire on us?"

"They're using magic, Henry!" The woman cried in shock.

"No shit." The other man, who Mara could now see looked to be about eighteen, said through clenched teeth as he struggled to move.

"I'm sorry. We've been being hounded by thieves for the last month. They've stolen from our fields more than a few times. I mistook you for them. I'm sorry." The man said with slight desperation.

Mara eyed the man before walking towards him and taking his rifle and the pistol on his belt. Once she took the rest of their guns she nodded at Teela. "You can let them go, Teela."

Teela dropped her hands, releasing the spell. They all noticed that her hands hadn't stopped glowing though. The man nodded his thanks as the dog instantly ran behind the man, its teeth bared. "My name's Peter. That's Amanda and Henry. This is Jerky."

Teela ignored the man in favor of focusing on what the woman had said. "Amanda, was it?"

She nodded a bit fearfully. "Yes, ma'am."

"Why were you so surprised to see magic?"

Mara looked over at the woman as well before noticing that they all shared a confused look between them. "Well. . . t-that's–"

"Because it's gone." Henry said, brushing himself off.

"What do you mean gone? Explain." Mara demanded.

"Just like he said, Miss. . ." Peter said, drawing out his words as he looked for a name.

"Mara." she supplied.

Peter nodded, "Mara. Magic's been gone for almost a century. Well, most of it anyways. My grandfather told me stories about magic like your friend there just did. Stories of when the Eternals arrived."

"Eternals? Are you talking about the Eternians?" Teela asked.

Amanda nodded. "Yeah. Is that what you are?" Teela gave a nod.

"My mother was Human. My father's an Eternian." Mara explained.

"Didn't think that was possible." Henry said with a raised brow. "Any time one of you tries to have a kid with a human, the baby doesn't make it for more than a week."

Teela ignored the two before focusing back on Peter. "Continue. Tell me about these stories."

"Everyone knows them. Earth was finished. All of the resources were dried up, gone, dead. Then, in a last ditch attempt, we sent two astronauts to space." Peter said.

"Marleena and Evelyn."

"Yep." Henry scoffed. "Everyone knows those names. Love 'em or hate 'em, they sure brought help." He said with some sarcasm.

Peter glared at the teen for antagonizing the eight foot tall woman with a glowing sword. He let out a breath before continuing. "Well, that's when the Eternals arrived. The whole planet of them, or what was left anyways. They wielded magic akin to what your friend just did. Apparently, they lost some war and fled. Well, over the next twenty years or so, their magic started going away. So, seeing as how it was disappearing anyways, they gathered their most powerful sorcerers and banded together to cast a spell on the planet, instantly revitalizing all corners of the earth and breathing life back into it. With that last great deed, the magic was gone. Until today it seems."

Mara glanced at the man before looking at Teela. "That. . . doesn't make any sense."

"No. It doesn't. And they're not lying either. I cast a truth spell when they weren't looking." Teela said before turning back towards the trio, "Why are you calling them Eternals?"

"As far as we can tell they don't age. They're all over the planet in their little golden cities along with whatever other freaks they have along with them." Henry spat.

Mara looked a little shocked at the teenager's anger. "Why are you so angry? They fixed Earth, didn't they?"

"Yeah and took it over while they did it." Henry scoffed before a look of pity settled on his face, " The fact that you look so lost tells me you've no idea what I'm talking about. Least we know you won't take our shit. Can't account for her though." he pointed towards Teela. "I had you pegged for an Eternal the moment I saw you."

"They. . . We don't do that. Eternia has always helped. This doesn't make any sense!" Mara said in irritation. "Marleena sent help to Earth and fixed it. That was it. They didn't take it over."

Teela put a hand on Mara's shoulder. "Mara, I don't think this is our Earth." she said quietly, "Listen to what they're telling us.

Magic's gone here. We need to talk to someone in charge."

Mara looked at Teela before looking back at the slightly frightened trio. "We're sorry for intruding on your land. We'll leave you be. Come on Teela." She said before shifting back to herself.

Teela nodded before beginning to follow Mara away from the humans. Amanda looked at Peter and Henry nervously before stepping forward, "Wait a second! If you help us, I can give you a ride to the nearest city."

"Amanda!" Henry yelled in anger. "We don't need their help."

"Yes, we do! It's not just our farm Henry. It's George's, Sam's, John's. If this keeps up and word gets out, it'll attract more thieves looking for an easy mark. What happens when they start stealing Rachel's cars?"

"What do you need help with?" Mara asked.

Peter let out a sigh, "Those thieves that we thought you were? They've been raiding the farms around town and taking food and clothes. Nothing valuable and not a lot but if it keeps up, it could get worse."

"It's three women from what we could tell. Eternals. We thought you were one of them due to your skin color." Amanda said. "When you got closer, we realized we were wrong."

"They wore the same type of clothing you're wearing. One is a black woman with dreads with a laser gun. The next one is a blonde woman. She has a strange spear that glows. And then there's the blue elf with a bladed whip." Henry huffed, irritated at the circumstances.

'That sounds like–" Mara began.

"It sounds like Andra's squad." Teela said before looking at the disgruntled man before waving her hand, casting an illusion. "Are these three the women you speak of?"

Amanda nodded along with Peter. Henry sneered, "Yeah, that's them. Couldn't make out their faces before this though. Friends of yours?"

Mara chose to ignore the comment, "If they're here we need to find them. If Adora or Catra is with them then we can figure out what happened."

Teela nodded in agreement before turning towards Peter. "Do you know where they might be?"

"The townspeople have a few guesses but the biggest one is that they're holed up in a cave a couple miles north of here. It's beside the river. You can't miss it." Peter explained.

Teela nodded before casting a sigil in the air before launching it. It was somewhere between a firework and a flare. It swirled in the air, giving a clear signal to anyone who knew what to look for.

Henry looked up in shock before taking a threatening step forward, "What was that! What did you just do!"

Mara put her hands in front of her, attempting to calm him down, "It was simply a homing beacon for the Royal Guard. If they're near be then they'll head towards it."

"Henry, calm down." Peter said firmly.

"No! This is ridiculous! We're already having problems with the food seizures and now we can't even fight back because they have magic." Henry shouted in outrage.

"As soon as our friends show up, we'll leave. We won't take anything from you or your town. We swear." Mara said with as much sincerity as she could muster.

Henry looked like he wanted to push the issue but remained silent. His glare didn't waiver even a little. After a moment of silence he nodded, "Fine." He spat, "But then I want you gone."

"Of course." Teela said.

For the next half hour they waited in silence. The air was thick with a tension that seemed almost painful. Mara wasn't sure what to make of these Eternians but she knew that if she found out that these people were telling the truth, she'd make sure she put a stop to it.

As they sat in the meadow silently, a rustling caught their attention. Turning towards the tree line, Mara squinted, noticing a flash of golden hair. "Lyra? Is that you?"

Instantly, upon hearing Mara's voice, three women stepped out of the trees. "Mara? Teela?"

True to Henry's words, it was indeed their friends. They looked a little worse for wear, but no less capable. Andra stepped towards Mara, eyeing the three behind her. "Mara, it's good to see you. Do you know what happened?"

Mara pulled them into a hug. "Andra, Caitlyn, Lyra, It's good to see you all. To answer your question, no. We were at the wedding and then. . ."

"Nothing, right? Like it's stripped from your memory?" Caitlyn stepped back, answering with concern.

Teela nodded, "Yes. We just woke up before these three. . . filled us in where we were. Is Catra with you, by any chance?"

"You mean attacked you?" Lyra said scathingly.

Amanda looked at the blonde, realizing that she was much younger than the others. She couldn't have been more than sixteen.

"Gee, I wonder why we attacked them. Could it be that we thought they were *thieves*?" Henry asked, condescendingly.

"Fuck you! We stole only enough to eat and it was never enough to set you back." Lyra snapped.

"Lyra enough." The blue woman said sharply.

"But Caitlyn, he–"

"Is right. We should not have stolen." Caitlyn said.

"No one was telling us anything! They all ignored us like we were the scum of Eternia." Lyra cried in indignation.

"I wasn't aware there was anything but." Henry shot back.

Lyra's eyes flashed dangerously as she slammed her spear in the dirt, an ethereal blue glow shimmering off the blade. "You wanna repeat that?"

"Henry!" Peter snapped in anger, "Enough!"

"Lyra, go cool down!" Andra commanded.

"Prick." Lyra muttered under her breath as she stalked away from the group.

Henry guaranteed in annoyance before giving a sharp whistle, "Come on Jerky."

The dog immediately followed the angry teen. As their respective groups watched them both walk in opposite directions, Mara looked at Amanda and Peter. "I'm sorry about her. She's. . ."

"They're teenagers." Peter said dismissively. "You three never hurt anyone and from the looks of your weapons, you very much could have. It's fine."

Teela looked at the group before turning towards Amanda, "Where is the nearest Eternian city?"

"It's about three hours west of here by car. One if you use a sky craft." Amanda answered.

"You have a sky craft?" Mara asked.

"Ha, that's funny. No. It belongs to the Envoy of New Tahryn. He's the asshole who collects the 'tax' as it were." Amanda explained.

"New Tahryn, huh?" Andra remarked on the name of the city, "I take it that the tax is unreasonable?" Andra surmised.

"No," Peter shook his head, "It's actually quite fair. 7.6 percent for all households."

"How does your village make such a profit to support that tax with only farmland?" Teela asked in slight shock.

"It's not just farms. We have extremely good mechanics as well as manufacturing plants." Amanda said. Peter nodded in agreement.

"Our town does pretty good but it's come on hard times over the last two years."

"So it's the Envoy, then." Andra said with clear disdain.

Peter nodded, "He's been taking more than we can handle. He charges us just enough that we can eat and do our jobs."

"But too much so that you can't get anywhere to report him." Mara finished in slight anger.

Amanda nodded solemnly. "We make sure the kids are taken care of, but it's starting to affect others in more drastic ways."

Peter put a comforting hand on her shoulder before looking back at Teela. "I don't mean to pry, but if I may ask, who is Catra? You've said that name a few times now."

"Catra D'riluth and her wife Adora Glenn are the Queens of Eternia." Andra answered in a commanding tone.

"Glenn?" Peter muttered under her breath.

"Oh." Amanda said in a small voice of shock. "And, uh, who are you people exactly?"

"We are her majestys' royal guard." Lyra said with pride in her voice as she strode back towards the group.

Peter looked confused before speaking up, "I hadn't realized that Queen Marleena had a daughter."

"Well, this sounds familiar." Mara muttered before speaking up, "It's complicated."

Peter nodded, a little unsure, "And you two?" He asked Mara and Teela.

"I am the Eternian High Mage." Teela said.

"Technically, I'm an ambassador of peace for the Eternian Empire." Mara explained. "Although, that's a bit complicated."

"So you're basically an Eternal cop?" Amanda asked with what Mara assumed was a hint of hope.

Mara nodded, "I've been sent to dispatch justice before. I very much can act as law enforcement. I take it you want us to have some words with this man?"

Peter nodded, "If you really are the Royal Guard and High Mage then you could report him."

"The man's name is Lizorr. He's pretty hard to miss. Fortunately, he should be here sometime this week. We've gotten pretty good at keeping track of him." Peter said.

"Scaled freak." Henry spat as he came to stand beside Amanda and Peter. "Him and his brother, Hoove, are among the worst types of people."

"Lizzor? Scaled? Are they reptilian by chance?" Lyra asked.

"Yeah. Creepy looking too." Amanda added.

"It sounds like they're mutants from Denebria." Lyra guessed before turning towards Teela.

Teela gave a nod, "I figured that too."

Mara gave a nod before turning towards Teela and Andra. "Let's deal with this guy first. We can use his sky craft to get to New Tahryn."

"Agreed. But we should make it a priority to locate Queen Adora and Queen Catra as soon as possible." Caitlyn said with a slight nod.

Ugh, I hate when I can't write for a while. Especially when work gets in the way. But enough about that! I hope you all enjoyed Chapter two. It took a bit but I finally finished it. Let me know your thoughts.

Chapter 3

Catra D'riluth looked out at Eternia's ocean as she listened to the sounds of the waves lazily hitting the shore. She hadn't been to Eternia in almost two years so when she had an opportunity to slip away, she'd taken it. The sand of this beach always felt so warm. It never failed to elicit an almost nostalgic feeling from her.

The gentle sands were always the best part. She loved this beach. The driftwood that drifted onto the golden shores. The soft breeze that carried the smell of salt like a sweet perfume. And the softly rolling waves that could be the most welcoming sight or easily switch to the towering waves that yelled out into the gusting winds.

The sun was beginning to go down and the light reflected off the water in a gorgeous way. Catra took a deep breath, savoring the peace and quiet. It was her fifteenth birthday today but all she wanted to do was stay out here, away from everyone while it ended.

"*Catra!" A happy voice yelled out. Well, almost everyone.*

Catra barely had any time to turn towards the familiar voice before she was tackled into a hug. A grin broke out on her face at the sight of her assailant. A whole year since she'd seen her and she was still wearing that stupid hairstyle.

"*Hey Adora." Catra said with a smirk that showed off her fangs. "How've you been?"*

Adora rolled off of her best friend down as she looked her up and down before stifling her laughter. "What are you wearing?"

"*Really? A whole year and that's the first thing you ask me?" Catra asked in a fake offended tone. But in truth, she was right. These clothes were horrible. She let out a groan at Adora's look of*

expectancy. "Mom made me wear it. Something about upholding our traditions in front of King Randor."

Adora leet out a snort, "Like my dad cares what you wear to dinner. You could wear a wool tunic and I doubt he'd say anything besides 'Oh, Catra, it's so good to see you.'" Adora said dramatically.

Catra grinned, "That's what I said. But nooo, mom says we have to 'set an example.'" Catra's smile faltered a bit at the mention of her mother before pushing those thoughts away. "So what have you been up to in the last year?" She asked as she took off the stupid overcoat that her mother had forced her to wear.

Adora let out a groan of her own. "My parents won't leave me alone. They're always hovering around me and it's irritating. It's like. . .like they–"

"*Won't give you any space?" Catra supplied as she turned her focus on the waves.*

Adora let out a grunt, "Exactly! They're my parents and I love spending time with them but I just want a little privacy."

"*Don't I know it." Catra muttered as they settled into a comfortable silence before Adora pulled out a small box from behind her before holding it out. "Happy Birthday Catra."*

Catra took the box with a smile. She didn't particularly care what was in the box. Seeing Adora after a whole year was a gift enough but she accepted it nevertheless. "Thanks. . ." As Catra opened it, she pulled out what looked like a metal headpiece. It was dark red in color and had two small black markings on the front of it. It seemed a little familiar. "I think? What is it?"

"*It's armor. I overheard my mom talking to C'yra that you'd been getting into weapons and armor. I saw that and thought it looked like something you'd wear." Adora said before an almost unnoticeable trace of vulnerability entered her voice. "Do you like it?"*

Catra turned it around before frowning, "It's cool Adora but. . ."

"*But what?" She asked with concern.*

"*I think it's cracked. See–"*

"*What? No, it wasn't when I bought–" Adora reached out before catching the smirk on her friend's face. Giving her a playful shove, Adora sat back down.*

"*I love it. Thank you." Catra said before putting it on. "How do I look?"*

Adora looked Catra up and down and for the first time, began to think that she might be looking at her friend in a slightly more intimate manner. With her coat off, Catra was left only wearing a sleeveless shirt that hugged her body, showing off her arms that had begun to display tonnage over the last year. Her hair had gotten spikier and much longer than she remembered. But Adora's focus was mainly on her eyes. Her eyes seemed to radiate warmth. The golden glow of the evening's sun reflected off of the deep blue waves seemed almost a dim comparison.

Adora cleared her throat before laying back in the sand, her face alight, "You look good. It really suits you."

Catra gave a smile that did little to calm Adora's nerves before putting her gift back in its box. All of a sudden, Catra dived into the sand beside Adora, wrapping her arms around her and burying her head into her shoulder, "I missed you. Like, a lot."

Adora pulled her closer, a gentle smile on her lips. "I missed you too." As they gently dozed off in the sand, basking in one another's warmth, the sun set on the horizon, giving way to the gentle glow of the Eternian flora.

Catra D'riluth awoke to a knocking on her room's door. Sitting up, groggily, she glanced at the balcony door only to be greeted by a starless night sky. She could hear the slight sounds of morning

and smell the dew on the balcony flowers. She guessed that she had maybe an hour left before the morning overtook the night. Another gentle knocking at the door disrupted her thoughts. Gently freeing her arm from Adora's sleeping figure, she grabbed a robe from the closet before walking towards the door. As she quietly opened the door, she was surprised to see Angella was the one knocking.

"I'm sorry to disturb you but may I talk to you for a moment?" Angella asked softly, as to not disturb Adora.

Catra glanced back at her wife's sleeping form before nodding and stepping into the hall, closing the door. Upon looking at the woman, Catra didn't fail to notice the disheveled state of the queen and how she was more or less wide awake. She also caught the faint scent of sex on her. It was understandable in her opinion. Perhaps it was because she had just woken up or maybe she just wasn't in the mood, either way, Catra bit back the snarky remark she would have normally said and settled for a smirk as she looked at the woman.

Angella's face lit up in a blush before she smoothed her hair and cleared her throat. Catra let out a small laugh. "Ya know, I knew my Angella for just over a month before the time rewrite stuff and I could never get a reaction out of her. She was extremely fast with a retort no matter what I tried. Seeing you flustered is a bit of a treat."

Angella tried to fight the genuine smile from appearing on her face only to fail horribly. "I assure you, I am very quick with a word but you've just barely caught me this time." Angella's smile dropped before she took a slightly more serious look, "I will let you get back to bed in a moment. I just wanted to ask you one thing."

Catra raised an eyebrow, "Yeah, sure. What's going on?"

"Castaspella just returned to Mystacour for the eclipse yesterday and I just wanted to know if anything of note happens for the

next couple of days." Angella asked.

Catra caught the slight desperation in the woman's tone. She realized that the real question she was asking was, 'How much time do I have left to relax with my husband?' Catra leaned against the door, closing her eyes in thought as she tried to remember. It had been two days since their mission to Beast Island.

"*How are you doing? We haven't been able to speak for almost three weeks now." Shadow Weaver said.*

"*Two." Catra said.*

"*I'm sorry?" Shadow Weaver asked.*

"*It's been about two weeks. 12 days to be precise."*

Catra let out a breath, "You have eleven days of peace. On that eleventh day, Adora and Glimmer will perceive their invites to Princess Prom."

Angella gained a smile of relief before nodding. "Thank you, Catra."

Catra shrugged, "It's fine."

Angella shook her head, "It's not. When you got here yesterday, everyone cast suspicion on you. Me, most of all. Even with my husband vouching for you I still had the thought of it being a trap, a trick. That you were lying and that was the end for the rebellion. For that, I am truly sorry."

Catra put a comforting hand on her shoulder, "Angella, it's fine. Really. Don't worry about it. Enjoy yourself. You just got Micah back."

Angella gave a grateful nod before leaving Catra to head back to bed. Catra let out a breath before closing the door. Taking a

glance at Adora, Catra shook her head. There was no way she was getting back to sleep. Instead, she headed for the shower.

The sound of running water coupled with the morning rays peeking over the horizon roused Adora from her sleep as she sat up, letting out a yawn. As Adora blinked the sleep away, she heard the water stop. As Catra strolled out of the bathroom, holding only a towel, Adora let out an appreciative smile. Catra immediately turned towards Adora, a smirk on her face.

"Hey Adora." She said teasingly. Adora smiled before standing, quickly heading towards her wife. Catra quickly danced out of the way. "And just what do you think you're doing?"

"I'm trying to kiss the love of my life." Adora said, laughing.

Catra let out a joyful sound, wrapping herself with a towel. "Not with that breath you're not. And most certainly not smelling like that. I just showered."

Adora would not be denied, though. With loving abandon, she quickly tackled Catra onto the bed before laying several kisses on her face. As Catra's hands began to wander, her ears picked up the sounds of rapid footsteps and their door being rushed open. In a quick burst of speed, Catra threw the blankets over Adora before grabbing her towel and doing her damndest to cover herself, albeit unsuccessfully.

'Guys, you have to get out here. King Micah is–Oh my gosh!" Bow exclaimed before instantly turning around in embarrassment as Adora and Glimmer accompanied him into their quarters. Glimmer gained a look of confusion before instantly turning around as well. Adora might have let her gaze linger a bit if not for the very pissed off expression that Catra wore at that moment as she stood in front of her older counterpart.

"Is it not customary on this Bright Moon to knock?" Catra slightly snarled.

"We're sorry! We didn't– We, uh, we'll let you get dressed." Glimmer said in embarrassment before dragging Adora out of the room with Bow.

Catra let out a breath before Adora looked at her in concern. "Are you alright Catra?"

Catra shook her head as she quickly got dressed, "No. Actually, we need to talk about this. I'll let you get bathed and dressed. Meet me in the dining hall."

Adora nodded before heading for the showers.

Earth

The Kingdom of Illium, capital of Earth

The city was bustling with life as the people began their day. It was a sight to behold. The city was alive with the spark of progress. Different species all working together to further the planet's growth. In just one hundred and fifty years they had taken Earth to new heights in technology. Humanity couldn't afford a repeat of their mistakes. It was a necessity that required the Eternians to establish dominance upon whatever pieces of humanity were left with the loss of magic. . . until today it would seem.

"My Prince! My Prince! I must speak with you at once!" A young man shouted, running up only to be stopped by the guards.

The man raised a hand, giving the guards the signal for the man to approach, "What is it?"

"The arcana have been activated." He said in a serious tone.

Instantly, the room went quiet. Everyone turned to look at the man. The Prince slowly stood up, "You're sure? It wasn't a false

alarm?"

"No, my Prince. I assure you, it was no accident. We have detected magic on Earth." He said seriously.

The Prince turned away as thoughts of their lost civilization filled his mind. He turned back towards the man, a scowl on his face, "Where? And when?"

"Two days ago near New Tahryn. We've pinpointed it in a small town about a day's ride from Tahryn by sky craft."

"That sounds like Shroudwood." A guard said quietly.

"It could be Boroughville as well," Another guard said.

The man nodded, "Yes, we believe that's where it originated from. But. . . there's something else as well."

"What is it?" He asked, turning a serious expression on the man.

"We've picked up heavy dimensional readings. Trace energies reminiscent of distortions in time and space have been detected around New Tahryn as well. They're almost identical to, well, Despondos and not in a good way. My prince. . . the barrier is cracked."

The Prince nodded silently before turning to one of his guards, "Duncan, inform my mother of what has happened. We will be going personally to investigate this matter."

Duncan nodded, "At once, your grace."

Mara sat at a table in the local bar, eating a piece of pizza. Alongside her were Andra, Teela, Lyra, Caitlyn, and Peter. Looking around, she realized the actual cultural differences of this planet were exactly as her mother had described to her when she was growing up. She looked across the table at Peter, "So, when is this Lizzor guy supposed to show up?"

"It should be today." He said simply as he took a sip of his beer.

Mara nodded before Andra decided to ask a different question. "If I may ask this, what can you tell us about the King and Queen?"

Peter sat back, "Well, for starters, King Randor died a few years back. He was a good enough man I suppose. He tried his best to be fair, but. . ." He let out a sigh, "I guess there's only so much kindness you can have after losing your whole planet."

"Randor's dead?" Lyra muttered in shock. "I thought they didn't age here?"

"It was more from grief, I'd imagine." Peter shrugged with a sigh.

"What do you mean?" Mara asked.

"Seventeen years ago there was. . . an incident of some kind. The details elude us out here. But it was big enough news at the time that we even heard about it out here. His wife, Marleena Glenn is currently ruling. Poor woman. Unlike her son and husband, she is still only human and losing her husband is taking its toll. Although the magic extended years on her lifespan, she's getting older. You wouldn't know it by looking at her, though. Doesn't look a day past forty. I guess that's the marvels of modern medicine."

"Did you say son? Marleena had a son? I thought Henry said hybrid children die?" Teela asked.

Peter smiled. "I did and Henry is correct to an extent. The prince is a special case. Apparently, he is the last wielder of magic left in the universe according to the few Eternals I've spoken to. Don't know how true that is though. But he's a good man and is soon to inherit the throne. A kind person and a just leader. He'll be the best thing that could happen to Earth. Once his wedding is arranged, he will take the mantle of ruler from his mother and become king."

"Huh? What's his name?" Mara asked with curiosity.

"His name is Adam. And you people aren't fit to lick his boots." A low guttural voice hissed from the door. Upon turning, Mara immediately realized that she was looking at Lizzor, "Peter, good to see you. But I've run into a problem. See, I can't, for the life of me, find the shipment anywhere. So, I find myself wondering what excuse you've come up with."

Peter said nothing for a moment as he sipped his beer, a cold expression on his face before he spoke without sparing a glance at the lizard man. "We're not paying you anymore."

Lizzor gave an incredulous look before a scoff sounded from his lips, "Is that so?"

"Yep, that's so." Peter said as he finished his beer before finally sending the most hate filled glare that Mara had ever seen.

Lizzor nodded before he snarled, lunging at the older man.

Marleena remained quiet as they landed in the small town of Shroudwood. When her son had informed her of a detection of magic she had chosen not to get her hopes up. When he had immediately informed her after that traces of dimensional energies that resembled Despondos had been detected as well. . . well, now she was extremely invested in what the cause might be.

Marleena smiled as she stepped off the ship. She took notice of the Sky Craft in the hangar across from theirs. Tahryn's tax collector. She thought she heard her son mumble something to the guards about a possible late payment due to the undocumented timing.

Shaking her head, they began to head through the main street. In two hundred years, humanity was finally beginning to look like itself once more. Civilization was flourishing albeit somewhat slower than she would have liked. She let out a sigh of exasperation when she saw a truck driving off in the distance. Two hundred years of scientific advancement and humans chose

to design a vehicle that looked so. . .*human*. A fuzzy nostalgic feeling settled in her core with a warmth. It reminded her of her childhood if she were being honest. The energy crisis had been solved and soon. . . soon they would be able to reclaim the universe away from that monster.

As they walked down the street, Marleena stepped towards one of the residents of the town. A man who looked to be in his thirties carrying lumber. He stopped and turned towards her, giving a respectful nod, but not quite a bow. Her son stepped forwards, a hand extended, "Good afternoon. I'm Adam Glenn."

The man nodded, shaking his hand, "William Barlow. You can call me Will." He eyed the guards before turning his gaze on Marleena. The slight widening of his eyes told them that he realized who he was speaking to. He looked at all of them before giving them his full attention.

"Well, it's not everyday we get a visit from Illium. And most certainly not the Queen and her son. What can I do for you, ma'am?"

Marleena smiled. She had noticed it ever since coming back to earth. Humans would not bow to the Eternians and they would hardly ever use their titles. Alternatively, the Eternians would only speak to high ranking officials by their standing. It was a cultural thing that intrigued her. "I'm looking for the representative for your town. Peter Moore, I believe his name is? We. . .picked up some concerning readings and we just want to make sure that your town is safe."

Will sighed, "Here I was thinking Lizzor finally got caught."

"Lizzor? That name isn't human." A woman said from behind Marleena. Teela, daughter of Duncan and soon-to-be queen. Marleena thought quite highly of the young woman and approved of her son's choice.

Will's brow furrowed in confusion as he stared at Teela dumbfounded before looking behind him at a building. "I thought. . . Weren't you one of those girls?"

It was Teela's turn to look confused. "I'm sorry?"

"Do you have a sister? You look just like that girl. . . Tula, I think her name was."

"I am Teela not Tula. What other girl are you talking about?"

Will shook his head, "Sorry, I thought you were the magic woman."

"Magic?" Teela said in confusion.

The whole town's talking about her and the other one for the last two days. There's three others that said they're a part of a royal guard as well. Don't really know the specifics."

"Then the arcana was right." Adam said seriously, "Magic was detected near here. You said there was another woman?"

"Yeah. Dark skinned girl. According to Henry she was glowing and was close to ten feet tall." He said, shaking his head, "That girl was barely six feet tall."

Several of the guards immediately looked at Marleena at the description. Marleena looked at the man in shock before interrupting. "What was her name?"

"Oh, I don't know. Mandy, Milly, Mia. Something like that?"

Duncan spoke up from the side, "Was it Mara?" He asked quietly.

"Yeah, that sounds right. Last I heard, they're all down at Leslie's bar with Pete." Will said, flicking his head to the side.

"Where is the bar?" Adam asked.

A sudden crash had every guard brandishing their weapon as a large reptilian man flew through a window and into the street. Every person in the town square turned to watch the event.

"That's the bar." Will said simply before walking away towards a group of people.

Lizzor groaned before shakily getting to his feet. After a moment, a woman stepped out of the bar, calmly striding towards the man. After a moment, four other women joined the first. Marleena immediately identified three of them. Mara was unmistakable for anyone else. Teela, or a woman who bore an uncanny resemblance, stood in the back before tapping the bar wall and causing the glass to fix itself. The magic woman was this Teela look alike it would seem. The third was clearly Andra, one of her son's close friends. She was also currently standing next to her as well. So this bore a question that was anything but simple. Was she dealing with time travel or multiverse theory?

"*Adora! Wake up! The ceremony."*

Adora sat up in a panic before instantly getting to her feet, doing their best to brush the beach sand off. Catra immediately took Adora's hand before warping as close as she could to the palace, only getting to the outer edges of the city. As they ran through the main road, Catra took note of the time. An hour before midnight. She wasn't just late, they had completely missed it. As they entered the palace, Adora went and stood off to the side, looking for any sign of her parents. Catra, on her part, walked up to the chamber door where her mother was. There, she heard a tone from her that she wished she was less familiar with.

"*C'yra! Get in here now!"*

Catra hesitantly walked forwards, her shoulders hunched in apprehension as she avoided eye contact with her mother. As she stepped in front of her, she stayed quiet, knowing that she could

say nothing that would help the situation she had landed herself in.

"*Where have you been?" She hissed. "Don't be late. That was all I said to you. Instead, you chose not to even show up! Do you have anything to say for yourself?" After a moment of silence, C'yra grabbed Catra's chin, forcing her to look at her. "C'yra D'riluth, you will look at me when I talk to you. Now answer me. And what happened to your coat? It's filthy."*

"*I fell asleep." Catra said quietly, her eyes flicking off to the side. Her mother took a deep breath before wiping something off Catra's shoulder.*

"*At the beach, I see. Why am I not surprised?" C'yra shook her head. Catra grip tightened on the box in her hands as she waited for the verbal lashing to end. Unfortunately, this caught her mother's attention. "What's that?"*

"*It's just a gift." Catra said, pulling the gift closer to herself and away from her mother.*

C'yra let out a huff, "It smells like metal. Is it a weapon?"

Catra's eyes narrowed as anger began to fill her. "So what if it was? It's not your business."

"*You are not a soldier, C'yra. You are a celestial child and to be the next queen of Half Moon." C'yra said harshly. "And I'm your mother, so it makes it my business."*

"*Well it shouldn't." Catra snapped. "And I don't care about what moon I was born under.."*

"*You need to!" C'yra said sharply. "If your father were here he'd–"*

"*He wouldn't do anything. He gave less of a shit about me then you do!" Catra exclaimed, pointing at her mother. C'yra snatched the box out of Catra's outstretched hand in anger.*

"*Don't speak about him like–." C'yra paused at the feeling of the box's contents before looking at the box.*

"*Give it back!" Catra said in anger. C'yra ignored her and opened the box. As C'yra pulled out the red headpiece, a look of fury appeared on her face that was so potent, Catra would forever remember it.*

"*Who gave you this!" She snarled in rage that caused Catra to take a step back. Her words were loud enough for Adora to catch them, even outside the door.*

"*N-nobody. It was just one of the gifts from the table." Catra stammered.*

C'yra looked at Catra coldly before throwing the red headwear on the ground before sending a spell at it, instantly destroying it. Catra gave a small gasp before gritting her teeth in concentration, rewinding to the moment before she entered the door.

Immediately, Catra collapsed to her hands and knees, exhausted at the rare usage of her newest ability. Everyone in the hall stopped and stared at the commotion.

"*Catra" Adora cried in concern before kneeling down beside her, unaware of what had just transpired.*

C'yra strode out of the chamber door before looking down at Adora and Catra. "Her name is C'yra, Adora. Use it. Not that silly little nickname you made when you were five."

Adora immediately stepped in between Catra and her mother, a defiant anger on her face. "What did you do to her!"

"*I gave her a lesson on her responsibilities. Do not embarrass us like this again, C'yra."*

Adora's eyes flashed a dangerous blue that gave C'yra pause, as she stood defensively in front of Catra. "This day isn't about you! It's Catra's *birthday," Adora snarled, enunciating the usage of her*

name, "She can choose how to spend it. And stay away from her! Just because you're feeling sorry for yourself because your husband died, doesn't give you the right to take it out on her."

By this point, Adora was emitting a golden glow along her body that everyone in the room knew the meaning of. The power of She Ra coupled with a very angry teenager was a one way ticket to disaster. Immediately, people began leaving the hall, the hushed whispers of gossip already on their tongues.

C'yra narrowed her eyes before the doors slammed open, giving way to King Randor. "What is the meaning of this!"

Adora barely shifted, her gaze remaining fixed on C'yra, even in the face of her father's anger. C'yra on the other hand gave a small jump at the booming voice. Marleena was quick to follow her husband through the door, Evelyn in tow. Adora was quick with the reply before anyone could reply. "She's being a colossal bitch!"

"Adora!" Marleena scolded, upset at her daughter's language.

Randor looked at his daughter as she stood in front of her friend, protectively. He wasn't a fool. He knew how C'yra was. He didn't know how his wife and Evelyn could get along so well with the woman. She was respectful, he'd give her that but that was about it. The magicats stood on ceremony more than most and he could guess what this was over. But he would be lying if he said this didn't spark his anger in the worst way. Taking a calming breath and keeping his thoughts calm, he looked to Catra, "Are you alright?"

Catra nodded before shakily getting to her feet with Adora's help.

C'yra looked at her daughter before letting out a small breath. "It seems the lesson was learned. Oh, and C'yra?" Catra looked up at her mother with an exhausted expression, "When I ask you a question, do not lie to me. I was well aware of who gave you that gift. I know when you're lying. But worst of all, I gave you the

chance to come clean, to take responsibility. This was a test. And you failed. Enjoy the rest of your birthday." She said before striding out of the palace, leaving Catra and Adora alone with her parents and Evelyn.

Randor looked at Catra, "I'm sorry Catra."

Catra waved him off, her breathing back to normal albeit with a migraine forming. "It's fine. It's nothing new." Catra muttered. Although, in the quiet hall, she may as well have shouted.

Randor turned towards Evelyn, "Can you take Catra to get something to eat?"

"*Of course." Evelyn nodded before walking with Adora and Catra out of the room.*

As soon as they were out of earshot, Randor immediately lashed out in anger, kicking one of the feast tables over. Marleena just let out a sullen sigh. "How can you get along with that woman!"

Marleena shook her head, "You know she wasn't always like that."

"*I know." Randor said with gritted teeth. "Which is why I just can't understand why she is treating her daughter this way. She has taken every opportunity to do this ever since Catra was twelve. And why does she have such an issue with that name? Her hobbies aren't up to her standards? And it's not like Thrao was ever a father to the girl." He growled before shaking his head. "Thank Sharella for Percival."*

"*I know. But we can't interfere. She's not our daughter, Randor." Marleena said, giving a comforting squeeze to his arm before walking out of the room.*

Randor gave a nod, before a small smile broke out on his face, "If Adora has it her way, she will be soon." he said quietly.

As Catra and Adora sat with Evelyn, enjoying their food, a guard came into the room. "Princess Adora? Your father would like to speak with you."

Adora gave a comforting smile to Catra before leaving with the guard. As Catra sat with Evelyn, she wanted to broach the subject that she'd been dying to ask for the last year. Right when she'd found the nerve to ask, a woman entered the room. She wasn't Eternian, Catra could see that right away. She gave off a sense of power but one that was warm and inviting. She'd never seen this woman before.

"*Ah, Beatrix. What can I do for you today?" Evelyn asked.*

"*Just came to deliver a report on the incense trade. Apparently, several of the containers were found to be faulty. We've taken care of them but I suggest a full overhaul." Beatrix said before conjuring the papers in her hands.*

"*Paper? Not tech?" Catra asked in slight confusion.*

Beatrix turned towards the young woman, "Yes. I'm from Etheria. While we have a good advancement of technology, we at Mystacour find that paper is still superior in messages. It's quite hard to fake a magical signature in the ink. You must be the infamous C'yra I've heard about over the last couple of hours. I'm Beatrix."

"*Beatrix here is one of the few sorceresses to hold the title of Light Spinner, a master of light magic. She has also just recently gained the title of head sorceress at the Academy of Mystacour on Etheria." Evelyn explained.*

Catra had heard of Mystacour. One of the most prestigious magic schools in the universe. Unless you were born Etherian, you needed an invite. A thought came to her just then that was evolving into a plan. "Are you still a teacher at Mystacour?"

Beatrix shook her head. "Unfortunately no. I left it to Norwynn to continue in my place. Recently, I've come to Eternia to widen my

studies in magic. Why do you ask?"

"*Could. . . could you teach me magic?" Catra asked, doing her best to ignore the headache that was still very much present..*

Evelyn's eyes widened. "Catra, that's. . . a big request. You can't just ask that out of nowhere."

"*I know, but if I can learn magic, especially from the head sorceress of Mystacour then–"*

"*I can teach you magic." Beatrix said bluntly.*

"*-my mom– What? You will?" Catra asked in surprise before excitement gave way.*

Beatrix nodded. "Of course. But, be aware, my time is extremely limited with my pursuit of mastering shadow magic. Your studies will be very hands off for a while. Do you understand what I'm saying?"

Catra nodded, excited at the prospect of even learning the basics. "I completely understand. I promise I won't disappoint you!"

Beatrix smiled. "So eager. It is refreshing. If that is all, I must be going. Happy Birthday Catra."

As Catra and Evelyn watched her leave the room, a teenager that looked similar to Evelyn stepped into the room. "Hey, there you are. Dad wants to talk to you."

Evelyn gave a groan before standing. "Sorry to cut this short Catra. Happy Birthday."

Catra, feeling a sense of solitude washing over her, shrugged, doing her best to hide it. "It's fine. I'll talk to you later, I guess."

The girl looked at Catra as she poked her food, her appetite pretty much gone. "Are you alright? Not enjoying the festivities?"

Catra took in the appearance of the young woman beside her. She was attractive with olive skin and gray eyes. Her brown hair was in a long braid that stretched down her back in a ponytail like fashion. She had a slim build with a toned physique. Catra realized that this was probably Evelyn's daughter.

The girl put a hand on her shoulder, concern in her eyes, "Hey, if you aren't feeling well I can-" she went to say something before she was cut off.

"*I'm fine, I just have a headache." Catra said, rubbing her temples and swallowing the lump in her throat.*

"*Oh, I'm sorry." She said, giving a sympathetic smile.*

Catra smiled back at her before asking, "What's your name?"

"*My name's Mara, nice to meet you. . .?" She said, putting her hand out, waiting for a response.*

"*I'm Catra." She said, taking her hand.*

"Catra?" A voice broke her from her thoughts.

"Hm?" she asked, turning to find her wife looking at her. She looked around to see the members of the princess alliance all in the main hall at other tables, discussing things. She'd gotten lost in thought it would seem.

"What were you thinking about?" Adora asked, taking a seat beside her.

"My fifteenth birthday." Catra muttered, reaching out and taking a sip of her drink.

Adora pulled Catra into a comforting hug. "What did you want to talk about?"

Catra nodded, "I've assembled the pieces for the warp drive with Entrapta's help. It's time to go home."

Adora shifted a bit in her seat, "Already?"

"What do you mean 'already'? Adora, it's been almost a month and a half. We need to get back. We were just inaugurated." Catra said quietly as several servants walked throughout the hall, busying themselves with the return of King Micah.

Adora looked conflicted but didn't change her stance. Her voice becoming slightly louder. "I know that, but we're here right now. We can help them. We know what happens next!"

Catra looked around, noticing that most of the alliance was looking at them in interest. Standing up, she waved her hands at the room around them, she began to speak Eternian, *"Adora, wake up! This isn't our Bright Moon. These aren't our friends. We need to go home."*

Adora looked around the room before continuing in Eternian, *"I know, Catra, but we can't just sit here and do nothing! They're in the same position we were. Angella said–"*

"*I already spoke to Angella this morning. She wanted to know how much time she had with Micah before the next major encounter with the Horde."* Catra said.

"*And?"* Adora asked.

"*And It's princess prom."* Catra responded with irritation. *"In case you forgot, right after that is when we made peace with our Horde. This timeline won't get that chance because their Catra didn't have to deal with a bunch of time travel bullshit. So in this case, we know nothing!"* Catra snapped with a slight growl before taking a deep breath to calm herself as she sat back down.. *"Sorry."*

Adora shifted in her seat, *"It doesn't feel right."*

"*No, it doesn't but we've wasted enough time. We need to deal with our own issues."* Catra said before glaring at Adora's younger counterpart, "Starting with eavesdroppers."

Adora Glenn looked at her younger self in confusion. True to Catra's words, she rubbed the back of her head, letting out a nervous chuckle. "But we were speaking Eternian."

"I know. Unlike my counterpart here, it would seem yours is still very much an eternian." Catra said standing.

"What do you mean she's an eternian?" Bow asked.

"Just what I said." Catra said as she walked over to a table where she had laid several of her things, including the disk that had infected She Ra as well as Adora's repaired azurlight. Entrapta looked on from the side, excited. "But ignoring that, I'll have the warp drive put together shortly."

Adora looked a bit dejected at that until Catra gave a glance at her. "It'll take a little bit to put together. You've got some time to talk."

Glimmer looked at her with irritation. "So that's it? You're just going to leave?"

Catra nodded as she turned towards her, "Yes. We have responsibilities that we can't just ignore. Our people need us, Sparkles."

"We need you!" She cried, "You froze an entire battlefield on your own. And you," Glimmer turned to the older Adora, "You can teach our Adora how to use her powers. With you both helping, we'd win in no time!"

Catra went to respond before Adora beat her to it. "Glimmer, while I'd love to stay and help you guys, Catra's right. We don't know what caused us to time travel and we need to go home. If it was something dangerous, we need to at the very least reassure them that we're fine."

"Can't you just wait a little longer? You're the queens, surely your people would understand?" Bow said.

Catra shook her head, "Bow, we aren't just in charge of Eternia. We have to manage hundreds if not thousands of worlds. Each one of them with their own conflicts and sets of issues. I'm sure Adora's parents are running everything, but that's not fair to them."

Glimmer went to say something else before Angella spoke up. "Glimmer, that's enough."

Glimmer looked like she wanted to say something else but held her tongue, sitting back down with an upset huff. Catra knew that this was tearing Adora up to leave but they had little choice. With that, Catra got to putting the warp drive together. After an uncomfortable thirty minutes it was done.

Standing, Catra looked to Adora, "It's finished. Are you ready?"

She nodded. As she walked to stand beside Catra, Angella and Micah walked over to them. "We want to thank you, Catra. For everything you've done for us. You've given me Micah back and I can never repay that." Angella said, slightly tearing up.

Catra gave a smile, "It was nothing. I would have helped Micah even if it hadn't turned out the way it did. Now, make sure you all stand back."

As everyone made their way back to a safe distance, mutterings from Entrapta's documentations could be heard from the side. Catra hit a button before setting it on the floor as the warp drive powered up, acting like an amp as it boosted Catra's powers to what she knew to be her normal levels. As she took Adora's hands, she felt Adora's magic flow through her, pushing her to heights she normally would never dare go. Giving a nod to everybody in a final farewell, Catra pushed the magic to encompass them before giving it a final nudge.

The next moment was shocking to say the least as a blood curdling scream that seemed indescribable filled the halls as a wave of energy spread out across Etheria sending cracks throughout reality itself before quickly closing. . . and then spread even further.

Eternia

Eternos, Capital of Eternia

Adora awoke with a gasp, sweat pouring off her body as she struggled to catch her breath. Her head was pounding in agony as she struggled to get to her feet. She looked around the room, only to realize she was in the medical wing of the royal palace. Shakily walking towards the door, she ignored the gown she was in as she pulled the door to the royal hall open.

The room was bustling as people ran back and forth with a purpose for reasons she couldn't grasp. Catra was right. Whatever had happened that had made them disappear had thrown the Kingdom into disarray. She caught sight of her father and mother talking with who she realized was Hordak. Her vision was shaky at best as she stumbled into the hall.

"Dad!" She attempted to shout but little noise came out. She was in a bad state. Luckily, Beatrix immediately noticed her off to the side.

"Adora!" She cried in concern as she rushed over to her, grabbing everyone's attention. Unfortunately, Adora could no longer find the strength to stay standing, let alone conscious, and would have crumbled to the ground had Beatrix not caught her.

Randor and Marleena ran to her, examining her. "She's awake! And breathing, thank Sharella."

"Get a Sana rune at once. It's a miracle she recovered, let alone that she was moving after." Marleena commanded.

After Adora was carefully moved to her quarters under the highest security, a flash of pink appeared in the hall, giving way to Glimmer as she strode towards Randor, "Is it true? Is Adora awake?"

Randor nodded, "She awoke a half hour ago. She's asleep again but we have several Sana runes around her bedside, restoring her health. Marleena is up there beside her at the moment."

"Have you heard anything about Catra's whereabouts?" Glimmer asked desperately.

Randor looked down in shame, "No. Nothing. She's gone. Not a trace to be found. Whoever took her and her guard left nothing."

Glimmer grit her teeth in frustration, "We have to find her. Razz warned us something like this would happen. We can't give up."

Hordak nodded as he walked up to them. "I agree. Finding Catra is the key to combating Prime. We've stalemated him at the moment but it's not good. However he came to be in this timeline is a mystery to even I."

Randor turned towards the man, "In your alternate memories, you were a clone of him, yes? What can you tell us?"

"He's dangerous and extremely efficient. But he is not unbeatable. Light Hope's virus was able to heavily neutralize his means of control via the chips. . ." He let out a low growl, "But it is not enough. I don't know how he is here, but it's concerning. He still looks exactly the same."

"His attack on the wedding was on purpose." Glimmer said with a focused look, "He specifically targeted Adora, Catra, and Mara. He knew they were major threats. We got Adora to wake up. Maybe she can give us some clues as to what happened."

"I hope so." Randor said solemnly.

Earth

Shroudwood

"Mara!" Evelyn shouted.

Mara tore her gaze from the lizard man in front of her before turning towards Marleena, "Marleena?"

"My queen!" Lizzor groaned, doing his best to bow before taking a knee in pain.'

"Please leave that man alone." Marleena said calmly.

Mara looked at the man before sneering and stepping away from him. She took a few steps towards Marlena's group before they froze. The woman who Marleena assumed was an alternate Teela stepped forward before whispering, "Dad?"

Duncan eyed the young woman before turning to look at his daughter as she stepped forward. Teela looked at the identical woman, eyeing the magic still wafting off of her, "So. . . is this time travel?"

"An alternate timeline is our guess." Caitlyn said as she stepped forwards.

Marleena's Andra looked at her alternate self. This one looked somewhat different compared to the mirror image that was Teela. Her Andra had shorter hair in braids and was a little shorter. Mara's Andra wore jewelry in her hair with long curls and was taller with a more muscular structure.

Adam was surprised at the interaction but remained quiet. He eyed Mara's sword, noting the similarities to his own. Marleena

also noticed it as well. "So you're not–"

"The temporal barriers are gone!" A voice rang out through the radio on Adam's hip.

"What!" Marleena exclaimed in shock, completely ignoring Mara.

Mara's head snapped towards the radio. Marleena pulled the device in front of her, displaying an image of the man. "Are you sure?"

"Yes. All barriers are down. Not just the temporal but the aura web is down as well. We're not hidden anymore." He said quietly.

"What. . . why do you seem so calm?" Marleena asked.

"My Queen. . . He's gone." A woman's voice sounded from beside him.

"What do you mean 'gone?'" Adam asked in a slightly harsh tone.

"All traces of Horde Prime are gone. We can't detect him at all. It's like he doesn't exist."

An animalistic shriek pierced through the air like a knife, striking terror through Mara's core. In horror, she watched the sky begin to fill with cracks and rifts as dark ink like tendrils began to slowly drift out of them. Mara felt the familiar fear begin to take hold as a sense of deja vu reminded her of that horrible battle, except Catra wouldn't arrive this time. But as quick as the sky cracked, it mended itself. The town was dead silent as everyone waited for the other shoe to drop, to no avail.

The Fright Zone

Catra ignored the soldiers that zipped around the Fright Zone in confusion. She ignored Shadow Weaver as she rambled on about

the amount of power she sensed that had surged through the atmosphere. And she ignored Hordak who wouldn't stop talking about stars and how they were 'free from their dimension,' whatever that meant. All Catra knew was that there were stars now. Big deal. No, Catra was more focused on the strange feeling that had welled in her body a couple of hours ago.

Quietly observing Scorpia and Lonnie talking to Kyle and Rojelio, she quietly made her way away from the barracks. She avoided the ominous red glow that emanated from under Shadow Weaver's doors. And she avoided the little irritating imp before going somewhere only she and Adora would go when they wanted privacy.

Finally alone with her thoughts, Catra overlooked the Fright Zone from her scaffolding before focusing on that feeling that was welling up inside her. She didn't know why, but it felt intoxicating. She closed her eyes before focusing. It swirled around her, washing over her skin and running through her muscles and bones. It was power. Pure, untapped power. As it filled her, she let out a deep breath.

Her thoughts turned towards her future counterpart. She had power. Power that not even the likes of Shadow Weaver possessed. Was that what she was feeling? Slowly her thoughts shifted to Adora. She wanted to know what the older Adora was like. Had she left her too? Judging by the fact they were married, she doubted it. *Her* Adora didn't care about her, about her feelings, or how she felt. She only cared about Sparkles and her dumb little arrow friend. She'd abandoned her at Thaymor. Thaymor. She didn't want to admit it but she had handled that situation wrong. If she could go back there, change how she'd acted, maybe. . . maybe.

She wasn't a monster. She wouldn't hurt a kid, but Sparkles sure thought she would have. She grinded her teeth in anger. *Glimmer.* Who did she think she was? She ruined it. She. . . Catra's thoughts were overwhelming her and it was becoming agitating. Turning away from the view, she found herself face to

face with a drawing etched into the wall of her and Adora. She stared at it for a moment, her face twisted in anger, before throwing a punch at the wall. . . only for the portion of the wall to crumble. Catra immediately backed up in shock before looking at her hand.

She looked at the railing before throwing her hand out. Only for nothing to happen. She tried a few more times before giving up in frustration. What had she been thinking? She didn't have power, not real power anyways. Not like her replacement with Adora. She clenched her hands in frustration as she felt her eyes begin to burn. Suddenly, she heard a creaking sound. Looking back up showed the metal had twisted into itself.

She stared at her hands in astonishment before holding her right hand out in front of her. Focusing on the feeling inside of her, she let it gather before squeezing. The effect was instant as she felt pressure build up around her hand. Looking around for something to aim at, she noticed a barrel before taking aim and throwing her hand out. The barrel crumpled before flying out into the Fright Zone.

Catra gave a dark grin. She felt the fatigue, sure, but it didn't matter to her. If she could freeze a battlefield in the future, then taking it slow sounded fine to her. She would show Adora that she was worth more than those princesses. Show her what she was missing. Show her that she was the better soldier.

Bright Moon

Catra sat up with a groan. She looked around only to find herself in Bright Moon. She climbed out of the bed before walking around the room. She froze as she looked over at the night sky. Stars. She let out a sigh of relief. They'd done it. Turning to walk out of the room, she headed for the main hall. She had assumed that

she would arrive on Eternia when they'd returned to their time. It seemed she'd been wrong.

As she walked into the hall, she caught sight of Juliet. Walking towards her, she straightened her back, assuming the proper etiquette that had been drilled into her. "General Juliet. How are you? I have–"

"Catra! Are you alright?" She said in concern.

Catra raised an eyebrow before nodding, "Yes, I'm fine. Do you happen to know where Queen Angella is? I must speak with her."

Juliet looked at Catra before speaking softly, "Catra, it's me. You're. . . still here. It didn't work."

Catra stopped before looking towards the door. "But. . . the stars. You didn't–"

"We don't know. We're. . . trying to understand what happened."

Catra nodded before going to turn, "I'm going to go back to my room and collect my thoughts. I'll talk to everyone in the morning."

"Of course." Juliet said kindly before Catra left.

As Catra made it back to the room, she noticed Adora on the other side of the room. She walked towards the bathroom before closing the door. She felt sick to her stomach as a sense of nausea overtook her before she threw up whatever food may have been in her stomach. All of this. Getting the pieces over the last month for the damn drive and it had all been for nothing. She wanted to scream out but that wouldn't get her anywhere. She washed her mouth out before staring at herself in the mirror. She didn't look too bad, just a little tired. But then, something caught her notice that chilled her to the bone. The colors of her eyes. . . were reversed.

Hello to all once more. I hope everyone is enjoying the story. Been a bit busy over the last month, but I was still able to get some writing in. As always, leave a review, let me know what you all think, and Happy Halloween.

Chapter 4

Bright Moon

Catra felt. . . off. She couldn't place why but she did. Maybe it was the fact that her eyes were no longer switched? Adora was missing but Angella had assured her that she had made it back to their timeline when she had used the drive but she couldn't be sure. Everything was garbled and confusing. Sure, the stars were still in the sky letting her know that she had inadvertently kicked them out of Despondos but that was about it. It had been a trying two weeks and princess prom was finally here. She watched as Adora and Glimmer tried on dresses, going over battle strategies on how to best approach Frosta for the alliance.

A tap on her shoulder broke her out of her thoughts. She turned to find Angella looking at her with a familiar look of excitement. Catra raised a brow, "What's up?"

Angella smirked before holding up a scroll. An invite scroll to be precise. As she began to read it, she felt her stomach drop. "Queen Catra, you and a plus one are formally invited to the All Princess Ball, Winter Wonderland. We at the Kingdom of Snows. . ."

Catra tuned her out as she focused on the absolute wrongness of this invite. Nobody should know her status and most certainly not Frosta. She had been deliberately kept out of the reports and letters from all sides of the alliance. Angella stopped reading and gave her a look of concern. "Catra, are you all right?"

Catra rubbed her eyes, "Yeah, I just. . . need some air."

Angella hesitantly nodded, "Of course. When you're ready to talk."

Catra gave a short nod before walking out of the castle. She just needed to clear her–

"That's enough! You look at me and see a child, but I have worked too hard to gain respect only to throw it away just because you feel they are up to something. For centuries the All Princess Ball has been neutral ground. I will not dishonor that legacy. Scorpia is a princess. Princesses get plus ones. They stay."

Catra let out a groan. 'Great. Here we go again.'

Eternos

Adora couldn't place it, but the palace felt. . . wrong. Maybe it was the lack of Catra, maybe it was the fact that Mara, Teela, Andra, Caitlyn, and Lyra were also missing, or maybe it was because everyone was telling her that Horde Prime, somebody who had *no right to exist anymore*, was attacking them and declaring war. She didn't know but it was eating at her, gnawing on the back of her mind.

As she walked through the palace halls, Beatrix approached her. She liked the woman, despite what many of her friends and family thought. She was a good teacher and a good mentor to Catra ever since C'yra died. The woman gave good advice and it was true that she didn't always heed it, she always took it into consideration. "Beatrix, what brings you here today?"

"Adora, come with me. I want to talk to you." She said before turning to walk down the garden path. Adora fell into stride beside her as they stopped in front of the fountain. Beatrix turned towards her and let out a sigh. "I will admit, I did not think that you and Catra were ready to be Queens of Eternia. But under your rule, the Kingdom is performing admirably. You are becoming every bit the leader I always knew you to be."

Adora gave a bashful smile, "Thank you, Beatrix. I couldn't have done this without my family's and Catra's support."

"Suffice to say, I'm impressed with your performance. And don't worry too much about Catra. We *will* get her back beside you."

Beatrix said supportingly. Adora nodded, a bit at ease at the woman's words. Beatrix waved her hand at the gardens overlooking the city, "Look at it. This is who you both are. The queens who will lead us to a new age of prosperity and victory. Everything is perf–" She cut herself off as they watched the whole city glitch.

"What the hell?" Adora gasped before a voice filled the gardens.

"*Mara, dearie*"

Adora spun around, looking for the source of the voice before looking at Beatrix. "Did you–"

"I heard it too." She said as she looked around the gardens, her eyes narrowed.

As Adora focused on the city, her blood went cold as she saw it. A wall of nothing that was devouring Eternos.

"Come on! We need to get-" Adora went to grab Beatrix's hand before finding herself in a familiar castle of ice.

"You shouldn't have these powers." Catra started. "It's not–"

"Why, *hello*, Mara, dearie!

Shroudwood

Mara shook her head with a dark chuckle as a sense of clarity hit her. "That's so stupid."

Adam tore his gaze from the sky. "What is?"

"I figured it out." Mara said, her smile gone. She turned towards Teela. "We're still in the throne room. Or rather, a version of it."

"What?" Teela asked in confusion, "What are you talking about?"

"The monsters in the sky, the lack of magic, the cracks, being stuck on earth *away* from Catra and Adora? It's not real. None of this is. Or rather, it's not real *yet*." Mara explained.

"And you lost me." Lyra said.

"She's saying we're in a nexus event." Marleena spoke up with a look of utter disappointment leveled at Mara. "With Horde Prime vanishing from existence and the temporal barriers being destroyed with your arrival, it's the only thing that makes sense." She shook her head, "How long?"

It was Mara's turn to look confused. "How long what?"

"How long has it been since you tampered with the Temporal Obelisk?" Marleena asked with trepidation. "And I don't mean your rewritten timeline. I mean since the moment someone woke up."

As Marleena mentioned the Obelisk, a ripple of murmurs and fear spread throughout the Eternian soldiers in the town like a wave. Whispers of shock and outrage echoed towards Mara and her friends.

Mara thought about it, "A month at most."

"Why does it matter? We didn't tamper with it. Not only would that be tantamount to suicide, it would be the highest form of treason. We'd never do that to our queen." Caitlyn said.

"So she's the queen of Eternia is she?" Marleena scoffed. She turned a glare at Mara, "And you helped her? You stupid girl. Did she trick you?"

"No. I helped her of my own volition. Why do you care?" Mara asked with irritation.

Adam finally spoke up in a calm, yet commanding tone, before the argument could devolve further. "Mara, the temporal obelisk was destroyed by my father. He saw the dangers it posed and made sure no one could harness its power ever again. If your queen has

taken the power for herself, then she has lied to you and she must be stopped."

Mara pursed her lips before a smile broke out on her face. "Ah, so that's the difference then."

"What is?" Teela asked from beside Adam.

"My friend, our queen, Catra D'riluth, was born into the power. The temporal obelisk is her runestone. She's a–"

"Celestial Birth!" Adam said in shock. "My father speculated it was once possible but whatever species housed the obelisk was long dead before he stumbled on it."

"What is a nexus event?" Caitlyn asked, still hung up on the term.

Marleena looked at Mara's friends. "Nexus events are events that are considered pivotal to a timeline. They are events that have the power to shift an entire world's history. They are predetermined to take place but their ending is not. Regardless of how it ends, it will always take place. Which means," Marleena spun around and looked at the world around her. "none of this has taken place yet."

"I'm so lost." Lyra groaned in exasperation.

"Go through what happened exactly. Start from the beginning. I'll try to work it out with you." Marleena said.

Mara sat down on a bench nearby as she tried to work through what went wrong. "Okay, I met Catra on Etheria. I was stationed there with my unit, Grayskull, working on the Heart of Etheria Project."

"That still matches up with my husband and I's history." Marleena said.

Mara nodded, "At around the harvest festival, I met Catra. She had lost her memories from making contact with a shard of the obelisk. We talked for a bit before she passed out. I later learned

she was switching between the future and the past. When she woke up again, I found out from Admiral Stratos and Fleet Admiral Keldor that we were engaged in a war against Horde Prime."

"Still matches."

"When Catra switched back, she rewound time in the future, throwing our time out of sync and off its axis. This opened up those rifts in the sky you just saw. We fought the monsters for a while until Catra woke up just in time. She rewound our time, putting it back on course. Right after, Catra and I learned that the Queen, our Marleena, was in a coma. She claimed her soul was not in her body and had been talking to Catra in her head. I learned that the harvesting of magic was an attempt to wake Marleena up and heal her."

"There's the first difference." Duncan said from the side. "Marleena was still awake for us. And the harvesting of magic was for a weapon against Horde Prime."

Mara thought about his words for a moment before pressing on. "Then I met Adora, the future She Ra. Catra's girlfriend. We talked for a bit before we worked out that Marleena and my mother were hiding something about time travel."

"Your mother?" Marleena asked? "Who's your mother?"

"Evelyn Morgan. Is that a difference here? My father is Lorric Sunder." Mara asked.

"Quite the big difference. For one, Evelyn and I did not reach Eternia until well into your teenage years. Second, Evelyn and Lorric were never married. She married Keldor." Marleena said with a fond smile before it faded.

Mara nodded, "Regardless, fast forward a bit, Catra and I met up with Randor and confirmed that the version of Marleena that Catra was talking to was the same Marleena that was in a coma on Eternia. Catra switched back and was kidnapped by what should have been her mother, C'yra, queen of the magicats."

"Another difference. I don't know any race called the magicats." Marleena said.

"It was explained to me and Catra what the powers of the obelisk entailed should she choose to form the bond. The timeline started collapsing so Catra rewound us a whole day back. There, we learned that she had reformed the obelisk and was going to use Catra's power to break the time loop and save Earth."

"Ahh, there it is." Adam said. "There's your branching timeline."

"Saving Earth?" Mara asked.

Marleena nodded, "How did my counterpart meet Randor?"

"Yours and my mother's ship was equipped with a primitive warp drive. You didn't account for the power drain. You floated through space for a while until you were almost out of air, food, and water. Randor and my father found you both and nursed you back to health. You begged Randor to save Earth and upon your arrival–"

"Earth had withered away into nothing because nobody understood time dilation. Am I correct in that assumption?" Marleena asked.

Mara nodded, "Pretty much."

"Not here. No, my ship was one of normal design with very powerful thrusters. I was thrown off course and was stranded on Eternia. There I met Randor and fell in love with him."

Mara eyed Adam, "And instead of a daughter you have a son."

"No, I had twins. My daughter didn't survive." Marleena said solemnly.

"I'm sorry to hear that." Mara said quietly before continuing, "Well, basically, our timelines were collapsing. We all talked about what to do over the stupidest course of events and decided that since the obelisk had been repaired Catra chose to break the time

loop. Catra had walked up to the obelisk and forged the bond. With that power, she had rewritten the timeline to fit everyone's needs. Earth was saved, Horde Prime was gone, Adora and her were getting married. Peace. So what the hell went wrong?"

"Don't you see?" Peter asked as he walked up to Mara, "Your friend, Catra, hasn't forged the bond yet. Everything is still being rewritten."

Mara blinked before shaking her head. "But why am I here then? Nothing should have gone wrong and there should be no branching timelines."

"That's something you'll have to figure out." Adam said in a sorrowful tone.

Mara thought back to everything that had transpired.

Razz disappearing. The wedding. Getting her memories back. The Obelisk. Glimmer and everyone remembering the previous timeline when no one should have been able to. None of it made sense. The wedding was where it had diverted. Why there? C'yra's words rang through her mind. Adora and Catra were temporal pillars. Their marriage was a foundation that cemented the timeline. And then something hit her.

"Mara maybe we can–"

Mara cut her off by holding her hand up, silencing everyone. Shadow Weaver. Beatrix didn't have her memories. And neither did Light Hope.

"*I. . . Did I do it wrong? I remember nothing." Shadow Weaver said, not showing any of the pain that the others had when their memories returned.*

"*That's impossible. It worked for everyone else. It even worked for Sulphira and she had been dead for centuries in the original timeline." Bow said.*

"*Isn't it obvious?" Hordak said suddenly.*

"*What?" The alliance asked.*

"*This woman is not Shadow Weaver." Hordak said.*

"She couldn't remember the previous timeline, not because she's not Shadow Weaver, but because she doesn't exist." Mara said breathily. And then she remembered the moment before they had entered the palace to form the bond. Shadow Weaver had done something with the shard. She had cast some sort of spell on herself using its power.

Suddenly, Mara's vision flashed white and she found herself in an unfamiliar location. "The shard." she whispered, darkly.

"You shouldn't have these powers." Catra started. "It's not–"

"Why, *hello*, Mara, dearie!"

The Fright Zone

As Catra wandered the halls, she couldn't escape a bad feeling that had settled in the pit of her stomach. Her new found powers had come as a delight but the more she thought about it, the more it didn't make any sense. She hoped like hell that her future self would be there if only to explain her new abilities. On top of that, she'd been having. . . flashes, for lack of a better term. Flashes of memories that she knew she had never lived before. A result of the time stopping abilities no doubt.

"Catra, I need to speak with you." Shadow Weaver said before grabbing her arm.

Catra looked at the woman before turning towards her, "Yeah? What's up?"

"I've. . . sensed something in you change. A power has begun to form inside you and I need you to tell me if you've begun to

exhibit any abilities that may resemble your counterpart." Shadow Weaver said seriously.

Catra was nothing if not a good actor though, "What do you mean power? I thought these weren't the same versions of us?"

Shadow Weaver shook her head, "They aren't but that's not how magic works. It's tricky and you could begin exhibiting abilities soon." She narrowed her eyes. "If you're lying to me, Catra, I need you to tell me. I know how intoxicating magic can be but you need to understand that there is a reason that time magic is completely forbidden across all of Etheria."

Catra thought about what she was saying. Could this be harmful to herself? Thinking back on it, her counterpart did look somewhat tired when she had frozen Kyle during their first meeting. And she did say she hadn't meant to time travel.

Shadow Weaver spoke again in a gentle tone. "Time magic isn't just dangerous, it's completely volatile. I was a teacher of magic once upon a time and am probably the most versed individual in magic on the planet and I will tell you that I don't know the first thing about it. So you need to tell me right away if you're exhibiting signs of magic."

Catra let out a sigh before nodding. "About three days ago. When the stars came back."

Shadow Weaver gave a slow nod, "Have you frozen anything? Rewound or anything of the sort?"

Catra shook her head, "No, nothing like that. More like. . ." Catra looked around before seeing a barrel off to the side of the hall. She raised her hand before squeezing. Immediately, it crumpled into a ball. She pulled her hand back to her chest, her fist still balled as the barrel floated towards them.

Shadow Weaver held up a hand, examining it as her eyes glowed. She let out a noise of shock and. . . approval? Catra watched her walk around the barrel before she dropped it, feeling the pull on

her reserves getting stretched thin. "I can only do a little bit right now. Two days ago I couldn't have lifted that."

Shadow Weaver nodded, "Impressive. Not time magic, not really, but definitely in the same sphere. I've rarely seen this type of magic and it was always by accident. Esoteric gravity." She turned towards Catra, "If you can avoid using it for the time being, do so. When you have some free time, we can begin training these powers in a controlled environment. It wouldn't do for you to accidentally crush our troops."

Catra felt a small bit of elation at that. "Really? That would be-"

A flash of white flooded her vision.

"-great."

"I know you're plotting something. From now until the second the ball ends, I'll be watching. Wherever the two of you go, I go." Adora said with a smirk from the ground.

Catra looked down at her in confusion before looking around, finding herself in an unfamiliar location. She quickly realized she was in the Kingdom of Snows. She caught sight of her future counterpart standing beside the pirate at the drinks station. "How. . . How did I get here?"

Glimmer scoffed, "Nice try. We just–"

Catra had already tuned her out. She didn't know what she was feeling but it was strange. She could feel a surge of power periodically rippling through her body from her core all the way to her finger tips. As she marveled at the feeling, Catra slowly began to play with the feeling. As she–

"You're right. This is a much better vantage point for my observations. Hi Adora. Have you met my new assistant? She brought snacks." Entrapta said as she turned towards Adora.

Adora gave a glare but it quickly faded as she noticed Catra looking at her hands in confusion before looking around at her surroundings. "Catra are you okay?"

"What?" Catra asked, looking at Adora.

"I asked if you're okay?" Adora said, taking a hesitant step forward.

Catra nodded slowly before looking around, "Yeah, yeah, I'm-I'm fine. I just–"

Catra realized that Shadow Weaver had been telling the truth about time magic. Her sense of time was extremely warped. She found herself leaning in Adora's arms mid dance. Catra quickly stepped away. This wasn't right. Something was very wrong.

"Catra? Talk to me? What's going on?" Adora asked, any trace of hostility gone. What remained was only concern.

Catra stumbled back as Adora's voice seemed so loud . Another surge ran across her body. "I. . ." Catra stopped as she looked down at her hands. Looking up, she noticed that she had caught the attention of more than a few dancers, including her future self who had abandoned the dance and was walking towards her. Again she felt it, stronger this time. She could see energy swirling around her fingertips, just barely noticeable.

"Catra! You need to relax!" Her counterpart said as she began rushing towards her.

"I don't–" Catra said slowly before feeling the power fly through her body once again.

Catra once again found herself in Adora's arms. She felt so tired.

"Catra?" Adora immediately noticed the change in body language. "Talk to me? What's going on?" Adora asked, any trace of hostility gone. What remained was only concern.

"You just said that." Catra said in a confused tone. Everyone turned to look at Catra. "What's going on?" She asked exhaustedly. She felt her breath being taken away as she slowly slumped to a knee as she felt another surge of power growing. Why did she feel so weak?

Suddenly, Catra and Adora looked around as the whole dance was frozen. Catra D'riluth quickly walked up to them before she reached out, placing a hand on her shoulder. "This isn't possible."

"What's not?" Adora asked as she helped Catra stand, letting her use her as support.

"You shouldn't have these powers." Catra started. "It's not–"

"Why, *hello*, Mara, dearie!" A familiar voice said from behind them.

"Razz?" Catra asked before turning around, only to find herself face to face with her Adora and Mara. "Mara? Adora?"

"Catra?" They said in unison. Mara looked down at the younger counterparts of her friends.

"So Marleena was right." Mara said before their surroundings began to change. The walls began to crack with brilliant light before they found themselves in a twisted version of Bright Moon, the Fright Zone, and the Eternos palace. And at the center, sat the Temporal Obelisk.

"Mara dearie, Adora dearie, Catra dearie, you always seem to get it right." Razz said bitterly as she hobbled in front of them. Before she could get any closer, Mara brandished her sword, leveling it at the old woman.

"What are you doing?" Adora Glenn asked.

"That's not Razz. It never was. Glimmer and I never spoke to Razz. Isn't that right, Shadow Weaver?"

Razz smiled before it became twisted and cruel. Slowly it morphed into an inky dark blotch, swirling into a thick smoke, becoming Shadow Weaver. She looked different than Catra remembered. Her claws were longer, sharper, more feral looking. Her mask was firmly in place over her face and she wore a hood, hiding her hair. In her hand sat a staff that looked malformed with twisted wood and metal that seemed to almost scream out in horror. Catra immediately recognized several shards of the obelisk embedded at the top of it, containing a large amount of magic. Mara recognized it as the heart of Etheria.

Shadow Weaver threw her hand forward before a digital woman that looked half dead and deteriorated flew into Mara's arms. Mara went to catch the woman before she fizzled out of existence. It had been Light Hope, or what was left of her. "She did her best to keep me from what was mine. Keeping me trapped in a fake mental state subservient to that fool Horde Prime. A commendable effort but one that was in vain. All she did was give me the heart of Etheria."

"I don't understand! What is going on?" Catra D'riluth shouted.

Mara gave a murderous glare at the witch. "You haven't forged the bond with the obelisk yet. It was almost complete until she changed it. She pretended to be Razz to get Glimmer and us to mess with your mental state. By making you remember, it warped your perception on the new timeline. It's why the wedding was so important. It was the last chance for her to change it."

"But why?" Catra looked at Shadow Weaver, "You were the one who told me to form the bond in the first place. Why stop it?" Catra asked.

"Because she wants the power for herself! Isn't it obvious?" Adora's younger counterpart snarled as Catra shook off the effects of her rewind.

"Ahh, Adora. You could have been great under my tutelage. Both of you could have. But when I found out what you had reduced

me to, Catra. . . well, I had to take action. So I changed the script. You would have sought me out and willingly accepted my teachings. But no matter how many times we do this, you just can't accept it. You always choose her."

"Catra gave you a life, a happy one. Elevated your status, had you in line to be the most powerful sorceress to ever live and you still want more?" Mara shook her head before activating the power of He Ro. Adora Glenn summoned her sword, swiftly transforming into She Ra as well. "Well, we won't let you."

Shadow Weaver let out a laugh, "I am stronger than all of you!" As lightning lashed out, hitting She Ra and Mara, sending them flying across the room. "I will have my way and nobody, least of all you, will stop me."

Catra D'riluth, seeing Adora and Mara fended off so easily, threw her hand out. The ambient magic that flowed throughout the area obeyed Catra, twisting and seething as if irritated at being told what to do. Gritting her teeth, she shot the small orb of temporal infused energy at Shadow Weaver. Catra grinned as she watched her freeze in place before rushing past her, focused on the obelisk. What she failed to notice was that it failed almost immediately. Catra was stopped in her tracks as a red aura, one she had grown to despise as a child, wrapped itself around her.

Catra looked at Adora before pulling out a dagger and tossing it at Adora. Adora looked at the weapon before staring at Catra, "You snuck a weapon into princess prom?"

"Look who you're talking to." Catra said as they rushed towards Shadow Weaver's back. Shadow Weaver didn't even turn to look at them before they were engulfed in magic and levitated to stand in front of her. Adora threw the dagger at Shadow Weaver only for her to pluck it out of the air.

Shadow Weaver lifted them to face her before chuckling. "What was that supposed to accomplish? I shouldn't be surprised. I

know you're not aware of it, but did you know that you two aren't technically real?"

"What are you saying?" Catra snarled.

Shadow Weaver chuckled, waving the dagger at them. "I know, I know. It sounds stupid but it's the truth. See, the only real people in this room are us four. You two are only pieces of the real Catra and Adora. Catra's psyche shattered into two while trying to salvage the timeline, giving birth to you two. It's why those little abilities are in your possession and you've been getting flashes."

Adora's future counterpart and Mara had stood by this point only to be dragged in front of her beside them as well. Shadow Weaver had them all at her mercy and had done it without breaking a sweat.

Shadow Weaver raised an eyebrow at the younger Catra before looking at her older version, "Oh, now there's an idea."

"What?" The younger Adora asked, eyeing the witch.

"Catra, there's no need for us to be enemies. I can help you." Shadow Weaver drawled, turning her gaze on the girl, "I can offer you a way out. Teach you to harness the power of the obelisk that your older self keeps rejecting."

Mara looked at her with desperation, "Don't do it Catra! She just wants to use you to seize it herself. We have to finish the bond!"

"And throw away such power?" Shadow Weaver asked in disbelief before shaking her head, "I think not."

"So, what? You get everything you ever wanted?" Catra D'riluth snarled, "You made me this way! Told me to forge the bond!"

Shadow Weaver narrowed her eyes before clenching her fist around the staff, electricity crackling around the weapon. All of a sudden, Catra watched in horror as both versions of Adora shriek in pain as they turned into pure magic before flowing into one

another. Agony became Adora's entire being before reforming back into what she was before the bond was set into motion.

"There. All better. Doesn't it feel wonderful to be made whole again? I'm just returning the favor. Catra healed me after all. It wouldn't do to leave her love without a piece of herself." Shadow Weaver said cockily. Adora just gasped as sweat ran down her face from the sheer effort it took to stay awake.

"Now, I need you to stay awake Catra. I'll need to do the same for you to finish the bond." Shadow Weaver said as she pointed at her with the dagger.

Catra smirked at Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver stopped before narrowing her eyes. "What are you–"

Before she could say another word, the heat bomb that had been planted into the back of the knife detonated in Shadow Weaver's face, destroying her mask. Catra studied Shadow Weaver's face and noticed it had bits of metal ingrained into it, no doubt from Light Hope's efforts in stopping her. Instantly, the spell loosened and they all fell to the ground. Catra looked at the cracked blue shard before turning to her older self and Mara. "Get to the obelisk, now!"

Mara nodded before picking Adora up and running with Catra to the obelisk. Shadow Weaver looked at the broken shard before snarling at Catra, a glare that could murder settling on her face. Grasping the staff, she leveled it at Catra, firing off blasts of magic at the teen.

As Catra dodged the magic, she screamed in anger, "That's right, run away. It's the only thing you've ever been good at!" Shadows stretched across the ground as the staff seemed to speed up the spell, "You've always been a disappointment. You've learned nothing from me!"

"Oh no, I've learned everything from you!" Catra said as she slid out of the way from a blast, "How to predict when you strike! How

to dodge! How. To. Resist!" Catra jumped behind a pillar, breaking Shadow Weaver's line of sight, "You thought you were punishing me all these years? Wrong." Shadow Weaver looked around, searching for Catra, "You were training me for this day!"

Shadow Weaver whipped around only to have her face slashed open from Catra's claws. Blood poured out of the eye that had been mercilessly gouged out. Shadow Weaver shrieked in pain before the staff was ripped out of her hands by Catra. Catra raised the staff up before swinging it at Shadow Weaver's head. She managed to avoid the strike, albeit barely, but the magic inside the staff had locked onto Catra's emotions and had chosen that moment to swarm the nearest target in the form of a beam.

Catra stepped back, keeping the staff away from her grasp as she watched Shadow Weaver's face melt, leaving only her skull. Shadow Weaver clutched her face before throwing her hand out at the obelisk, or more accurately, Catra. Catra D'riluth had made it to the obelisk and had begun to finish the bond before the magic inside of her began to flow out of her body and into Shadow Weaver's hand. Catra watched as Mara stood by helpless as her future self fell to her knees, her body beginning to look worse as Shadow Weaver's face began to regenerate. So Catra did the only thing she could, choosing not to think about how this would probably end her own existence.

She raised her hand towards the obelisk, channeling the magic in her own body that seemed to only be enhanced by the staff. And squeezed.

"Argh!" Glimmer groaned, "What a waste of time!"

Bow nudged her, an encouraging smile on his face, "Hey, it wasn't a complete waste of time. We stopped the Horde from being able to ever use this horrible disk again."

Adora nodded, "It's true. While we couldn't pin down why Catra was here, we still got rid of that thing. So there is that."

Sea Hawk put a blanket around Adora as they gathered their stuff. "And look on the bright side. We have an awesome adventure to tell when we next gather!"

Glimmer smiled, "I suppose there is that. Let's just hurry up and get out of here. I think I've had enough snow to last me the rest of the year."

Adora nodded. "The sooner we leave the Northern Reach, the better."

As they finally packed their things and went to head out for the Dragon's Daughter Five, Adora stopped. "Do you guys hear that?"

"Hear what?" Bow asked.

"Exactly. Where's the wind?" Adora asked.

Glimmer stopped and squinted. Off in the distance, there was a slight glow. It was blue but there was no mistaking the light. It looked like a person. "Adora, look! There's someone over there."

They all nodded before rushing for the clearing. As they stepped closer, Bow took note of something. "Guys? The snow isn't falling."

"What?" Glimmer asked before looking at the snowflakes frozen in air. "Weird."

"Adora!" A familiar voice cried. Adora looked at her friends before walking further towards the person only to see Catra leaning on a stick. She looked horrible. There were shards of glowing crystals sticking out of her back as well as smaller pieces sticking out of her legs, arms, and a large gash on her abdomen. Blood was pooling around her. She wasn't wearing the winter gear she had been wearing earlier and was simply wearing her normal clothing.

"Catra!" Adora shouted in slight concern. Even bow and Glimmer were slightly cautious. What did this? *Who* did this?

As Adora ran towards her, she stopped when she saw something strange. "She looks–"

"Glitchy." Bow said as he walked up to her.

"Adora!' Catra cried in the same tone. Glimmer looked at her curiously before walking up and stuck her arm through her.

"She's not here. It's like she's repeating." Glimmer realized. When she poked it, she realized something else. "This is magic. I'm not sure what kind but there's no mistaking it."

Sea Hawk tapped Adora's shoulder. "Look, there's a trail of blood and foot prints."

Adora looked at Glimmer and Bow, "We need to follow her."

Glimmer looked a little conflicted but the large amount of blood cleared her mind. If anything else, capturing Catra would be a good thing. They all nodded before Adora spoke up. "Bow, be ready with a med kit." As they pushed further into the tundra, they found another glitchy Catra.

"Mara! Bow! Glimmer! Anybody! I. . . I need help." She said weakly. This version glitched into another appearance for a moment. As they looked at it, Catra's clothes flashed into something that seemed more akin to Bright Moon apparel. Even ehr headpiece flashed golden with jewels in the center before it flashed back to herself.

"Strange." Glimmer said.

Adora put a bit more stride in her step as they hurried towards the source of the footprints and blood. Another minute passed before they found her lying in the snow, unconscious. Adora reached out and touched her shoulder only to find that she was physical. "This is her. Let's get her back to the ship." Adora said, carefully picking her up. Bow looked down before grabbing the staff.

Hordak paced the room before slamming his fist into the wall, a snarl on his face. He couldn't fault Catra or Entrapta. Not this time. This was truly just a result of bad timing. When his scanners had gone off two days ago alerting him of an active portal, he'd done his absolute best to contact Force Captain Catra only to fail. He could only await their arrival and hope that their mission had been successful. His answer came through the door within the hour.

"Lord Hordak. The mission was a success. We retrieved the First Ones tech with minimal resistance." Catra said, standing at attention as she delivered her report. "Entrapta will be arriving shortly with it."

"Excellent. While I am happy to hear that, I have a different matter I'd like to ask you about."

"Of course. What is it?" Catra asked.

"While you were in the Northern Reach, I received a signal from an opened portal approximately two days ago near your stationed location. Judging by the time frame, you may have been in position to witness it. Did you happen to see anything?" Hordak asked.

Catra thought back. They had left two days ago after the battle with Adora. There hadn't been any type of portal nearby that she knew of and Entrapta would have certainly made a fuss about it if they had seen it. Thinking back on it, she had witnessed a flash of blue light for a moment but had chalked it up to the monsters in the area. Catra gave a hesitant nod.

"Possibly. There was a flash of bright blue light. It didn't seem normal but I had chalked it up to the monsters and the alliance fighting. If it really was a portal, it was a ways out from the base. I could pinpoint it for you." Catra offered.

Hordak nodded. "Yes, do so. The portal closed as quickly as it came but if something came out of it it could prove invaluable.

Thank you Force Captain. You are dismissed."

Catra nodded and left the room. 'A portal, huh? I'll keep that in mind.'

Adora stood beside one of the healers as they ran through a basic checkup on the unconscious Catra. Angella stood nearby as a scout delivered something that Adora had been expecting. "We have confirmation that Force Captains Catra and Scorpia both returned to the Fright Zone with Entrapta earlier today."

"Thank you. That will be all." Angella said before turning back towards Adora, Glimmer, Bow, and Sea Hawk. "So, what is the cause of this?"

Adora watched them as they carefully removed the shards out of her body, suturing the wounds. After a moment, her body glitched, showing a very different Catra. One with clothes that resembled royalty with a golden headpiece that resembled a crown. "Well, normally I'd say this isn't Catra."

"Normally? Why do you say that?" Glimmer asked. "Besides the glitching, she looks the same to me."

"She's taller than she should be, her stripes are different colors and she has more on her back than normal, her hair is darker, she has slightly more freckles, her claws are longer, her eyes are brighter. It's little details you can't see. I grew up with her so I know what to look for. At first glance I thought it was her but now that I have a better look. . ." Adora said as she examined her. "But then there's the weird recordings we saw in the snow. Her clothes. She called out our names."

Bow spoke up, "She had a few belongings on her. The two most important was the trackerpad that looks somewhat similar to mine but upgraded. Like a lot. The other was the staff that isn't emitting any magic."

"What else did she have on her?" Angella asked.

"This ring. A nice piece of jewelry if I do say so. She also had this." Sea Hawk said, holding up a familiar looking pin. Angella took it as she examined it before looking at Adora's.

Angella hummed before looking at the healers, "Will she pull through?"

"It's. . . It's hard to say. She might wake up soon or maybe not at all. There are some pretty serious injuries. The smaller crystal shards jutting out of her body are superficial at best, nerve damage at worst, the larger ones in her arms and legs pierced a few arteries as well as some confirmed nerve damage. We pulled a few smaller shards out of her lower spine. Thankfully they didn't damage her spinal cord. She has several herniated discs as well. The largest shard that we pulled from her back punctured her lung and broke two ribs upon entry while cracking two others. If it had been a little to the right it would have pierced her heart. She has magic burns throughout her body as well as a deep wound. It's hard to say what caused it but a blade seems to be the most likely answer. There's also some minor frostbite and a possibility of hypothermia." The man said before sighing, rubbing his eyes, "I'm amazed you got her here alive. I'd be even more amazed if she ever fully recovers without magic. I'm gonna be honest here. Even with the war, this is one of the worst patients I've ever operated on. Do you know what caused it? This isn't really the Horde's MO."

Adora shook her head, "No. We found her in the Northern Reach lying in the snow. Whatever caused this wasn't the Horde."

"I don't want to be that person but we need to pri–" Glimmer went to speak before she noticed the few shards they had pulled out were arcing with energy. As they all turned to watch, the shards began to levitate before slowly pulling themselves towards one another before seamlessly fusing together and dropping.

Angella narrowed her eyes, "Keep those shards away from each other."

The healers nodded before Angella left the room with the best friend squad in tow. "Bow, how is it going on breaking the security on the pad?"

Bow shook his head. "This is extremely advanced. If I didn't know any better, I'd say I was looking at a piece of First Ones tech. I was able to recover a file but not much else."

"Let's see it." Angella said before Bow set the tablet down as a video began to play.

"*Hello. . . God, this feels weird." Catra muttered to herself. Slightly shaking her head, she looked up at the tablet.*

"*So, Mara said that I should record my thoughts and experiences as some type of journal. She says it will help me 'center myself' or something. I'm not sure about it." Catra said, pausing for a few seconds.*

"*I'm not exactly sure what I'm supposed to say during this. Hmm. I suppose I'll just say everything that's happened so far since I learned how to 'switch.'" Catra shifted awkwardly.*

"*So after I learned to switch, I met Mara's. . .commanders? Is that the right word? Anyways, they helped me figure out I was time traveling and wanted some help with finding anything that could help them. Unfortunately, when I got back to the future, I couldn't find anything on anybody called the Eternians. After that I met some strange woman named Shadow Weaver and she said she raised me and I could do magic. She gave me a picture of me and Adora with three people I have yet to meet or remember.*

"*But I'm a little on the fence here, regarding her. At first, she seemed, I don't know, inviting? But thinking back on it, something seemed off. Maybe it's just nerves, but Adora's trip to Mystacor says something else." Catra said, chewing on the inside of her cheek.*

"*On the topic of Adora, she got back about two weeks ago with Bow and Glimmer. Bow's been really nice and is pretty respectful*

of my boundaries. He even gave me this tablet I'm recording with.

"*Glimmer is. . .weird. I can't pin her down. She doesn't seem to like me very much and I'm sure that has to do with me being a former Horde captain. But whenever we do talk about anything else, it's like we get each other. It's strange, like I said.*

"*Adora is. . .complicated. It's so easy to talk to her and she seems to know every little thing I'm gonna do before I do it. She even knew what food I liked before I tried it. It's comforting in a way. It's like I don't need to impress her or try to get her respect or approval." Catra gave a small smile, tilting her head down. "But. . .It can be awkward, if that's the right word. It's a little strained sometimes, like something's missing. I know it has to do with the memories that I lost. Something must have happened between us that I can't remember.*

"*I've gotten more comfortable around Angella. She's very patient with me and I appreciate it. When we can sit down and talk, I find it's very calming. Like all of my worries melt away. It's an unfamiliar feeling. When I went back to 'switch,' Angella sat beside me and watched. By her account, I light up with 'brilliant hues of color' and then I pass out.*

"*When I switched back to Mara, she had several things to say. I guess my theory about the time of day and night was correct, because I had slept through a full day and night beside her. I had to explain that the mental strain had been taking a toll on me and I needed to sleep and not just switch. She was pretty understanding. That day kind of sucked. Mainly because I had to explain it to several people. When Kai and Stratos talked to me about my findings, they offered several answers about my lack of findings in the library. The most prominent ones being that their particular race was going by a different name and not Eternians or they didn't exist in her timeline.*

"*What's funny is that Kai already guessed about my sleep problem. He seems pretty knowledgeable regarding these things. He's got a familiar feeling to him that I can't pin down. Probably*

something to do with being militaristic? I don't know, but I told them I'd check again and see if I could find any words regarding their language. I also couldn't read their writing. Mara laughed about that and explained it. Turns out their written language structure is so simple that you could learn it in an afternoon. Mara showed me how."

Catra stopped talking, putting her face in her hands before letting a breath out. "I'm not sure what to make of her. She's so kind and helpful, but she seems lonely. Like nobody hangs out with her. I decided that I'll check in on her from time to time. We're friends after all."

Catra's ears perked up as she paused. As if on cue, a knock at the door could be heard, "Catra, are you in there?"

"*Yeah, I'm kinda in the middle of something, Adora. Can you give me a couple of minutes?"*

"*Oh, are you doing your recording thing? Sorry, I'll wait." Adora said through the door, somewhat muffled. As the sound of footsteps sounded away from the door, Catra turned back to the camera.*

"*Right, so, uh, anyways, like I said, It's been about two weeks and I've just been taking it easy. I've only talked to Mara twice since then. We found out that when I switch, I can only do it about two more times in quick succession before I need to stop. It gets kind of painful, so. . .yeah. Waiting a day or two is the smart decision, according to Angella and Kai. Mara said I shouldn't even consider doing it without waiting a day at least."*

Catra shifted a couple of times before huffing and grabbing the tablet from where it was sitting. Walking back to the bed, she laid down and set it beside her face. She turned to look up at the ceiling and let out a sigh.

"*Bow was fascinated by the prospect of time travel and wanted me to tell him more, Glimmer was skeptical and understandably*

so, and Adora. . . Well she wasn't too enthused about me messing with the things that made me lose my memory. She outright confirmed what Shadow Weaver said to me. That I could never do magic before this whole thing. I don't know, I just thought that she would be happy about it. But all she said was that I shouldn't mess around with it. That if I 'remembered' my past experiences with magic, I wouldn't want to mess with it." Catra ran a hand through her hair before pulling the photo.

"*I'm sure she means well, but how am I supposed to understand her about this? The only memories I have regarding magic are the ones from Earth. Every memory depicts magic as something cool and powerful, something to be harnessed and used, to better people's lives. Of course it's dangerous. I mean, how could it not be? Anything that can harm people is dangerous." Catra unsheathed her claws on her hand, examining them, "I have claws that can carve through steel and she didn't say not to use those. Why would she? They're a part of my body. But so is this magic."*

Catra sat up, picking up the tablet, "Glimmer seemed kind of excited when she learned I could do magic, surprisingly. I figured she would have been uneasy, seeing as how her opinion of me is kind of negative right now. Either way, I'm going to approach this with caution. On Earth, there are a lot of depictions in the media of 'dark magic.' If that's the case here, then I'll have to be more careful."

Catra paused, looking around awkwardly, "That seems like a good place to end it. Um, I guess. . .End of log number 1?"

Angella hummed before leaning back in her chair. "So, what, time travel? She doesn't look any older than she does now."

Adora shook her head before rewinding the video. She examined the surroundings of the room, looking for any marks that could distinguish the time. "She said we got back from our trip to Mystacour two weeks ago. That was about four to five months

ago. It can't be time travel. Alternate timelines maybe? The Horde taught about it in one of our classes but it was all theoretical."

"That does seem to be the case here." Bow said. "I'll see if I can get this open but. . . guys that was a video journal."

"So?" Glimmer asked.

"So, that was private. If I'm able to unlock more logs, there's a chance that there will be more personal things in them than just an update on what was going on." Bow said, slightly uncomfortable.

Angella let out a sigh, "Very well," She turned towards Adora, "Since this is clearly Catra or at the very least a version of her, Adora, you will watch the logs before us and document the findings. If you deem it too private, you need not show us. Is that acceptable?"

Bow still looked unsure but nodded nonetheless. "I suppose."

Angella smiled. "I know it's uncomfortable to read someone else's diary." She gained a focused look, "And what of the staff?"

Glimmer shook her head, "We'll just have to wait for aunt Castaspella. I messed with it for a while and nothing. No glowing, no magic, nothing. It's just a stick but Catra said she had magic in the video so it's a staff. There's no doubt about that."

Angella turned towards Sea Hawk, "Sea Hawk, can you keep this to yourself? The less people know the better. Until we know for certain what the cause of all this is, keep it quiet. Even to the rest of the Alliance. I will explain it if it comes up at any point."

"Queen Angella, you have my word." Sea hawk said with an exuberant bow.

Angella smiled and nodded.

Warm. A sense of peace. A feeling of acceptance? Resignation? Perhaps. She couldn't be sure. She felt calm. It was like a gentle breeze had washed over her skin. The sun's golden rays washed over her as she felt the soft sand beneath her fingers. The sound of waves crashing against the beach soothed her ears. Now if only she could. . .

Where was she? This wasn't right. She didn't know why but it wasn't. It wasn't a bad feeling by any means, just a little off putting. She knew she was doing something before this but what?

We're losing her. Get Adora now!

Why couldn't she see? And where was Adora? She'd make this moment perfect.

She's glitching again!

She felt. . . hot. The warmth that seemed so peaceful a moment ago was beginning to burn. It was almost unbearable. She could no longer feel the breeze or hear the waves. No she felt–

Catra jerked awake, a gasp escaping her lips as she tried to sit up only for searing pain to shoot through her body, distorting her vision. She did her best to breathe but it felt like she wasn't getting enough air. Her body was on fire. Tears flowed out of her eyes as she found the slightest movement almost too much to bear.

"Catra, stop moving!"

She did her best to remain still as she looked to her right. Her vision was so blurry from the pain but she recognized Angella's wings. She raised a shaky hand to her chest as she struggled to get air.

"Catra, listen to me. You have a collapsed lung. You need to stay calm. Try not to take deep breaths." A doctor said from the side.

Catra eyed him before giving a slight nod. She turned her head to see Adora, Bow, and Glimmer rush through the door. She eyed the sword on her back before turning her head towards her with extreme difficulty.

"You need. . . to heal me." She rasped out through the oxygen mask on her face. She barely heard her voice but Adora must have understood her.

"I can't. I don't know how." Adora said with slight trepidation. "Just try not to move, okay."

She groaned in pain and irritation. She couldn't make sense of her surroundings but she noticed Bow was holding her tablet. "Designated. . . Administrator." She rasped, "EF-66. . ." She started coughing.

Bow looked at the tablet as it lit up. Adora understood the code immediately as she took the tablet from Bow. "Designated Administrator EF-66666."

The tablet flashed red. *"Unrecognized biological codes. Confirmation code required."*

"Pink morning." Catra said. Her vision was getting a bit dark by this point. Probably due to the lack of oxygen in her system.

"*Welcome, Catra."*

"She needs to rest and stop talking!" The doctor said as he went to sedate her. Adora grabbed his wrist.

"No, whatever she's trying to show me is clearly important. I trust her judgment." Adora said before bringing the tablet near her face.

"Crystal. . . Castle. Log 2" Catra said weakly before laying back down.

"Is that it?" Adora asked gently. Catra nodded before closing her eyes, doing her best to relax.

Adora nodded before turning to watch it with Bow, Glimmer, and Angella. As the video opened, it showed the Crystal Castle from a pov that Adora quickly identified as Light Hope.

Adora stepped into the Crystal Castle with a smile on her face. "Hey, Light Hope. I'm ready to begin training. Is Mara available?" Adora asked, gaining a more serious tone.

Light Hope nodded, "Mara is currently residing in her quarters in the Royal Palace of Eternos. I can contact her if you wish."

Adora blinked before gaining a look of understanding. "Oh right. Our times are different aren't they? Is she asleep? I don't want to bother her."

Light Hope shook her head. "Fortunately, you are somewhat mistaken. Eternia and Etheria are on reversed lunar cycles. While our Etheria may be approaching sunset for you. It is very much close to the same time right now."

"*So while Mara's on Eternia we're running on the same time frame?"*

"*Yes, although I calculate that the time is off by forty three minutes and twenty six seconds." Light Hope said.*

Adora nodded to herself before looking at Light Hope. "Yeah, if you could get Mara that would be great."

Light Hope continued to smile. "One moment." She said as her eyes lip up in a digital glow.

Suddenly a hologram appeared and the Crystal Castle shifted into Mara's quarters. Adora took note of Catra laying on a bed off to the side. Entrapta was right in the sense that Catra doesn't move when she's switched.

"That's Mara?" Glimmer asked.

"I guess so." Adora said as they continued watching.

"*Yeah, I suppose that's weird for you, huh?" Mara said from behind her.*

"*A little bit, but it's alright." Adora said as she gazed at Catra's image blissfully.*

Mara stared at her for a moment before smiling. "Y'know, you both look like that when you're talking about one another. Maybe you should say something to one another."

Adora smiled as she turned to look at Mara. "We did."

Mara's eyes widened, "Oh! Uh, congratulations. I see it went well?"

Adora nodded, "She told me last night at the celebration for the war's end."

"War's end? What!" Glimmer exclaimed in shock. Angella shushed her as they continued to focus.

Mara grinned, "Well good for you two. I'm happy for you. In fact we should take advantage of this."

Adora frowned, "What do you mean?"

Mara pulled her sword out and held it in front of her. "See, She Ra works a little differently from other magics. Our power isn't something that you can command just through meditation and discipline, although it helps. She Ra's power has an emotional aspect as well. Positivity and love play a big part in the power as well."

"*Oh, I see. Is that why I haven't been able to heal? I thought I had healed Catra earlier but we were unsure of it until Catra told*

me that you were healing her at the same time." Adora explained, a bit of dejection slipping into her voice.

"*Hey, don't worry about it. Healing isn't something I could do right away either. It took training. So, let's get to it. We'll start with the basics."*

Adora quickly realized why Catra had shown her the video. She immediately started skipping through the video rapidly.

This is how you shapeshift your–

A beam attack is–

Your link with Swift–

Finally she stopped when she heard the words she was looking for.

"*Alright. Since I know that you're a bit hung up on that particular ability, that will be our primary focus for today's lesson." Mara clapped her hands.*

"*Thank you." Adora said with a smile.*

"*Now, when you heal, it's not the same as the other abilities we possess. If you let aggression or frustration, basically any emotion associated with conflict, into your efforts then the magic will become volatile and dangerous.'*

Adora watched as the video version of herself tried and failed before becoming a little frustrated. Mara kept her patience before ushering her towards her.

"*Let's try something else. I can see you're afraid of the power. It's understandable. I was too for a time. We are the most powerful forces in the universe and because of that we must always be vigilant of the harm we can cause. But that doesn't mean that you should fear it. You need to let go of that fear and press forward. Show the courage that I know you possess." Mara gave a gentle*

smile before looking towards Catra, "Focus on her. Focus on the feelings associated with that moment. Let the magic flow through you."

Adora watched as she lit up with a golden light, her sword thrumming.

Adora closed the video before taking a deep breath and transforming into She Ra. Catra cracked an eye open but otherwise remained silent. For the next minute or so, Adora focused on the feelings that Mara had just explained. She was right about it though. She was afraid. Afraid that she would fail. But she was also right in that she needed to move past it. And so, Adora, after several seconds of silence, began to glow. Glimmer watched as Adora mimicked the video perfectly and laid a hand on Catra's shoulder. In the bright light, everyone averted their gaze before it slowly died. As they all looked back at Catra, they found her opening her eyes.

She let out a breath before slowly standing. She looked at all of them with a blank expression before turning her gaze at the shards littered around the room on various tables. Everyone back stepped as she glitched again, her appearance momentarily shifting to that of her queenly appearance before turning back. She snarled before kicking the table across the room, sending the shards far away from her. A glow emanating off of her skin.

"Catra, calm down! Talk to me!" Adora said as she shifted back to herself from She Ra.

Catra shook her head, her lips pursed, "Just keep those fucking things away from me!" I'm sick of it!"

Her memories were all over the place and she now knew why. Shadow Weaver had messed with the obelisk. The timeline that she had envisioned subconsciously had been tarnished. She had felt the bond finish before the Shadow Weaver had started to drain her, had started to kill her. But it seems that that perfect future was a lie. Because here they were, back at square one. But

this time, she knew it was real. She could feel the bond, the magic, and she was repulsed by it. By the anguish and strife it had caused her and her friends. She swore then, that if Shadow Weaver was alive and she ever saw her again, she would kill her.

Glimmer sent a small glare of irritation at Catra before leaning down and picking up a piece. Instantly, Glimmer felt it. It felt familiar, alive. "This is a runestone!"

"What?" Bow asked in shock.

Glimmer nodded before Angella walked over, taking it from her daughter. True to her words, it was indeed a runestone. But it felt locked. Angella side eyed Catra before walking towards her with the shard. Catra sent a charged glare at the woman as her claws extended. Angella stopped as she noticed the shard's glow got brighter the closer it got to the young woman. Catra also glitched once again when she was in its vicinity. Angella let out a grunt. "So that's how it is then?"

"What is it?" Adora asked.

"It would seem that this version of Catra is a princess." Angella said with a neutral tone.

Catra took advantage of everyone's shock before snaking her hand at Adora, stealing the tablet from her. "System lock sequence LH-53."

Adora whipped her head at the doppelganger of her former friend. "Some gratitude would be nice."

Catra scoffed, "Thanks." She looked around the room, recognizing it as the med bay of Bright Moon. A flash of memory shot through her as she remembered fighting Shadow Weaver while simultaneously running for the obelisk. It seems Shadow Weaver had been right, her psyche had been split. "How did I get here?"

"We found you bleeding out in the snow up in the Northern Reach." Bow explained. We did our best to keep you alive until we

got back to Bright Moon."

"The Northern Reach?" Catra muttered to herself. Why would she be all the way up there?

Glimmer teleported in front of her,causing her to take a step back, "Talk Horde Scum. What's your game?"

Catra rolled her eyes before shoving past Glimmer. She'd done this song and dance twice already and she wouldn't be doing it a third time. She walked up to Bow before noticing the staff he was holding. She narrowed her eyes, "Where did you get that?"

"You were using it as a crutch when we found you. Why? Isn't it yours?" Bow asked, confused.

"No. Shadow Weaver made it to try and kill me with it. It looks a little different now but it's still hers no doubt." Catra said as she let out a slight sneer.

"You mean *your* Shadow Weaver?" Adora asked.

Catra nodded, "Yeah, my Shadow Weaver. At least you picked up on that quickly."

An explosion of shards flying through her body before being blown off of her feet

Catra clutched her head before glitching again. She quickly pushed out of the doors before walking away from the room as she tried to catch her breath. Another glitch. She felt her very being becoming unstable. As she tried to take another step, she realized that she was a few feet forward more than she had intended. Another glitch.

Angella watched quietly as Adora walked up to her with concern. Angella walked up to the shards before examining them. Once she had examined them thoroughly she laid them in the correct order before watching as they pulled themselves together. With each piece that fused together, Angella witnessed Catra's form change

a little more. Nothing overtly major. Her height gained an inch or two and her hair lost its wild form before turning more straight and silky. What was the most interesting to her though was not the physical changes that occurred on Catra, no. It was that her tablet shifted to an intricate designed, beautiful bracer with a purple gem on her wrist.

Angella looked down at the gem in her hands before looking at Catra. She seemed to have stopped glitching. The runestone itself was missing a lot of itself. Maybe seventy percent of it but she could see the shape more or less. It looked like a pillar.

"I said not to touch it." Catra growled.

"Well, considering you were on the fritz a moment ago, I'd say that it was for the best." Angella said. "Care to explain?"

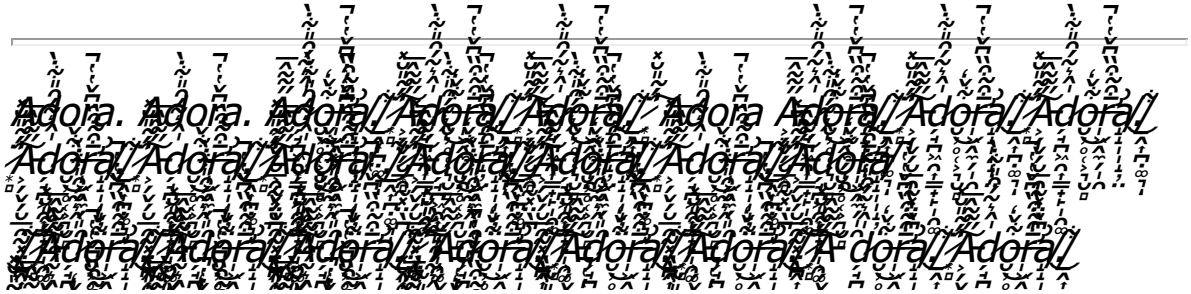
"No." Catra said before turning to walk off towards the main hall.

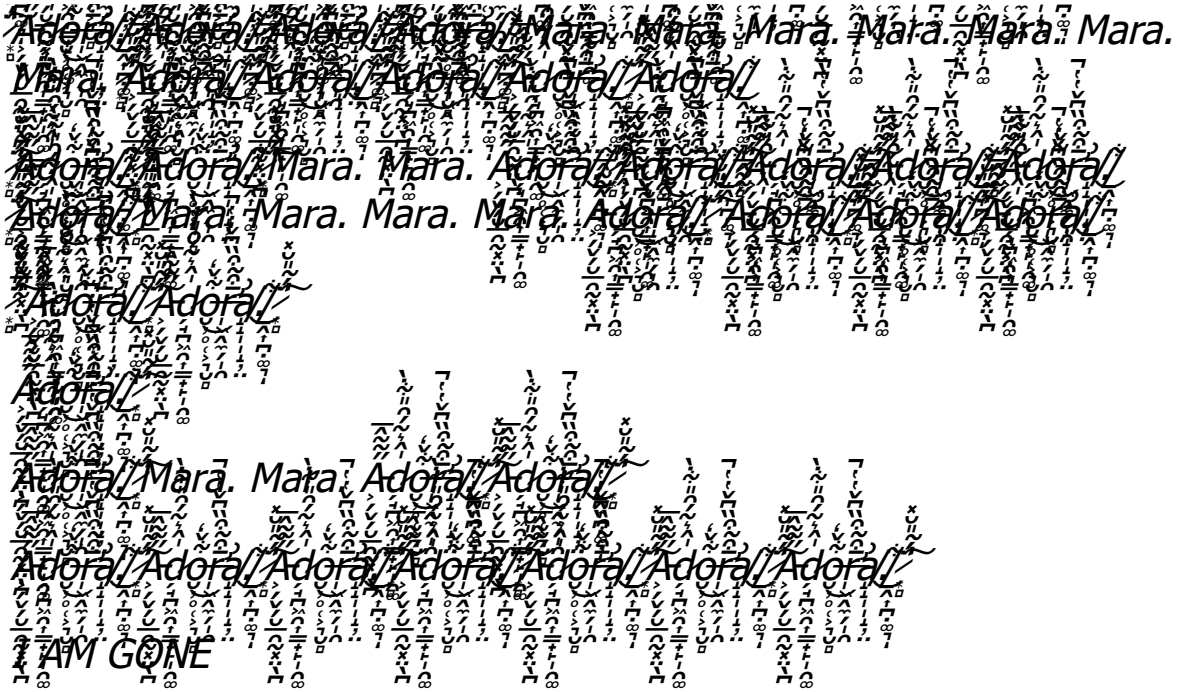
Angella let out a sigh before turning towards Glimmer, "Follow her. Make sure she doesn't get into anything."

Glimmer nodded before teleporting besides Adora and Bow. Angella knew that this was a much less hostile version of the Force Captain she had heard about. The first video she had watched had shown Catra in Bright Moon inside Adora's room. The second video all but confirmed her initial suspicions regarding the wing pin and the ring. Adora and Catra were in a relationship. Perhaps due to the war's end where she was from? No matter. She'd get Castaspella's opinion soon enough.

"Guards, can you please move this to the spare bedroom?"

They nodded before they went to move it.





Writing this chapter sucked! Never have I had to rewrite a chapter FOUR TIMES! . . . But it's done so, yeah.

I want to give a shout out to the person who guessed it correctly that Razz was actually Shadow Weaver and that none of that was really happening in a broad sense. I was genuinely surprised someone guessed it.

But like always, enjoy, comment, I always appreciate the feedback and Happy Thanksgiving for those who celebrate.

Chapter 5

"It's working! We did it! Guys, you gotta see this" Bow exclaimed in excitement before looking around in confusion.

Catra let out a sigh as she walked out onto the roof. She'd awoken to shouting from outside her window. Granted, she was probably the only person in the castle with good enough senses to pick up on it.

"Please tell me you got the message." Adora said as her and Glimmer huddled around Bow.

"Some of it's degraded. Can you read the rest?" He asked, handing her the pad.

"Serenia. Portal. Mara." Adora said before looking at Glimmer, "What's a Serenia?"

"I don't know. But if it has to do with Mara, it can't be good."

"Serenia," Catra started, causing them to turn in surprise, "is an officer in Mara's squadron, Grayskull."

"So it's a name?" Bow said, looking back down at the tracker pad.

"Yeah. It's a name." Catra said flatly.

Glimmer eyed her suspiciously, "And how do you know that?"

Catra stayed quiet, considering her options. For the last couple of days, she'd chosen to stay relatively silent offering the barest pieces of information that might be needed. When Castaspella had arrived to inspect the staff, she'd thought about Micah and wondered if that had been another cruel trick, putting him on Beast Island. Unfortunately, she had been told by her Angella that she was sure he was dead.

"Fine, stay quiet." Glimmer snapped.

". . .Her sister's a good friend." Catra simply said.

"And who's that? Another time travel buddy of yours?" Glimmer said with a huff.

Catra couldn't fault her for the suspicion. Ever since she'd been healed, she'd told them nothing that would be of value and the only evidence they had that she wasn't a part of the Horde was the video that had told them that her war had ended.

Catra shook her head, "It's better if you don't ask questions about me. Your war is still going on. Mine ended about. . . a week ago." Catra realized that it felt so much longer than that.

Her memories were filtering themselves. She knew that if the obelisk was reformed, she would change. Irreversibly change into the queen of Eternia and become Catra D'riluth. And that scared her. The unknown, the commitment, the feelings that nothing was certain anymore and that this timeline was the last connection she would have to this past. Would she lose her memories of her childhood in the Horde? Her experiences? Would she even be her anymore?

"Catra?" Bow asked with some slight concern as she glitched again.

Catra scoffed. That had been happening a lot. She knew that until she was completely herself, she would keep glitching. "I'm fine, Bow."

Glimmer groaned. "Will you at least tell us what the deal is with the glitching? Why do you look older and more," Glimmer waved her hands down herself, "princess-ish? Are you really a princess?"

Catra let out a sigh. "Fine. Fine. Tomorrow morning. I'll tell you why I'm glitching. Will that appease you?"

Glimmer crossed her arms, "For now, I suppose."

"Great. Now if you guys are finished doing whatever it is you're doing, I'm going back to sleep." Catra said before turning to leave.

Adora was wondering about it as well. She knew that Catra could keep a secret. If she didn't want to tell them, she wouldn't. Adora hummed, "What's 'Pink Morning?'"

"Come again?" Catra said, looking back over her shoulder.

"Your password on your. . ." Adora pointed at her wrist.

"It's an azurlight. It's. . ." Catra looked at it, trying to piece it together before Light Hope came to the forefront of her mind. "It was a gift."

Adora nodded. "Your azurlight. Before, I mean. When it was still a trackerpad."

"A pink morning is a drink that I like." Catra shrugged before going back into the castle.

"Have you ever heard of a pink morning?" Adora asked her friends.

"Nope." Glimmer said to which Bow nodded in agreement. "Maybe my mom knows?"

"Catra!" Adora said shapely, waking her from her sleep.

She sat up, groggily wiping the sleep from her eyes, realizing that the light was barely peeking past the horizon. "What?"

"We need your help. Bow's gone." Glimmer said.

Catra let out a tired sigh before dragging herself out of bed. Quickly getting dressed and splashing some water in her face, she turned back towards Glimmer and Adora. "Does your mom know that you're taking me out of Bright Moon?"

"We can worry about that later. For now, let's go!" Glimmer shouted before grabbing them and teleporting.

"Bow's trackerpad and arrows are gone. He must have left after he shot that note through my window." Glimmer said as they quickly strided through the whispering woods.

"The note that says, 'I'm fine. Don't follow me.'?" Adora asked as Glimmer dragged her. Catra let out a chuckle at that.

Glimmer groaned before turning towards Adora. "He's not fine. We have to follow him. If he was, he would've told us he was leaving. And after finding out the signal is about Mara–"

Adora put a comforting hand on Glimmer's shoulder. "Okay, okay, Glimmer, just calm down. I agree, okay? So, where does Bow go when he's not at Bright Moon?"

Glimmer stuttered over her words, "Uh…"

"Seriously? How long have you two been friends, again?" Catra said with a raised eyebrow.

Adora nodded along, "Exactly."

"Look, Bow really values his privacy. He's never talked about his past or where he came from. Never. And you know how talkative and open Bow usually is. Something's wrong. What if he's in trouble?" Glimmer said before grabbing Adora's hand and dragging her along again.

As they walked through the woods, Catra sniffed the air. Adora stopped and looked at Catra. "What is it?"

"I smell oric wax." Catra replied.

"What's that?" Adora asked.

"It's the wax that Bow uses on his bow and arrows to keep them in good condition." Glimmer said as she began to look around before spotting his gear under a bush.

Glimmer let out a gasp as she picked them up, "There's no way Bow would ever leave his trick arrows behind. I told you, he's in trouble."

"Don't jump to conclusions. There's no sign of a struggle. Bow's footprints are the only ones we've seen. And his bow and arrows were placed under a bush, hidden from view. I also don't smell any blood." Catra listed off her reasons.

Glimmer looked at Catra with a small glare. "Then what reason would you suggest?"

Before Catra could respond, Adora spoke up. "What is that place?"

Before them was a pillared building with vegetation growing along its walls. Glimmer and Adora looked at one another before Adora laid a hand on Glimmer's shoulder before they teleported inside, leaving her behind. Catra rolled her eyes as she glitched before heading towards the door. "Oh, don't forget about me or anything."

It took her a few minutes to get to the building. As she approached the front door, her ears picked up the conversation.

"*This is Adora and Glimmer, my friends from the academy. Adora, Glimmer, meet my dads."*

"*Adora, Glimmer." A male voice said with joy.*

"*Oh, we're so happy to finally meet Bow's school friends." another one said with excitement. "Come, come. I'm sure you all have stories to tell. I'm Lance and this is my husband George."*

"*You want anything, you just tell me, and I'll get it. You want snacks? I'll get you snacks."*

"*Yes, so energetic. Heh. You girls must love attending the Academy of Historic Enterprises with Bow."*

Catra realized this was Bow's home. A sly grin made its way onto her face as she thought of a way to get payback for leaving her behind in the woods. As she headed for the front door, she listened in.

"*Uhh... Yes. Absolutely." Glimmer responded.*

"*Yup. Wouldn't change a thing." Adora laughed nervously, "At the academy, that we all go to." she said awkwardly, enunciating the word 'academy.'*

"*Oh, I bet you're here to see our collection of First Ones artifacts. We got some new pottery shards. I–"*

Catra knocked on the door, cutting off the conversation. As she waited patiently, the door opened after a moment, showing an older man with short hair and a mustache. He bore a bit of a resemblance to Bow and stood eye level with herself.. He gave a slightly cautious look. Catra took a deep breath before giving a warm smile. "Hi, is this the residence of Bow?"

"May I ask your name?" He said somewhat defensively.

Catra nodded, "Oh, where are my manners? I'm Professor D'riluth, one of Bow's teachers at the Academy of Historic Enterprises. One of his friends, Glimmer, her mother informed me that she and Adora had accompanied him to his home. I felt the need to make sure he got here safely. With the war one can't be too careful."

Catra watched the man's eyes light up at the prospect of meeting one of Bow's teachers. "Oh, of course. Yes, Bow and his friends all made it here safely. Please come in. We'd love to have you."

Catra nodded thanks as she entered the home. She was taken in at the library. Catra looked at Adora, Bow, and Glimmer and gave a toothy smirk before changing her face to one of concern. "Oh, thank goodness you all made it here safely."

"Yeah, Bow can be quite shy when it comes to such things. But as you can see, They are all here." George said with a warm smile. Before Adora could get a word out, George called out. "Lance, come meet Bow's teacher. This is Professor D'riluth."

It took all of her strength to not break down into laughter at the looks the best friend squad gave her. "Catra is fine. I'm very nonformal most of the time."

"It's so nice to finally meet one of Bow's teachers. When Bow told us he'd been accepted into the academy we were overjoyed that he was taking his first steps into following the family tradition." George said as Lance came back with snacks and a cup of tea for Catra.

Catra smiled as she took the tea, "Thank you. I have to say it's finally nice to meet you both. Bow's so private about his home life that I've only ever heard tidbits here and there."

George nodded, "Yes, Bow is much more reserved than his brothers. That's true."

Glimmer immediately choked on her drink, "Brother?"

"Oh, Bow has an older brother? How nice." Adora said quietly.

Lance nodded excitedly, "Youngest of 13, all historians just like us. And just like Bow when he graduates and takes over the library. Right Bow?"

Bow quietly looked at Glimmer before letting his drink fall out of his mouth. Cartra gave a chuckle.

George shook his head, "Don't bother, Lance. It looks like he's not very cha-tea today." He said before laughing at his pun. Lance let out a groan.

Bow put his tea down before standing, "Okay, thanks for the tea and the snacks, but I think my friends would really like–"

"A tour of the library." Lance interrupted. Bow's eye twitched in annoyance. "Of course our Bow would find people who share his zest for history. Just wait till we show you the oldest and newest parts of our collection. Shards from two ancient and defunct runestones."

Catra's head snapped up, looking at the man before the worst thing that could happen chose to occur. Catra's body glitched. Lance and George let out cries of surprise. "What was that!"

Catra coughed into her hand, "Ah, that. Well, you see, my studies take me all over Etheria and on one of my expeditions I came into contact with a piece of Eternian technology that had a bit of an effect on me. Most days it's nonexistent, others it happens quite often. It's quite harmless." Thankfully, the glitch happened one time and they hadn't gotten a good look at her other self.

George let out a sigh, "Another reason to confirm my thoughts. If it wasn't of historical value, that thing would be long gone. No need to keep a reminder of the Princesses and their war here."

Glimmer looked confused, "But. . . the Horde started the war. The Princesses are fighting to save Etheria."

George shook his head, solemnly, before walking towards the fireplace, "You're too young to remember the first failed Princess Alliance. I'm not. I enlisted, fought for what I thought was right."

Bow started, "Dad, can we not–"

George looked into the fire as he recounted his past, "When I came home, there was nothing left of my village but ash. I vowed then that my family would never get mixed up in fighting or the Princesses again."

Lance took George's hands, giving them a comforting kiss before turning towards them, "Well, I know what will lighten the mood, baby pictures. I've got some great ones from Bow's first bubble bath."

Bow stood up in irritation, "I'm gonna show Adora, Catra, and Glimmer my room now!"

Adora looked up in excitement, "I wanna see the bubble baths!"

"I too want to see the bubble baths." Catra said laughing.

Bow glared at them, "Now!" he said before pushing them out of the room.

"Bow, what is going on?" Glimmer asked.

Bow groaned, "My dads don't know I'm a Rebellion fighter. They think I'm at boarding school and I'm supposed to be on break right now."

Glimmer looked at Bow in understanding, "So, this is why you never talked about your past? I thought it was because it was dark and painful for you, but your dads seem so nice and normal."

"Look, I love my dads, okay? I never mentioned them, because they decided when I was a little kid that I was gonna be the one to stay home and take over the library when they retire. But I wanted to travel, to fight. So, I did the only thing I could. I secretly taught myself archery, ran away, and pretended I was at a made-up boarding school."

Catra snickered before Adora spoke up, "That seems really elaborate, Bow."

"You saw what they're like. They don't listen to me. They just assume they know what I want. And if Lance knew I didn't want to be a historian. . . Worse, if George knew that I'm a Rebellion soldier fighting alongside Princesses, it'd kill them."

Glimmer looked at Bow in concern, "So, you're gonna lie to them forever?"

Bow gave a small smile, before putting his hands together, "Not forever. Just for the foreseeable future. It's worked so far. Please?

For me? Besides, my dads have the biggest collection of First Ones artifacts and writings in Etheria. This is the perfect place to look for answers about She-Ra, the Mara message, Serenia, everything."

Adora smiled, "Sure, why not? We can be scho-lars. How hard can it be?"

"Actually, I'm your pro-fess-or." Catra snickered, copying Adora's speech pattern. "Professor of Eter-ni-an Studies."

Glimmer groaned, running her hand down her face, "This is gonna be a disaster."

Bow smiled, "Well, maybe with that attitude it will be. By the way, I may have said in my letters that Glimmer is a physics major, Adora's an art major, nobody is a Princess or has magical powers, and we all met freshman year Okay? Let's go."

"This is the 1000-year-old Colonia pitcher. And this tablet dates back over two millennia. And this is where Bow played pretend as a little boy." Lance exclaimed, excitedly showing off their collection of artifacts before pulling back a blanket to show a small crawl space with toys and pillows.

Catra laughed at Bow's embarrassment before he shot a glare at her.

"Let me guess. Playing pirates?" Glimmer asked with a smile.

Lance shook his head, "Oh, no. Bow doesn't like pirates. Playing *historian*, getting ready to take over the library even then. Right, Bow?"

Bow grimaced, "Right."

Adora stood up with a smirk, "Mr. Bow's dad, sir, as First Ones histori-ans, do you know anything about the lore of She-Ra?"

Lance clapped his hands together, "Ah... Great question. Accurate translations are hard to come by, but we think the name was actually, Her-Ra."

Adora snorted, "Well, that's not right."

Bow snaked an arm around her shoulders, "But you don't know that for sure, Adora." he said, laughing uncomfortably.

"She'd fight for the power of Grayskull"

Adora looked a little offended, "It's 'For the Honor of Grayskull.'"

Lance pointed at a vase with a depiction of Orsa and Mara, "And rode on a dragon."

Adora gasped, "Wait, she got a dragon? I wish I had a–"

Bow laughed nervously, covering Adora's mouth.

Catra took a moment to speak. "The dragon's name was Orsa. And the translation you're referring to was a chant said by the Eternian legend Hi Ro."

Lance looked intrigued, "Really? Fascinating." He said with astoundment before clearing his throat, "Anyway, uh, where was I?"

George walked forwards, "Princess nonsense." He said before opening a veil and revealing a runestone shard.

"The runestone shard. It's the oldest First Ones object in our collection." Lance said.

Catra stepped forward to examine it. Her eyes lit up as she sensed a spark of magic present in it. "This isn't a natural runestone."

"Really? How can you tell?" Lance asked.

Catra tapped her azurlight before aiming her wrist at it. A light began scanning it. "Because the magic that's primed in it or

rather, what little remains, is artificial. No. This wasn't for a princess. This was to control a type of magic."

George watched the gem on Catra's wrist as it scanned the runestone with interest. After a moment, the scanning stopped. Catra pulled up a screen before speaking, "Analyze the arcane signature. Tell me the type of magic and purpose."

"*Analysis complete. The magic signature is Esoteric in nature. Its purpose would allow the user to utilize ferromancy."* Her azurlight informed her.

Even Bow looked a little interested in that. "Ferromancy? What type of magic is that?"

George spoke up. "It's the control of metal and magnetism. It would make sense to want to be able to utilize such abilities if you are building metal objects of large stature. But why would it have shattered?"

Catra shook her head, "My guess? Trying to put the entire magnetic field into a single runestone, especially an artificial one, was never going to work. Still, it was a good attempt nonetheless."

Lance looked positively buzzing with excitement, "I can't believe we just got a lesson from one of Bow's teachers. But enough about us. Tell us about your studies, Adora and Glimmer."

Glimmer laughed nervously, "Uh, you know, the physics are good."

Adora smiled, "The history is also good."

Lance looked a little confused, "Uh... I thought you were an art major?"

Bow put his hands on Adora's shoulders, coming to her rescue, "Uh, she's a double major."

Adora tried to salvage the mistake, "Uh, yes. History, art, art history, that's three. I'm a triple ma-jor. And I also teach, unless that's not a thing students do. Is it hot in here? I mean–"

George ignored them for a moment before turning towards Glimmer, "It's really great to finally meet you, Glimmer. Gotta be honest, we thought Bow was making you up."

Glimmer looked at the man with a smile, "Really?"

George nodded, "You know how Bow is: shy, quiet, not so many friends. From his letters it sounds like you really brought him out of his shell."

Glimmer looked at Bow, "Uh, yeah. I guess I did."

Catra looked at Bow and Adora flailing before cutting in, "Perhaps your fathers can help you with my homework assignment, Bow?"

Bow understood immediately, "Yeah, we got this First Ones puzzle to solve. But the last word is giving us trouble. Have you ever heard of Serenia?"

Lance gained an excited look, before seating them and running to grab several scrolls and books before dumping them in front of them.

George spoke up, "Serenia was the name of a mythical First Ones hero. Although some of us think she was a real person."

Lance looked affronted, "Mm-hmm. Some of us also think the Elberon vase dates back only one millennium."

Bow looked at his parents, "Is this everything you have on Serenia?"

Lance shook his head, "Oh, no. I'm so sorry. Ha, ha. Everything from the first floor. There's lots more on the second.

Glimmer groaned, "Ugh, this is gonna take hours."

Lance gave George a loving look, "Hours, days, maybe weeks. And if you're really lucky, it might take you a whole lifetime."

George chuckled, "Uh. You're so corny."

"So, Professor Catra, what do you teach? You said this was your homework assignment?" Lance asked.

"Ah, I'm surprised Bow never mentioned me. I teach the studies and theories of the Eternians." Catra said as Adora picked up one of the scrolls.

Lance and George gasped, "You're a teacher on the study of the First Ones?"

"Well, this one's just about aqueducts, so, it's mislabeled."

"Wait, you can read First Ones writing!" Lance asked in shock as he and George rushed to her side.

Catra quickly spoke up, saving Adora from the situation, "I teach a course on phonetics, phonics, and linguistics. Adora is the only one here to have taken it. Bow hasn't had the chance yet. But I have no doubt with a library like this, he must be dying to learn how to read it all."

George stuck his arm out towards Adora. "What does this say?"

Adora looked at the tattoo, "Uh, it says lunch."

Lance started laughing as George looked shaken, "Oh no. I thought it said love."

"You thought it said–" Lance burst out into laughter, "I like this girl! Actually there's one more debate you can settle for us, Adora." He said.

Adora looked a bit uncomfortable. "I dunno. Maybe I should help with the, uh, school project." She said before Lance shot her with a puppy dog eyed look, "But I guess it couldn't hurt."

Lance gained a look of excitement, "Great. Onward, best research squad!"

Catra laughed at her as they led the way. Once they were looking away, Adora jabbed her in the shoulder. This only made Catra laugh even more as Adora left with them.

As they left, Catra looked towards the fireplace before shooting a fireball into it, relighting it. Glimmer and Bow looked at her in surprise, "You can do magic?"

Catra shifted a bit as she sat down. "It's. . . Look, I said I'd explain and I will. This is part of that. Just be patient. Once we get back to Bright Moon, okay?"

Glimmer didn't like it but nodded. Catra nodded back, "Great."

Catra stood up after a few minutes, "I'm gonna go look at the other books here. I want to see if I can find anything that doesn't match up with my history." Bow nodded and Glimmer looked a bit grateful at the chance for some alone time with Bow.

After a half hour of perusing the library and blocking out Bow and Glimmer's conversation, she headed back before she heard a large roar and a loud crash. Immediately running back to the main room, Catra heard Adora's She Ra chant.

As she rushed out to the scaffolding, she jumped back, dodging debris. She looked down at Adora in her She Ra form before looking at the monster that was currently fighting her, Glimmer, and Bow. Before she could rush down, Bow shot the runestone shard before holding it out to the robotic bug. Instantly, it stopped attacking before taking the shard and turning into a ball. Catra sighed in relief before heading for the stairs overhearing the conversation as she headed down.

Bow looked down, "I... I lied to you. There is no Academy of Historic Enterprises. I've been living at Bright Moon, fighting in the Rebellion alongside Adora and Princess Glimmer."

Lance and George looked at one another before Lance spoke up, "But... why?"

Bow finally looked his fathers in the eye, "I don't wanna be a historian. I've never wanted to be a historian. I'm not a shy bookworm. I'm not a genius like you two. I make things. I'm a soldier. This is who I am. And I can't lie about it anymore, even though I know I'm breaking your hearts."

George silently walked up to him as Bow looked away, closing his eyes. After a moment, George gave his son a hug, "What's breaking our hearts is the fact that you thought you had to lie about who you are."

Bow looked at him in confusion, "You're not mad? But I'm a fighter, and you hate fighters."

George smiled, "I could never hate you. Never. If you feel like you belong in the Rebellion, that's where you belong."

Lance put a hand on George's shoulder, "Oh, Bow, why didn't you just tell us?"

Bow looked at him, "I tried, but you didn't listen. You only listened to me if I said what you wanted to hear."

Lance and George looked at one another before looking back at Bow, "We had no idea you felt that way. We, we were just trying to encourage you to pursue your dreams. We thought we were being supportive when we really were being terrible." Lance said before tearing up.

George teared up, "We love you the way you are, Bow. And, we're proud of you, no matter what path you take in life." He said before pulling them into a hug.

Glimmer let out a sob before George looked at them. "This is a family hug, Princesses. You're Bow's family, too." He said before they joined him into a hug.

As Catra came walking down the stairs, she began to glitch frequently. This caught everyone's attention as the glitching became so frequent it was hard to discern which Catra they were looking at.

"Uh, Catra? What's going on?" Adora asked.

Catra looked at her hands before she held her head, wincing in slight pain. She looked around before focusing on Lance, "You said you had a shard of a runestone? A new one. Is it blue?"

"Uh, yes, but there's actually a few. They're lying on the ground over there beside the collapsed bookcase. But why are you so. . . glitchy?"

Catra looked towards it and immediately recognized it as a piece of the obelisk. As she walked over towards them, she picked them up before her body began to look more glitch than physical. As soon as she touched them, she heard three voices.

"Catra, are you alright?" Glimmer asked in concern.

Catra let out a breath, knowing what she had to do. She laid the shards on the ground in the clearing and stepped away. They all watched as the shards began to hover, energy arcing off one another before pulling themselves together to form a perfect single shard.

The glitching stopped but two things happened in that moment. Catra's form grew older and slightly more mature and her eyes looked more vibrant. In Adora's opinion, she looked closer to her early twenties.

The second thing to happen was a portal opened in front of them, dropping the forms of three people in front of them before disappearing as quickly as it came. Bow looked at them as they groaned. Catra immediately went to help them up.

"Are you alright?" Catra asked.

They all froze before looking up. Upon seeing Catra, they immediately bowed. Catra went to stop them before they could speak but she was too late. Andra spoke before she could stop her. "Queen Catra! You're safe, thank Sharella. After the wedding we–"

"Queen!" Glimmer said in shock. Adora and Bow's looks mirrored Glimmer's.

Lyra and Caitlyn looked at them but their gaze turned towards Adora with confusion. Before they could speak, Catra interjected. "That's not our Adora." She sighed before looking at everyone. "Everyone might as well sit down. I guess that explanation is happening now rather than later."

Catra looked at the broken furniture everywhere before throwing her hand out, rewinding everything to what it was before the battle. She felt her time magic for the first time since waking up and knew it was much weaker. In fact, if she pushed herself more than what she just did, she had no doubt she would have passed out. The fact that Andra had to steady her was all she needed to know.

"I know your lax security allowed Shadow Weaver to escape. I know you've been covering it up. Lying about her whereabouts. But worst of all, I gave you a chance to come clean, to prove your worth to–" an alarm blared out in the sanctum as Hordak looked at Catra before he walked back, shutting the device off and allowing Catra to breathe again. "If you value your life, you will remain there."

Hordak looked at the screen before his eyes widened. Another portal had been detected. This one was much closer. It was in the whispering woods. As Catra gasped for air behind him, drinking in the oxygen that she had been deprived of, Entrapta came falling through the vent in the ceiling before swinging to the ground with her hair..

She stopped for a moment, looking at Catra with some slight concern before turning back towards Hordak with excitement after seeing she was alright. "Hordak! I've got a lot to cover and not a lot of time. I'm still working on integrating the First Ones tech from the Northern Reach into our portal machine. But that's besides the point.

"I've just picked up a powerful signal of First Ones tech in the Whispering Woods. It's easily the most powerful signal I've ever seen. It could be a perfect addition. I don't want to jump to conclusions, but I think this could very well be a piece of a First Ones ship." She turned towards Catra, "You'll need to gather Scorpia and get on it ASAP. It's close enough to Bright Moon that they could get to it first."

"Catra is no longer a concern of yours. She's going to be sent to Beast Island." He growled as he glared at Catra. Catra felt a pang of fear shoot through her as she eyed the doors. Before she could even move, Entrapta spoke up in defence of her.

"I'm confused." She said before swinging in front of him. "As you can see, the overall productivity of the Horde has increased four hundred percent since Catra has been your second-in-command. And look at this chart." Hordak eyed it with annoyance. "The evidence shows that First Ones tech has gotten us closer than ever to creating a working portal. Catra has been incredibly successful at getting new tech for us. Much more so than any squad the Horde has utilized ever. If we were to get rid of Catra, our results would take a massive dip that could set us back by months, maybe longer. We don't have a moment to spare. We need Catra!"

Hordak looked at the data before comparing it to the portal. It was the exact same location. He growled under his breath before straightening his shoulders and turning towards Catra. "Entrapta has interceded on your behalf. Thank her, for if I had it any other way, you would be getting prepped for transport. Instead of the many punishments I intended, you are being sent to retrieve First Ones tech for us. Entrapta herself will be going with you along

with Force Captain Scorpia." He leaned down to her, inches from her face, "Retrieve the technology and find out what the portal left. If you cannot even accomplish one of those tasks, do not bother coming back. Now get out!"

Catra shakily got to her feet before stumbling out of the sanctum beside Entrapta. She let out a shaky breath before looking at Entrapta. She gave her a comforting smile before helping Catra stand. "Are you alright, Catra?"

". . . Thank you." Catra said as she finally got her strength back. "Let's hurry."

Entrapta nodded, "Right."

Catra sat in front of everyone as they all sipped tea. Lance and George had been grateful when she had rewound the damages but they weren't blind to the strain it took on her. Catra finished her story with Adora healing her a couple days ago.

Lance spoke up first. "So, you're actually the queen of the First Ones from an alternate timeline?"

"And the more you reforge your runestone, the more you become your true self again?" George asked.

"And the you from this timeline is part of the Horde?" Lance finished, baffled.

Catra nodded. Andra's squad knew about this more or less, pieces of it anyways, but were shocked to hear that a lot of her memories were not intact. Andra spoke up, her concern palpable, "So, do you even remember your childhood on Primus? Can you even remember your mother?"

Catra let out a sigh before shrugging and shaking her head, "It's broken. I was never supposed to end up here. When Shadow Weaver manipulated the timeline, er, the *new* timeline, it messed everything up. I remember my mother. I remember loving the

beaches behind the royal palace in Eternos. My memories regarding my mother are. . . twisted. Split. I have a memory of her being absolutely spiteful, yet I can't help but feel that that was Shadow Weaver manipulating me. And then I have a few happier ones with my mother, Randor, and Marleena."

Caitlyn spoke up, "You're mother and you had your moments but she was never cruel to you. Whatever this witch was, whoever she was, if she lives, she will not get to you. We swear it."

Lyra and Andra nodded in agreement. Adora, on the other hand, looked confused. "That can't be the whole thing, right? It seems like pieces are missing."

"Of course not." Catra said. "I've left out quite a bit. But you asked how I knew magic and where I was from. So. . . I gave you my story, or at least a shortened version of it."

Adora nodded before looking at Andra, "So, do you guys know me? Where am I in your timeline?"

Andra and Caitlyn looked at each other awkwardly while Lyra stuffed her face with cookies and tea. Catra had obviously excluded that part of the story on purpose, completely dancing around any subject on Adora. Even going as far as skipping the wedding part. Catra coughed, "You're around. We're still good friends."

"Weird." Bow said. "It's like the reverse. In your timeline, you're the princess with powers."

Glimmer nodded, "I guess so. What with Mara being around, I guess that means you weren't She Ra, Adora."

Lyra shook her head while swallowing her food, not understanding the social cues of keeping quiet. "What?" She laughed, "Mara's not She Ra, she's Hi Ro. And you're totally around. You're our other queen."

Catra slumped her head on the table in front of her. "Lyra, don't you think I would have said that if I wanted them to know that?"

Adora looked excited. "Really, what kingdom am I queen of?"

Glimmer face palmed. "Adora, she's saying that you're married to Catra."

Adora was quiet for a second before looking at Catra whose head was still face down on the table. Her face lit up in embarrassment. "Oh, well I-I, uh, we never–" Adora stopped talking, her face redder than Catra's head piece.

Bow thought back to the video with Mara when Adora had learned to heal.

Mara stared at her for a moment before smiling. "Y'know, you both look like that when you're talking about one another. Maybe you should say something to one another."

Adora smiled as she turned to look at Mara. "We did."

Mara's eyes widened, "Oh! Uh, congratulations. I see it went well?"

Adora nodded, "She told me last night at the celebration for the war's end."

Mara grinned, "Well good for you two. I'm happy for you. In fact we should take advantage of this."

"So that's when you guys. . . At the celebration when you ended your war?" Bow asked.

Catra nodded, before standing. "Well, we can talk about it more later, okay? For now, let's ask your dads what you wanted to ask."

Bow nodded, handing them his trackerpad, "Right. So, on one of our missions, we received a message from an unknown source. Catra informed us that she knew Serenia from her time, but if we

knew what Serenia meant from our time, I think we could figure out the rest."

Lance looked at the message, "'Serenia, portal, Mara' Okay. But what are these other words?"

Adora shook her head, "I don't know. It's too degraded to read."

George looked at his husband, "Wait a second. Lance, what does this pattern look like?"

Lance gasped, "Oh, I think you're right."

Bow looked at them, "What is it?"

George handed him the trackerpad back, "Look at it, Bow. Really look at it. What do you see?"

Bow gained a look of realization, "These aren't words at all, are they?"

Lance smiled, "Oh, now you've got it. George, get the projector."

George quickly came back with the projector before turning it on, revealing stars, "The world of the First Ones was different from ours. Climate, language, even the sky was different, filled with cosmic formations they called. . ."

Adora gained a look of wonder, "Stars!"

Lance nodded, "The First Ones used them to navigate and named constellations after mythical heroes, including Serenia."

Lyra giggled at hearing Serenia being called mythical. Andra gently elbowed her in the arm but smiled as well.

George nodded, "The constellation Serenia would only appear in summer and only over one place."

Glimmer gained a look of understanding, "The Crimson Waste."

"*Fascinating."* Catra heard a voice say as her ears twitched.

She looked around the room for a moment. "Entrapta?" she called out.

Catra, Scorpia, and Entrapta listened into the tail ends of a conversation they hadn't gotten to hear as they eyed the group from the windows. While the conversation was interesting, all three of them seemed to be more taken in by the fact that they were looking at an alternate version of herself.

"Fascinating." Entrapta said. Catra immediately covered her mouth but it was too late.

"Entrapta?" her counterpart said aloud.

Immediately, Adora, Bow, and Glimmer sprang into action drawing their weapons, looking around. Her other self looked at them in confusion. "What are you guys doing?"

"Entrapta's with the Horde." Adora said on edge. George took a defensive stance in front of Lance.

"That's ridiculous. Entrapta doesn't care about taking lands or conquest. She cares about science and the advancement of it. It's only been about four months since Princess Prom for you guys and she was still with me after that." Catra D'riluth said.

Glimmer looked a little upset to hear that but shook her head, "Things changed in those months. She's with the Horde."

"Well," Catra shook her head, "Let me talk to her. She might not be my bestest friend but she's not bad. Maybe I can convince her to come back with you guys. I'm sure she'd love to study me. I'm basically confirmation of multiversal travel."

Entrapta looked excited at the prospect but Catra shushed her with a glare. She went to move before Scorpia's tail got caught on a vine, making a very noticeable scraping sound. Catra let out a

sigh before rolling her eyes. "Fine. Guess we're doing this the hard way."

Catra stood up and looked at her former friend, "Hey Adora."

"Catra! What are you doing here?" Adora said harshly.

"We picked up an extremely powerful signal from a piece of First Ones tech as well as trace amounts of extra dimensional energy signatures of that of a portal at this location." Entrapta said as she eyed Catra D'riluth and her guard.

Everyone looked at Entrapta before Catra glitched again. Entrapta's eyes widened. "Oh my! You're showing heavy evidence of temporal dissonance. This shouldn't be possible. Oh, you've got to let me run some tests. This breaks all known laws of physics."

Catra looked at her comrade, "What's that mean?"

"It means that every time your alternate self glitches, I'm receiving readings on the constant destabilization of the surrounding area around her. If she doesn't repair herself soon, she could cause a complete collapse of not only our dimension, but the space time continuum itself." Entrapta laughed maniacally before becoming serious. "That would be extremely bad just so you know."

Catra D'riluth looked at the obelisk shard in her hand with a solemn expression. Entrapta zoned in on it. "That's the piece of First Ones tech that our scanners have picked up on."

"So, you're telling me. . . If I don't fix my runestone. . . It'll destroy this timeline?" Catra said with anger at what she was being told.

"Precisely." Entrapta said with a smile. Suddenly, all three of her guards glitched as well. Entrapta's smile became a bit more strained, "Ah, well, on the other hand. If it doesn't fix it, then the problem that would be the cause would be you four in particular. Leaving would be the best in all honesty."

Scorpia waved, "Hi other Catra. Do you know who I am? If you don't, Hi, I'm Scorpia. We're best friends here. So nice to meet you."

Catra nodded, pocketing the shard. "I know you, Scorpia."

"Oh, that's a relief." Scorpia said before Catra looked at Entrapta.

"So are we taking the shard or what?" She growled.

Entrapta shook her head, "While it would be fascinating to study, we should let her fix the runestone to leave. But, on the other hand, I am picking up another signal that holds some power. It's radiating from that room over there."

"The runestone shard?" Lance said from behind George.

"Yep, that checks out. It's giving off massive magnetic readings. I've never seen anything of this magnitude that could produce this much electronic interference. It's like there's a field around it." Entrapta said.

Catra eyed her alternate self before looking at the three guards beside her. She was severely outmatched here and everyone knew it. But she couldn't afford to go back to Hordak empty handed. Not with her life on the line.

Catra D'riluth watched everyone as they eyed one another, preparing for a fight, before she looked at Lance, whispering. "Would you be willing to give them the shard?"

George and Lance looked conflicted but hesitantly nodded. With that knowledge in hand, Catra walked up to her younger self and held a hand out. Catra eyed her hand before hesitantly taking it. Instantly, they were standing somewhere else.

Catra looked around only to realize they were back in the Fright Zone. And she was looking at herself being suffocated at the hands of Hordak.

"*I know your lax security allowed Shadow Weaver to escape. I know you've been covering it up. Lying about her whereabouts. But worst of all, I gave you a chance to come clean, to prove your worth to–" an alarm blared out in the sanctum as Hordak looked at Catra before he walked back, shutting the device off and allowing Catra to breathe again. "If you value your life, you will remain there."*

Hordak looked at the screen before his eyes widened. As Catra gasped for air behind him, drinking in the oxygen that she had been deprived of, Entrapta came falling through the vent in the ceiling before swinging to the ground with her hair..

She stopped for a moment, looking at Catra with some slight concern before turning back towards Hordak with excitement after seeing she was alright. "Hordak! I've got a lot to cover and not a lot of time. I'm still working on integrating the First Ones tech from the Northern Reach into our portal machine. But that's besides the point.

"*I've just picked up a powerful signal of First Ones tech in the Whispering Woods. It's easily the most powerful signal I've ever seen. It could be a perfect addition. I don't want to jump to conclusions, but I think this could very well be a piece of a First Ones ship." She turned towards Catra, "You'll need to gather Scorpia and get on it ASAP. It's close enough to Bright Moon that they could get to it first."*

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Catra pulled her hand back and immediately found herself back in the library again. She looked at her older self stumble a bit. D'riluth nodded before looking at Entrapta. "Can you call Hordak?"

"Oh, easily! We're well within range for a call." Scorpia said from the side.

She nodded, "Do so. I'll wait." she said as she walked back towards the group.

Bow looked at her in irritation and confusion, "What are you doing? We can't just give them that shard!"

Catra D'riluth looked at her with a look of seriousness. "Take into account everything you just heard, where you're at, and what that could actually do for the Horde. One, we have just learned that I need to retrieve the pieces of the obelisk and need to leave as quickly as I can. Two, we are in Bow's home with the threat of an attack. And third, that runestone shard is just that, a shard. Now that we've considered all of that, you need to understand that not every battle needs to end with a fight. "

Her ears twitched. Hordak had answered.

"*Force Captain Scorpia. I take it you have retrieved the technology and are calling to give me the good news?*"

"Eh, not quite. The, uh, enemy? Is that the right word here? Well, they want to talk to you." Scorpia said, holding the tablet out to the alternate Catra.

Catra strode over, taking the tablet from Scorpia's hands. "Hordak."

"*Catra? No, you're not Catra. What is going on?*" Hordak asked.

Catra pulled Entrapta into frame. "Tell him what you told me."

"Oh, it's fascinating. This Catra is from another timeline! Not only is she from a different timeline, she's a First One. The technology and portal reading we picked up was from her. But there's a problem." Entrapta said.

Hordak watched as Catra glitched. *"Ah, temporal dissonance. I see. I think it would be best if you leave back the way you came."*

Catra nodded, "I'm working on it. My runestone was shattered and until it's repaired, I can't leave. But, I'm willing to make a deal."

Hordak narrowed his eyes, *"Speak your terms."*

"I'm willing to give you a shard from a defunct runestone that initially had properties of that regarding Etheria's electromagnetic field as well as the manipulation of metals. All I ask is that once you have this, if you stumble across any more of these shards," Catra held up the obelisk shard, "You promptly hand it over to the alliance so that I may fix it and leave."

Hordak eyed her as she glitched once more. He fiddled with his screen and Catra could tell he was rewinding the video feed. His face showed that he was looking at something distinctly golden.

Catra realized he was looking at an image of her glitched self. Hordak scoffed, *"Very well, Queen Catra. As long as I have your word that you will not interfere with the war and that once your runestone is complete you will leave, you have my word that I will give any shards that we find."*

Catra nodded, "Then we have reached an agreement. I will send the shard with your Force Captains and we will end the day with no conflict."

"*Agreed. Entrapta, Catra, Scorpia, return promptly."* With that the screen went black. She handed the tablet back to Scorpia and walked back towards Lance and George.

"I'm sorry that you two got dragged into this." She apologized.

George nodded with a sigh, "It's fine. As long as there's no fight."

Catra D'riluth looked at her other self's group. She narrowed her eyes. "Catra, you come with me to get the shard. Only you."

Catra nodded and followed her, walking past Adora and Glimmer. After they had left the main hall, Catra looked at her older self. "What'd you wanna talk about?"

"Why was he doing that to you? I've never seen Hordak react like that. In either timelines."

Catra didn't quite know what that meant but she let out a growl. "Do you have a Shadow Weaver?"

"I had two. Shadow Weaver and Beatrix. Hopefully, I'm down to just Beatrix." She said darkly.

Catra scoffed, "Yeah, I can see where you're coming from. She. . . she was my prisoner and she escaped. I was scared of what he'd do to me if he found out. So I hid it."

D'riluth sneered. "She causes problems no matter where she is. I made the mistake of trusting her and now, look at me."

Catra watched her before she started glitching. "That's weird."

Her older self laughed. "I suppose it is."

Catra joined her in laughing before they arrived at the room with the shard. Catra looked around, "So, where is it?"

"One second." D'riluth said before pointing her hand at the ball in the middle of the room.

"*System override. Battle unit 54970 deactivated."* her azurlight said.

Within a couple of seconds, the ball opened to reveal the shard. It still glowed with its purple light before Catra grabbed it. She looked at the shard before she felt a hand on her shoulder. She looked at her with a raised eyebrow.

"Listen. I don't know what you're going through and I sure as hell don't have all of the answers. Our stories diverged about five months ago for you, drastically. I lost all of my memories and joined Adora."

"You aren't a princess or queen or whatever?" Catra asked.

"I am, but it's complicated. In all honesty, I've only been a princess for a week. But regarding us, our story? What happened to me won't happen to you and I don't think it ever will. But if I learned one thing with all the shit I've gone through in the last month, it's that you should hold onto whatever's stable in your life. An anchor of sorts. For me, that was Adora. She's my anchor. And I. . ." She looked back towards the hall before back at Catra, "I can't tell them but I can tell you."

"What?" Catra asked curiously.

"I'm scared. Scared of putting this thing back together because I was right. Once it's done. . . so am I." she said quietly.

"What? What do you mean?" Catra asked.

"My memories of the Horde? The memories that make me. . . well, me? They're disappearing. Being corrected into the new timeline. I know some of that doesn't make sense to you but I felt it as soon as I touched this thing. And the worst part is no matter what I do, it's going to happen and there's no way around it. I have to or else I risk destroying your world. I'm sure that after a few more shards I'll completely forget those memories. So I want you to promise me something."

Catra looked stunned at what she was hearing but nodded slowly. "What?"

"Promise me, that you'll stop trying so hard to hurt Adora. Don't make that your reason for living. Find a reason to be happy. That year of fighting Adora seems so pointless to me now. If we had just sat down and talked I think it could have been avoided. Maybe you don't feel the same way that I did about my Adora. But if you're feeling the same way I did, then I'm willing to bet you do. Just try. It doesn't need to be for anyone else but yourself."

Catra looked at her before looking at the shard in her hand, "I-I'll try. I promise."

She nodded, "That's all I can ask." She let out a breath, "Now. Let's get going."

As they walked back out, both Catra's looked at Bow trying to talk to Entrapta and Scorpia looking at all of the artifacts in the library with amazement. Entrapta and Scorpia looked at them. "Did you get it?"

Catra held the shard up but stayed uncharacteristically quiet. Adora looked at Catra before looking at Catra D'riluth. "What did you guys talk about?"

"It's private." Her Catra said as she walked past her and back towards Scorpia.

A ping rang from Entrapta's tablet. "That's the code when you wish to contact me regarding any shards you find. Goodbye." She smiled warmly.

As Catra's crew left, Glimmer looked at her, "Hey, are you alright? You seem upset."

Catra waved it off. "I'm fine. I'm just thinking about what we talked about."

As they said their goodbyes to Lance and George, they headed back to Bright Moon. Angella greeted them with some irritation at the lack of being filled in on what had transpired.

"So you're telling me that you made a deal with the Horde?" Angella asked with agitation.

Catra nodded. "It was necessary. I wouldn't have if I had another option."

Angella let out a breath before looking at the three new women behind Catra. They stood in a very familiar formation. "I take it that these are your guards? I figured you were some kind of royalty based off of your magic and apparel."

Andra spoke up, "We are the queen's royal guard, Queen Angella. I am Andra, captain of the Royal guard. These two are Caitlyn and Lyra."

Angella nodded, "A pleasure." She looked at Catra's hand, "I see you found another shard. I imagine that's where you three came from?"

Andra nodded. Angella gave a curt nod back before turning around. "We'll discuss this later. For now, relax."

Micah, King of Bright Moon, was wandering through the woods of Beast Island when something caught his eye. He'd traveled this

route an immeasurable amount of times so when he saw the glowing shards, he knew that it was something new. Quickly approaching them, he found two. Looking around him, he quickly grabbed them and ran for the beach.

Micah examined them curiously before he tried to bite one. "So, it's not food." He tried jabbing one into the soil only to find it repulsed from the ground. "It can't be used as a weapon. But it's clearly magic."

Micah looked at them both before trying something else. He slowly pushed them together. As soon as it began arcing off one another, Micah realized it was a runestone. After a moment, they seamlessly fused together only for a portal to open in front of him, dropping a body in front of him, and then quickly close.

It was a woman with long dark hair. She let out a groan as she slowly got to her feet before looking at him. "Micah?"

Micah narrowed his eyes before readying a spell. "Shadow Weaver!" He snarled.

She instantly cut the spell in half but the pressure of the magic had blown her veil off of her face. Micah stopped when he saw her. "You're not Shadow Weaver."

"No, my name is Beatrix."

How was everyone's Thanksgiving? Hopefully it was good. I enjoyed writing this chapter very much and I have some other news. I've gotten a drawing tablet for digital art so I'm quite excited. I want to give a big shout out to redditor Ibuprofencompactor for their amazing art work of Catra and Adora as the queens of Eternia.

Chapter 6

Catra stood on the balcony of her room as she stared out over Bright Moon. Any other time she would have basked in the gentle darkness that Etheria's night offered. But her focus, however, was on her memories.

"*You should've seen your face. You were like, "Aah, no! Betrayal." Catra laughed as she joked with Adora.*

Adora let out a scoff, "Come on, Catra. We're senior cadets now. I can't believe you're still pulling such childish, immature – Is that a mouse!" Adora cried.

Catra's hair stood on end as she looked around the locker room frantically, "What!? Where!?"

Adora laughed as Catra glared at her, "Are you ever going to not fall for that?"

"*I don't know. Are you ever going to let it go? That was one time." Catra argued.*

"*I know, but for some reason it's always funny."*

"Adora."/A voice drifted in behind them.

Adora turned to face the witch. "Shadow Weaver!//

You have done well. You have completed your training course in record time."

Adora glanced at Catra. "Uh/Well, that wasn't just me. You know, Catra did, too."

Shadow Weaver looked at Catra dismissively. "Ah. Yes. How so? You were as unmotivated as you completed the course in that time as when you were new."



Catra let out a wince as she held her head, the pain in the back of her head becoming stronger. She closed her eyes as she began to take deep breaths as the pain started to fade.

"*You should've seen your face. You were like, "Aah, no! Betrayal." Catra laughed as she joked with Adora.*

Adora let out a scoff, "Come on, Catra. We're eighteen years old now. I can't believe you're still pulling such childish, immature – Is that a mouse!" Adora cried.

Catra's hair stood on end as she looked around the halls of the palace frantically, "What!? Where!?"

Adora laughed as Catra glared at her, "Are you ever going to not fall for that?"

"*I don't know. Are you ever going to let it go? That was one time." Catra argued.*

"*I know, but for some reason it's always funny."*

"*Catra." A voice drifted in behind them.*

Catra turned to face the sorceress, "Beatrix. How have you been?"

"*You have done well. You have completed your advanced lessons on magic theory. Soon, we will begin on the esoteric texts." Beatrix said with a smile. Catra looked at her in shock.*

Adora shoulder bumped Catra, knocking her out of her stunned excitement. Catra shook her head slightly as she let out a grin. "T-Thank you! I won't disappoint you, I promise."

Beatrix turned towards Adora with a nod. "Your father would like to speak with you. Try not to keep him waiting. I hear it's important." And with that, Beatrix turned and left.

As Adora and Catra went to head towards the main hall, Adora smiled, "She sure knows how to give a pep talk."

Catra laughed at that.

A gentle hand on Catra's shoulder shook her slightly, pulling her from her thoughts. Catra blinked before turning to look at the person, only to find Angella with a concerned look on her face with Andra behind her. "Catra? Are you alright?"

Catra looked around, realizing it was far into the morning already. She looked at her hands before shifting uncomfortably, gently touching her wedding ring. "Uh, yeah, I'm fine. Why do you ask?"

"Catra, you were glitching heavily. How long have you been standing there?" Angella asked.

Catra shrugged, "A few minutes." She lied, "It's nothing. What's going on?" She asked, quick to change the subject.

Angella looked unsure but accepted the answer regardless. Shadow Weaver is being held in the Bright Moon prison. She snuck in and I just wanted to make sure that you were alright."

Catra's face fell into a dark scowl. "Is it my Shadow Weaver?"

Angella shook her head, "No. She's definitely ours. She hasn't glitched once."

Castaspella made her presence known from behind Angella. "So, we haven't really had the chance to meet besides the day you arrived in Bright Moon. You look a bit older."

"There's a reason for that. We'll have a chance to speak after we deal with Shadow Weaver. Let's go see why she's here." Catra said as she walked into the hall, Andra, Caitlyn, and Lyra following them.

Angella looked at her as she spoke, "You've got experience with Shadow Weaver. She joined your side initially, right? Do you have any reason why she'd come here now?"

Catra nodded, "I have a few ideas. The first is that she could have heard about me and it's the same reasoning. That's the least likely option. The second is she's dying without a runestone to power her health. That's the most likely option. The third is that she's been banished from the Horde. I don't see that being likely at all, considering how Hordak treats his prisoners. When you speak to her, I'll stay out of sight and watch."

Angella led the way and stopped in front of a spare bedroom. Catra raised an eyebrow, "This is the Bright Moon prison?"

"Well, technically it's the spare room, but it is more than adequate as a holding cell. We removed the cushions." Angella looked at Catra silently for a moment, "Most of the cushions."

"This is the prison?" Adora asked as she walked up to them.

"Yes, it's the prison." Angella snapped in slight annoyance.

"Your Majesty, I know Shadow Weaver. I know her tricks. I need to be there for the interrogation, I'm the only one who–"

Angella raised a hand, cutting Adora off. "Shadow Weaver is dangerous. I will not let that woman near you. Near any of you. You are to stay away from this room. Catra will be more than enough to help."

"But, Your Majesty, Catra–"

"That is final." She refuted as she and Castaspella entered the room.

Catra looked at Lyra and Caitlyn, "See to it that Adora doesn't enter this room." They nodded before turning her gaze at the younger version of her other queen. "Andra, come with me."

As Catra and Andra entered the room, she stayed out of sight as she looked at the woman hunched over in the magic circle. Shadow Weaver began to stir before opening her eyes. "Where. . . Where am I?" She asked before reaching out, only to recoil at the magic barrier.

"You're in the Bright Moon prison." Angella started.

Shadow Weaver looked around in confusion, "This is a prison?"

"Why does everyone keep–? Of course, this is a prison." Angella let out a groan.

"You must be Glimmer's mother. I can tell by the way your voice grows shrill when you scream."

Angella gave a glare as she lowered her voice. "How dare you?"

"Shadow Weaver." Castaspella stepped forwards, "You will answer for the crimes you committed during the time as my brother's teacher."

"Oh, yes. Sweet, talented Micah."

Angella glowered, "You will not speak his name."

"I'm not the one who got him killed." She drawled. Angella let out a snarl before Shadow Weaver began coughing. Angella and Castaspella looked at her curiously before Angella stepped forward.

"Tell us why you are here."

"I have vital information to defeat the Horde," Angella's eyes widened, "but I will only speak to Adora."

Angella turned back towards Catra. "Was that enough, Catra?"

As Catra stepped into the light, Shadow Weaver's eye widened. Here was a much older Catra staring her down that she had no prior knowledge of. Catra scoffed, "Judging by her reaction to me. I've got it narrowed down."

"Catra? You look older." Shadow Weaver said.

"Let's start with the obvious one. She's dying. Her mask is cracked and the rune shard is missing. Lack of magic. Second, her reaction to me says that she wasn't aware of me. That means that she hasn't been with the Horde in a while. Am I close here?"

Shadow Weaver chuckled before coughing. "Always a clever one aren't you. You're clearly not my Catra. Your apparel gives that away. As does your demeanor. So sure of yourself, so confident, unlike my Catra. But something is off about you. What is it, Catra?" Catra narrowed her eyes as she glitched. "Ah, there. You've messed with time magic. That can't be healthy for you."

Catra turned towards Angella, "You want my opinion? Let her die." Shadow Weaver simply ignored her as she sat back patiently. Andra took this opportunity to speak up from the back.

"Wow, she's nothing like Beatrix at all. Sure she sounds the same but that's about it."

Castaspella turned towards Catra, "Who's Beatrix?"

"She's. . ." Catra paused, "She's my magic teacher." Catra thought about that before a memory shot through her.

"*Now, now, Catra. We've been over this. When drawing a truth spell, it must be perfect. Any sloppy lines will make the spell faulty*

and it will fail." Beatrix lectured.

Catra glitched before going to draw a truth spell. Shadow Weaver's eyes widened as she watched the flawless spell form. Before Catra could finish the spell, Catra glitched again before stumbling, her legs giving out beneath her as Andra caught her.

Catra took deep breaths, steadying herself. Shadow Weaver looked at Catra with understanding. "Ahh, so that's what it is. You aren't even from this Etheria. I imagine using any magic at all is quite challenging for you."

Castaspella looked at Catra in concern before turning towards Shadow Weaver and drawing a truth spell of her own. "Tell us what you know."

Shadow Weaver put a finger up, pointing out several inconsistencies. "*I know* when you cast a truth spell, you should make sure you've drawn it correctly. Sloppy work. Not like Catra's here. *Perfect.* I'd recognize my handiwork anywhere." She said before turning towards Castaspella, "Are you sure you're Micah's sister?"

She growled as she went to approach before being stopped by Angella. "She's trying to get under your skin."

"You could spare yourself the trouble if you would just let me talk to Adora." Shadow Weaver said boringly.

"No, you've put that girl through enough. Now tell us the truth. Why did the Horde send you here? What are you planning?" Angella snapped.

Shadow Weaver let out a laugh, "You think Hordak sent me? I escaped from Hordak and paid the price for it."

Angella watched as dark smoke drifted off of her skin, coughing once more. "You're... You're dying, aren't you?"

Castaspella tugged Angella and Catra out of the room, "Can I speak with you two for a moment?" As they left the room, she turned towards them, "This isn't working. We've tried everything, and her condition is growing worse. I know your feelings on this but perhaps. . . You said she healed you right? Maybe Adora could–"

"Absolutely not. She–"

Catra listened to them for a moment before she spotted Adora, Glimmer, and Bow out of the corner of her eye. She watched Bow walk forward as Glimmer and Adora teleported.

"We should consult with the Princess Alliance before we go further." Angella said before Bow stepped towards them.

"Your Majesties. Hey. So who wants to see a magic trick?" Bow said with a deck of cards.

Catra watched him perform several tricks, unamused as she listened to Adora talk to Shadow Weaver through the door. Eventually, she turned away from Bow and walked back into the room. Angella flew forward at the sight of She Ra, "What are you doing!"

"I'm sorry, I tried!" Bow said as he dropped his cards.

Catra watched as Shadow Weaver was healed. Annoyance was the most friendly emotion she was feeling at the moment as she watched with narrowed eyes. Angella rushed forward, wrapping her arms around Adora and Glimmer, "I told you both to stay out of here."

"She's She Ra, mom. What do you expect me to do?" Glimmer said.

Adora gently stepped around her as she walked up to Shadow Weaver. "I held up my end. Now you hold up yours. Why are you here?"

Shadow Weaver laughed as she examined herself. "You want the truth? I have nowhere left to go. Catra betrayed me. Hordak cast me aside. I want to take them down. And helping you is the best way to do it. Hordak has been working for years to build a machine capable of opening a portal through the fabric of space. He intends to bring the rest of the Horde's armies through this portal and use them to conquer Etheria, once and for all."

Everyone gasped as Angella spoke up, "Armies? There's more of the Horde?"

"A force so large, you cannot even comprehend it. You have struggled to hold off Hordak's paltry troops for years. You will stand no chance against the full might of the Horde."

"What makes you think he's close to finishing this portal machine now?" Adora asked.

"Because he has something he didn't have before. A Princess who knows how to combine First Ones technology with the Horde's machines." Shadow Weaver explained.

Bow gained a look of understanding, "Entrapta. That's why she's been after all that First Ones tech."

"How stupid do you think we are? She knows the Horde is losing, and she's trying to scare us. Portals to other worlds? It's ridiculous." Glimmer exclaimed

"I know how this must sound. We on Etheria have no concept of a universe beyond our reach. And yet, the evidence stands before us." She gestured at Adora.

Adora looked stunned, "Me?"

"Hordak succeeded once before. Years ago, he opened a portal. It was only for a moment. And in that, a child came through. That child was you, Adora. You were brought through a portal from another world."

"What?" Adora took a step back in shock.

Glimmer stepped in front of Adora, "Leave her alone. You're lying, we all know it. You lie about everything."

Shadow Weaver shook her head, "I gain nothing from lying. Adora is different from us. Do you think just anyone could bring a dying woman back to life? Not quite the reunion you pictured, is it? Perhaps you would have preferred the comfort of lies."

Catra shifted uncomfortably behind everyone, but that was enough for Shadow Weaver to notice. "And yet, it seems at least one of you was aware of this already. Judging by your reaction to this, Catra, you have heard this once already. *Am I close here*?"

Adora turned to face Catra. "You knew about this?" Catra stared at her silently, as she looked from her to Andra's group. "You said you grew up with me even in your alternate timeline. So then you must know about this timeline. What I really am? Where I came from." Catra didn't answer as she looked at everyone in the room. Adora snapped at her, shouting. "Answer me, Catra!"

Catra let out a breath. "You're an Eternian. Even in the initial timeline, we confirmed that. It's why you can read it and, even unknowingly, speak it."

Adora shook her head in denial. "No. . . that's. . . I can't speak Eternian."

Catra let out a breath, "*But you can, Adora. Maybe you can't piece the words together, but you can understand me clear as day right now."*

Adora was taken aback before a glare settled on her face, "Why wouldn't you tell me about this?"

"I. . . My counterpart here has no aptitude for magic. In my timeline, nobody knew where I came from. Who my parents were. Even Shadow Weaver didn't know. But I'm willing to bet that's not the same here." Catra admitted.

Shadow Weaver shook her head, "No, it's not. Our Catra's parents were villagers who died in a raid."

"Exactly. With those things in mind, I. . . hoped that it was the same for you. That if Marleena didn't show up for this Catra, she would have no connection with you either. Being connected to the Eternians complicated everything. So I chose not to tell you." Catra explained.

"That wasn't your decision to make. I deserved to know where I came from!" Adora yelled angrily. After a moment, she dropped her voice. "Did you know about Hordak's plans?"

"Adora, I–"

"Did you know!" Adora snarled.

Catra nodded. "Yes, but you have to understand. It was different. My time–"

Adora turned and stormed off, running for the door. Catra had a pretty good idea where she was headed. Shadow Weaver's chuckle drew her attention. "It seems that you aren't so different from my Catra after all."

Catra glared at the woman before walking out of the room. "Caitlyn, Lyra, watch Shadow Weaver. Andra with me."

"Where are you going?" Glimmer asked.

"To get–" Catra stopped as she looked at her hands as she started glitching. She looked at Andra, Caitlyn, and Lyra as they began to glitch as well but to a much lesser degree. Unlike before, this time it seemed almost unending.

"What is–"

A deafening booming noise sounded from the sky, cutting her words off. Catra looked at everyone before they rushed outside. As they left the castle, Catra was greeted to a sight that sent ice

down her spine. The sky had a crack in it and they were nothing like the rifts that she and Mara had stopped before. These looked entirely unfamiliar to her. If she hadn't seen the cracks occasionally glitch, she would have assumed that they had nothing to do with her.

"What is that?" Bow asked.

"I don't know. Where's Adora?" Catra asked.

"I'm here!" Adora said from the side. Catra could see the slight irritation still present but she could worry about it later.

Catra looked at the sky one last time before swiping her azurlight, pulling up a holographic screen. "Connect me to the communications line FC-1." After a moment, Catra's face appeared on screen beside Lonnie, Kyle, and Rojelio. "Catra, are you seeing the same thing I'm seeing?"

"*You mean the fact that the sky is tore open? Yeah, we're all seeing it."* Lonnie chimed in. *"What the hell is going on with your body?"*

Catra thought for a moment before Entrapta's voice came through the other end. *"It seems that the timeline is being destabilized in a localized area. If this continues, that fissure is going to keep getting bigger. Right now, the readings are showing that it's confined to one area but it's not looking good."*

"What happens if it gets bigger?" Bow asked.

"*Nothing."* Entrapta answered.

"*So it's just a pretty light show?" Scorpia's voice was faintly heard.*

"No, she means nothing. As in the end of everything." Catra D'riluth said before letting out a low growl. "Where is it happen–"

A second boom was heard as a smaller crack split the sky much further away. Catra couldn't see it but it was over the Horizon,

closer to the Horde. "Do you have a full view of that second one?"

"*Yes. It seems to be in the direction of Beast Island."* Hordak said with a growl. *"Can you fix this?"*

Catra nodded before flicking her Azurlight. "I think so. Adora, give me your sword."

Adora did so before Catra spoke to her azurlight. "Open File - Obelisk."

"*Please enter confirmation code."* Catra's hand glowed before the file opened.

After a moment, an image was pulled up before she held the sword up to the screen. "Sync energy signatures with Sword of Protection." As they all watched Catra input a code, the sword began glowing before a beam of light shot out of the end and into the sky.

"What's it doing?" Glimmer asked.

"It's giving us a direct path to the shards." After a moment, the beam of light split into hundreds of lines, shooting in all directions. Another boom was heard, giving way to another crack. Everyone stared up at the sky in horror.

"*Uh oh, the data is suggesting that the cracks, while contained in their localized areas, have begun to interconnect."* Entrapta said.

"*What's that mean?"* Kyle asked in fright.

"*It means that they don't need to spread. They just have to touch one another."* Catra said, filling in the blanks.

"There's hundreds of shards! We'll never make it." Castaspella said.

Catra shook her head, "No, the obelisk can self repair when enough of it is present. We just need the bigger pieces." Catra

typed something before finishing. After a moment, the hundreds of beams of light fused into three larger lines. Catra couldn't help but compare them to ley lines.

Turning back towards the video feed, she looked at Hordak. "I'm sending you the energy signature of the obelisk shards. There's three shards of large size. If we can put them together, will it stabilize the timeline?"

Entrapta waited for a moment before she ran the simulation before nodding. *"It does appear to be the case."*

"Good. Send a sky ship to Bright Moon. At least one of those is on Beast Island while the other one is past it. My best guess is Mount Candilla. Adora, you, Bow, and Glimmer are going for the third. It looks like it's near the Kingdom of Snows. Lyra, you're going with them."

"What? But–"

"No buts. If they can't touch the shards then that'll leave only us four. You're the smallest, which means you can fit on the back of Swift Wind." Catra said with a commanding tone.

Hordak nodded, *"Very well. See to it that you leave once this obelisk is repaired. Force Captain Catra, pick your crew. Head for Bright Moon at once."*

As Catra watched Hordak leave from view, she found herself looking at her younger counterpart. "Who are you bringing?"

Catra looked behind her before nodding. *"Entrapta, Scorpia, and Lonnie's crew. We'll be there within the hour."*

She nodded at the answer. "Alright, I'll be waiting."

Catra took a deep as she thought about what this meant for her. She had hoped that she would be able to enjoy her memories a bit more before losing them, but that hope had been severely squashed. She had gone through her journal entries the night

before only to find that they had also disappeared. There was no trace of them and that only further strengthened the fact that once the obelisk was repaired, the only thing that would remain of her would be. . .

As Adora left with Bow, Glimmer, and Lyra, she walked out to the platform near the Moon Stone. Andra and Caitlyn accompanied her along with Angella and Castaspella. Nobody was happy with this turn of events but they had little choice but to help one another. As she waited, her thoughts began to drift towards her childhood. A painful memory that had stuck with her even when she had lost her memories, albeit subconsciously.

"*Catra, wait up."*

"*What's it like being the world's slowest person?" Catra yelled back behind her shoulder laughing. As Adora swung down and started to chase her, their joyful laughter soon died as they came across a darkly illuminated room.*

"*It's open." Catra gasped.*

"*We're definitely not allowed in there." Adora said in a serious tone before they both broke out in giggles as they ran into the room.*

As they walked into the black Garnet Chamber, they stood in awe of the Black Garnet. Suddenly, Catra drew her hand back in a shriek of pain.

"*Ma-maybe we should get out of here." Adora said nervously.*

Before Catra could respond, Shadow Weaver entered the room groaning in pain. Before she could notice them, Adora and Catra quickly hid in a corner of the room. As they observed the woman drain the Black Garnet she took off her mask, Catra and Adora gasped in shock at the sight. Shadow Weaver whipped around at the sound before angrily shouting, "Get out!"

As they took off running, magic enclosed the exit to Adora's dread. As she turned back around, she found Catra unmoving, levitating in air and encompassed in dark cracking magic. "Catra," The woman cooed, putting her mask back on, "You stay."

Catra was forcefully dragged through the air towards the woman, "What do you think you were doing in here?"

"*We were just playing." Catra said in a small fearful voice.*

"*Insolent child, I've come to expect such disgraceful behavior from you. But I will not allow you to drag Adora down as well."*

Catra winced as a ringing sound pulsed in her ears. Angella gently touched her shoulder.

"Catra, your nose is bleeding. Are you alright?" Catra didn't respond. The pain in her head was overwhelming. Andra and Castaspella stepped forward out of concern.

"*Shadow Weaver, it wasn't her fault, it was my idea, too!" Adora cried out in defense of her friend.*

"*You have never been anything more than a nuisance to me! I've kept you around this long because Adora was fond of you, but if you ever do anything to jeopardize her future, I will dispose of you myself." Shadow Weaver said darkly. "Do you understand?"*

Adora ran in between the two, throwing her arms out pleadingly, "Please stop!"

Shadow Weaver's magic dissipated as she stepped back before moving towards the Garrets with a groan. Adora looked at Catra before running over to Shadow Weaver. "She didn't mean to!"

"Adora, you must do a better job of keeping her under control." Shadow Weaver said sourly as she [illegible] to the cabinet as she [illegible] her shadow. Adora gave Catra a gentle pat on the head as she stood. "Perhaps I should let someone like [illegible] happen again."

.

The pain gradually faded, as did the ringing in her ears. "I'm. . . I'm okay. Just a migraine." Catra reassured them, although none of them believed her. She wiped the blood from her nose and let out a sigh as she looked towards the sky, waiting on the sky ship.

"*Catra, wait up."*

"*What's it like being the world's slowest person?" Catra yelled back behind her shoulder laughing. As Adora swung down a hanging tapestry piece and started to chase her, their joyful laughter soon died as they came across a cracked door that showed the barest hint of the darkly illuminated room.*

"*Look." Catra gasped.*

"*We're definitely not allowed in there." Adora said in a serious tone before they both broke out in giggles as they ran into the room.*

As they walked into the office, they stood in awe of the glowing artifacts that littered the room. As Catra looked at the items in the room, her eye was caught by the jeweled metal flower with a burning stick, and the smoke that emitted a faint purple glow. Catra reached out and gently picked it up.

"*Adora, look at this. What is it?"*

Adora gasped before gently taking it. "It's an umbra root. They burn it in the dark hemisphere in the temples of Shokoti. This. . . this is illegal."

"*Why is it illegal?" Catra asked, looking at it in wonder, "It's pretty."*

"*I don't know. I haven't been taught that yet. But I'm sure there's a reason." Adora said as she examined it.*

"*Should we go show your dad?" Catra asked, looking at Adora.*

Adora nodded as she turned towards the door. "Yeah, for whatever reason, this isn't allowed. Come on."

As they left the room, they caught sight of Evelyn and Randor at the end of the hall. They ran forwards, careful not to drop the incense. "Dad, Aunt Evelyn, we found this in a room!" Adora said, holding the incense up into the air as they stepped into the sunlight.

Their eyes widened in terror as she ran towards Adora with extreme speed. "Adora don't–"

Catra watched in horror as an explosion of purple flames rocked the hallway. As the fire engulfed Adora, Catra was blown back from the explosion.

As they left the room, they caught sight of Evelyn and Randor at the end of the hall. They ran forwards, careful not to drop the incense only for Catra to collapse. Adora immediately stopped in shock before kneeling down beside her friend. "Catra! Catra, are you okay! What's wrong?"

Randor rushed forwards only to notice the incense burner emitting the purple smoke. "Evelyn, block the light!"

Within moments, every window was shut, plunging the hallway into darkness. Catra gave a groan as she looked at the King before looking behind him."Mom? What happened?"

Randor turned to find C'yra rushing towards her daughter with concern.

Catra stood in silence before the sky ship finally arrived. Catra looked at her counterpart before stepping onto the ship with Andra and Caitlyn. "Head for Candilla first. The furthest one away is the one we need to head towards if we want to diminish the cracks in the sky."

Catra nodded before setting the course. As they began flying, Lonnie looked between her Catra and the future Catra. "Huh, besides the glitching, this is trippy. You look a little older but not much else."

"Oh, it's fascinating for sure! Even with all of the tests I've run, I can't come up with a plausible solution as to how she's here. But I have noticed that your glitching is significantly slowing down and speeding up at timed intervals." Entrapta chimed in from behind.

Kyle looked at her before turning back towards Catra D'riluth. "You're from an alternate future right? What are we all like over there?"

"Yeah. I'm actually curious about that as well." Lonnie said. Rojelio hissed in agreement behind her.

Andra looked at Caitlyn, "This is beyond weird."

"Tell me about it. This Kyle is so skinny." Caitlyn muttered back.

"Do you two know me?" Kyle asked.

Andra nodded before looking at her queen. Catra nodded, "You can tell them if you want. I doubt we'll be in this timeline much longer."

Andra turned back towards them. "Kyle, you're actually good friends with us. You're a bit younger here though. You're actually a part of the royal guard." Lonnie laughed out loud, followed by everyone on the ship. Kyle for the most part looked ecstatic.

"I am? That's so cool! Is that a high position?" He asked.

Caitlyn nodded. "Yes. In fact, you outrank most of the military on Eternia. You have a direct line to the queens themselves."

Lonnie finished laughing. "Alright, what about me and Rojelio? Are we guards too?"

Andra lolled her head back and forth a bit, "Kind of? Lonnie, you've been a guard, a soldier, a pilot, a medic. You've filled in for a royal guard at a few points as well as an expeditionary. There's a classification for it but it doesn't really fit your. . . character? Is that the word?" She asked, turning towards Caitlyn.

She nodded, "The classification is Sentinel. But, like we said. . . it doesn't really fit. You're fairly accomplished though."

Lonnie hummed, "That's cool. What about Rojelio?"

"Diplomatic guard." Catra said from the side. Lonnie looked at her in surprise.

"Really?" Kyle asked.

"Yep." Caitlyn said.

Entrapta spoke up in excitement, "What am I like? What's Hordak like? Is the Horde still around?"

Catra looked at her azurlight before tapping it. "Bring up Etheria's files on Princess Entrapta and the Horde."

"*These files are restricted. Administrator code required."* A voice rang out from the gem. Entrapta looked at it in awe.

"Designated Administrator AU-66666 Catra." Catra said.

"*Administrator code accepted. Lifting security protocols. Welcome Queen Catra."*

"Queen? Who are you the queen of?" Lonnie asked in confusion.

"Obviously all of you." Their Catra replied smugly before she turned towards her counterpart. "You are, right?"

She nodded. Her voice was much more serious, "Yes. I am the Queen of Eternos and Empress of all accompanying planets in the Empire of the Deae Lacrimae."

"Strange, you didn't glitch when you spoke that time." Entrapta said from the side.

Catra D'riluth ignored her as she pulled up the files. Several images appeared of Angella and Micah standing together with Glimmer. One of the more recent images showed Glimmer with her wings and Hordak awarding Bow a medal. Catra swiped them away before flicking her hand forward.

"*The Etherian military, otherwise known as 'The Horde,' is Etheria's first line of defense against planetary threats. Overseen by King Micah and Queen Angella's closest advisor, General Hordak, the Horde is an elite fighting force that has advanced military tactics on Etheria. Its science division is managed by General Hordak's wife, Queen Entrapta from their Kingdom of Dryll. Their marriage is one of great importance that not only united Eternia and Etheria, but has advanced the technological aspect of Etheria by centuries."*

"Wow! That is just- wow. Can you believe that Entrapta? You're in charge of the scene division of the whole planet! And married to Hordak!" Scorpia said in excitement. "Oh, what about me?"

Catra D'riluth nodded before swiping the image. An image of Scorpia appeared in a princess-like attire that. . . seemed almost identical to her current wear.

"*Queen Princess Scorpia is the next in line to inherit the throne in Horror Hall and the Kingdom of the Fright Zone. Currently, King Scorpio."*

"Oh, that is so cool." Scorpia said in amazement.

"We're here." The younger Catra said as the ship began to descend. As they stepped off of the ship, she took in the sight of the desolate volcanic landscape. "This place is miserable."

"Oh, look! Is that the shard?" Scorpia asked, pointing out a glowing piece of crystal the size of Adora's sword.

Lonnie shook her head. "How much you wanna bet that the other one is going to be harder to get than that?"

Andra shook her head, "No doubt about it." She said as her and Caitlyn walked over before picking it up and hauling it into the ship. Catra looked up at the sky before sighing. She reached out and touched it before an energy shot through her body. The glitching ceased for a few minutes as Catra felt the magic flow through her body. She looked down, only to find her clothes had changed. She knew that her visual appearance was where it needed to be. Any trace of her Horde self was gone. Her hair had lost its rough looking appearance and her features were more relaxed.

Andra nodded with a relieved smile. "You must be relieved to be yourself again."

She gave a convincing smile to the captain. "Yes. With the glitching back and forth, it was starting to become a bit tedious looking in the mirror and seeing a different me." Catra looked at her future counterpart with a blank expression. She knew she was lying. She knew her own signs and she could tell she was scared by what just transpired.

"Hey, you've stopped glitching. Actually, all of you have." Lonnie said.

Caitlyn and Andra looked at one another before giving a nod coupled with sighs of relief. "It was a little concerning to be honest."

As they all went to board the sky ship, they looked up at the cracks in the sky before they watched the one above them grow smaller. It wasn't quite closed, but it was close.

Catra nodded, "Alright, let's head for Beast Island. It won't take long to get there and we have confirmation that they'll close."

As they took off, Catra D'riluth spoke into her azurlight. "Lyra, are you there?"

"*I'm here, my Queen. Did you get both shards?"* Lyra's voice rang out.

"We've got one of them. We're headed for Beast Island now." Catra replied. "Have you retrieved yours?"

"*Yeah, we did. It was a. . . challenge, to say the least. But we have it and are headed for Bright Moon."* Lyra said.

Catra nodded before flicking her eyes at her younger self. She lowered her voice, taking a serious tone, before turning away from the group. "Lyra, do not let anyone fuse the shard with the Obelisk until I return. That is an order."

"*Understood."* Lyra said before Catra killed the line.

Catra's mind flickered on thoughts of Beast Island before drifting to Micah. He'd been here before when Shadow Weaver had toyed with the bond. She wanted to say he wasn't here before she remembered a conversation between Angella and Shadow Weaver that she had eavesdropped concerning General Calix.

"*Do you remember General Calix?" Shadow Weaver asked.*

"*. . .Yes." Angella said solemnly. "He was a vile person and deserved the death he got. Why bring him up?"*

"*About forty minutes ago the Horde dropped a sizable number of crates and supplies off at the commerce and trade station in the center of the city. Among the trade agreements and papers, I found this." Shadow Weaver said softly, her voice drifting through the door.*

"*Why show me this? What does Calix have to do with it?"*

"*At the time of your husband's supposed death, I did not hold the position of second in command. When I heard of Micah's death, I was shocked. All paperwork flowed through my station at the time and that included a list of the dead. Especially notable figures in*

the war. I didn't receive any such letter. Do you get what I'm saying Angella?"

"*Micah wasn't dead when he was sent to Beast Island?" Angella whispered in horror.*

"*Yes. But you're missing the point."*

"*Then what is the point? Because it is eluding me and hearing about the death of my husband, on this day especially, is grating my patience more so than ever."*

"*I'm saying that there is a high chance your Husband is alive."*

"*How can you be sure?"*

"*General Calix was cruel beyond measure. He liked to see you cling to hope until the very end and then would take pleasure at the sight of your broken spirit. Killing the King of Brightmoon was not enough for the man. If I'm right, I didn't receive the file of Micah's death because he wasn't ever confirmed to be dead."*

"*. . . Thank you Shadow Weaver. You've given me a bit to think about."*

"*You're welcome."*

Catra let out a sigh before holding her azurlight up. "Call Angella."

After a moment, a holographic screen with Angella's face appeared from her wrist. *"Catra? What is it?"*

"Can you go to Shadow Weaver? I need to ask her something."

Everyone on the ship turned to look at her. Catra rounded on her future self. "Shadow Weaver's in Bright Moon?"

She let out a sneer, "Unfortunately. We're holding her prisoner. We found her this morning."

She examined her younger self's face as several emotions flickered across her face, complete betrayal being the most prevalent among them. She put a comforting hand on her shoulder, giving her a soft look of understanding.

"*She's here, Catra. You may ask her whatever you need to."* Angella's voice rang out.

Catra turned towards the screen, looking at Shadow Weaver in her magical prison cell. "Do you know a General Calix in this timeline?"

"*Mmm, yes. A vile man. The world is much better with his death. Why ask?"*

"In my timeline, my original timeline, at the time of your King Micah's death, you did not hold the position of second in command. All paperwork flowed through my station at the time and that included a list of the dead. Especially notable figures in the war. You didn't receive any such letter of Micah's death. Is that the case here?" Catra said.

"*Mmm, you did your homework. Yes, that is all true."*

"Did General Calix send Micah to Beast Island?" Catra asked.

"*Yes. Why do you ask?"* Shadow Weaver said.

"Shit." Catra swore under her breath. It was too coincidental. Micah had to be alive. She turned towards the image again. "Angella, I'll call back shortly." After a moment, she turned back towards her younger self before closing the door to the cockpit, giving them some privacy..

"Are you okay?"

Catra's grip tightened on the controls. "Shadow Weaver left. And went to Adora. She. . . Does she even know what happened to me? What Hordak was going to do to me. Does she even care!"

She let out a sigh before sitting down beside her. "No. She doesn't. She only cares about using us to get what she wants. I learned that the hard way. And she didn't choose Adora. She only went to Bright Moon to save herself." Catra remained silent but gave a small nod. Catra D'riluth opened the cockpit door and stepped out of the room. As they approached the island, her azurlight rang out.

"*Connecting to planet wide Eternian system N-32. Receiving Signal."*

Everyone looked at her wrist before Kyle spoke up. "What's that mean?"

Catra D'riluth narrowed her eyes. "Descramble the encoded signal."

"*Planetwide evacuation required. All units return to Eternia"*

"*Planetwide evacuation required. All units return to Eternia"*

"*Grayskull has fallen. Initiate Sol System Resurrection."*

"*–File Corrupted "*

"*–File Corrupted"*

"*This is a feature, not a bug. This is a feature, not a bug"*

"Signal received. Initiate signal shutdown." she said. After a moment, the signal died before the Azurlight flashed green.

"*Royal communications badge detected. Securing connection. Audio connection secured. Connection established. User Beatrix of Mystacour has requested contact."*

Catra's eyes widened before pushing the call through. "Beatrix! Is that really you?"

A sigh of relief sounded over the line. *"Oh, thank goodness. Catra, I'm stranded on an island on Etheria with a variant of Micah. He thought I was Shadow Weaver. Please tell me you're close by."*

Catra opened the doors before grabbing a flare from Caitlyn. As she shot it out into the sky, she looked back towards her azurlight. "Can you see that?"

"*Yes. I see it. We're heading for the beach now. …Catra, there's another thing. I found a large piece of the obelisk. Are you okay?*"

"I am. We were actually here to retrieve that. Bring it to the beach and be ready." Catra replied.

"*Wait, do you hear that?"* a voice that Catra recognized as Micah's said, *"The sound. It's ceased."*

"*Worry about it later Micah. We're getting off of this island."* Beatrix said.

"We'll be there in a few minutes," Catra said from the pilot's seat.

As they slowly descended onto the shores of the island, Catra caught sight of Beatrix and Micah running towards the shoreline, a large snake-like creature chasing them from the tree line. A moment later, a second one broke through the brush behind the first one. Lonnie's crew looked shocked at the appearance while Scorpia spoke up. "It's like the snow monsters!"

"Andra." Catra D'riluth said sharply. Andra nodded before lifting the gun on her hip before it extended, transforming into a rifle-like appearance. As everyone witnessed the gun light up, Beatrix quickly put a shield up with Micah assisting her. A moment later, a large beam of orange energy shot out of the end, crackling with an almost unstable appearance, shot clean through the monster's head, leaving a singed bloody hole. At the death of its friend, the second one turned and fled the beach.

Catra waited a moment before finally landing the ship. Micah and Beatrix stood up, brushing the sand off of themselves before

turning towards their saviors. Micah stopped at their appearance, a hostile look on his face.

"We're being saved. . . by the Horde? Forgive me if I'm a bit skeptical."

Beatrix looked at the man, "Micah, be rational. This is your only chance to get off of this island."

Catra D'riluth looked at the large shard in the sand that was of much larger size than the previous ones. It actually seemed to be the majority of the obelisk. She turned towards Lonnie, Kyle, and Rojelio. "You three, grab the shard and strap it down. Scorpia, help them out. Andra, Caitlyn, secure the area. I don't want any other monsters heading for the ship."

Micah looked at her as everyone began to do what they were assigned. "I take it you're this Queen that Beatrix was talking about? I know it sounds strange but you seem familiar."

Catra nodded, before turning away from him. "Angella, are you there?"

"*I'm here Catra."*

"We found Micah. He's alive. A little worse for wear, but alive. We're loading the final shard up now and are headed back. I've got to focus so I'm gonna cut it short but we can discuss it when we get back."

Angella looked completely stunned before nodding frantically. *"Of course! Please hurry."*

Catra let out a breath before they all boarded the ship. Micah looked at all of them before deciding to speak his mind. "So. . . the Horde made peace?"

"Uh, no. This was all circumstance." Lonnie said, shaking her head. "So, basically, this version of Catra is from an alternate timeline. Our Catra's over there."

Micah looked over at the pilot seat before looking back at the older one. "Okay. . . time travel. Because that's a thing now."

"Yep." Kyle said. "Well, we all teamed up because her runestone, I think that's what this is, needs to be put back together or the world will end. So, the Horde teamed up with the Princess Alliance to fix it and send her and her friends back home. That's pretty much it."

"Oh. Okay, that makes sense." Micah said, nodding.

"It does? Oh, good. Because I thought it was completely crazy when I said it outloud." Kyle said with relief.

As they sat in silence for the next twenty minutes, Bright Moon in view, Catra's azurlight blinked red. She quickly answered the call. "Lyra, what's going on?"

"*The obelisk is pulling the shard to it!"* The sounds of crackling energy could be heard from behind her. *"It's self repairing. Anybody in the path of the connection is being sent into some sort of stasis field. It's breaking everything around it!"*

Catra D'riluth turned towards the shards in the ship as the largest one began to hum, blue lightning arcing off of it. She quickly opened the doors before the shard flew out of the ship, narrowly missing the interior by inches. "Lyra, tell Adora to trans–"

She dropped to her knees in pain as energy filled her body. She recognized it as the magic from the obelisk. Her head pulsed in agony as she felt her very being changing in response to the temporal effects. Her memories changed as she shakily stood.

She didn't know when they had landed, nor when they had made it into the main hall of Bright Moon but they were here when the pulsing in her head stopped. She noticed that her counterpart was still here along with everyone who had helped.

Looking up, she saw Adora holding the shards back fairly easily. Catra shook her head before reaching out and touching it. The

energies instantly flooded into her before the room's atmosphere calmed. As she regained her powers, her mind was flooded with the knowledge of the past, present, and future. A sense of clairvoyance struck her and then she understood.

Entrapta spoke up from the side. "We need to do this now!"

"Do what?" Lonnie asked.

Entrapta rushed over to the main doors, "The sky has reached a critical point! The obelisk is in close enough proximity with its main body that it is essentially complete, reformed or not. But it's not enough. They need to go home or we're not going to have a home!"

Angella looked at the sky with apprehension before turning towards the older Catra who was quiet. "Catra?"

"I understand." Catra said with a relieved smile.

"Understand what?" Adora asked in confusion.

"Why I was losing my memories. Why we're here. All of it." She said as she nodded at Adora, "Let the obelisk reforge itself."

"But what about your memories?" Catra asked her older self.

"Your memories?" Angella asked in concern. "What about your memories?"

"With every shard, I lose the memories of my original timeline before I forged my bond. But I was wrong." She explained. "I'm not losing them. I just haven't gotten them back yet."

"Huh?" Lonnie asked in bewilderment.

She looked at Beatrix. "What do you remember last?"

"Your wedding." She said simply.

"And you three?" Catra asked Andra, Lyra, and Caitlyn.

"Your wedding." They said in unison.

"Exactly. Everything I've been going through, hasn't happened yet. You three don't remember your trip to Earth with Mara because it hasn't happened yet. Not even my fight with Shadow Weaver took place." Catra explained.

"But what about the shards in your back? What about the staff? So you're saying, what, that none of this is happening?" Bow asked in confusion.

Catra shook her head. "No. it is happening. It's just happened once before. Once we leave, it'll right itself and everything will go back to the way it was supposed to."

"What about us? Will we remember any of this? Will it affect us?" Adora asked.

Catra shook her head before the obelisk reformed itself. Instantaneously, the Obelisk's surface turned to that of an almost water like appearance. She turned towards everyone. "This is it. This is the portal home."

"Wait, what! This– I'm confused!" Catra said as she looked at her older self, "What is happening right now?"

Catra D'riluth let out a breath. "I know. But this is how it's supposed to go. Andra, Lyra, Caitlyn, Beatrix. This is it."

They nodded before stepping through the portal one by one. Lyra stopped before turning towards Glimmer and Bow. "It was cool meeting you guys. I'll see you around."

Catra walked up to her younger self before putting a hand on her shoulder. Catra found herself in a room in Bright Moon castle as she watched a scene appear in front of her.

The door behind Adora opened as an older Catra who was wearing a golden and white coat was chased in by Glimmer who appeared to be queen, "Just let me brush it!"

"*No!" Catra exclaimed in laughter as she was chased by a laughing Glimmer with a hairbrush in hand around Adora. Catra quickly hid behind Adora, "Don't let her touch me. She's gonna torture me."*

"*Do you always have to be this dramatic? You let mom brush it." Glimmer said with a smile.*

Bow entered the room before smiling, "Come on guys. If we are late to Scorpia's first ball she is going to kill us. Micah and Angella are already waiting."Bow walked up to Glimmer before putting his hand around Glimmer's shoulder as she leaned into him.

Glimmer smirked at Catra, "Fine! You're off the hook. This time."

Catra stuck her tongue out at Glimmer as they left before turning towards Adora, her hand outstretched, "Are you coming?"

Adora took Catra's hand, pulling her into a gentle kiss before following her out of the room.

A look of clarity dawned on her face before she looked down, nodding. "Remember what I said, okay? Find a reason." She said before stepping away.

And with that, she crossed the portal. And then it was gone.

"You look beautiful, Catra." Angella said as she straightened the young woman's bridal cape. As Angella smiled, she took in Catra's appearance. It was lovely wear that consisted of dark shades of blood red, ink black, and trims of gold. She wore a chained circlet with several red jewels along with a ringed band around her neck that had a tribal pattern of the magicats. Her cape was draped over her shoulders and gave Catra an air of elegance.

Catra gave a smile before letting out a small shaky breath. "Is it weird that I'm nervous?"

Angella shook her head, taking on a calming and reassuring tone, "No. That's quite normal. I imagine that Adora is feeling much the same way."

Light Hope waved her hands in the air, signing at Catra, "You look gorgeous Catra. Don't be nervous. This is your day."

Catra looked towards her friends that were here with her. Mara, Light Hope, Netossa, Spinnerella, Angella and even Beatrix. They all were giving her smiles of encouragement.

Catra nodded before a bell chimed three times, emitting low hums throughout the Temple of Sharella. Beatrix stepped forwards, holding a box of the ceremonial items that was required. Catra opened the lid, revealing a gold trimmed ring with a red and blue embellished stone that seemed to be continuously drifting.

All right. That marks the end of What Happened. I did my best to make it confusing while relatively simple to follow along. This is *NOT* the end, by the way. This was the setup for part three. This was just to set up the pieces. We are back in the main story now. Part three will be the end though.

And for everyone who celebrates Christmas, have a happy holiday!

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